

CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY

TEACHING MANUAL

Digital Productivity

Session Roadmap · Lesson Notes · Concept Diagrams · Answer Keys

READY TO TEACH

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OVERVIEW

Course Roadmap

What we cover in every session

#	SESSION TOPIC	WEEK / MODULE	DURATION
01	Google Drive Organisation	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email	105 minutes
02	Gmail Management	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email	105 minutes
03	Google Docs Sheets	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email	105 minutes
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05	Workflow Automation	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Task Management and Workflow	105 minutes
06	Capstone Productivity System	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Task Management and Workflow	105 minutes

How to use this book: Each session below is a complete, ready-to-teach lesson note. Section A tells you what to prepare, B lists the outcomes, D–F are the teaching content, G–H are your demos and practicals, and the knowledge check with answer key is at the end. The concept diagram for each session is embedded as a visual aid.

SESSION 01 OF 6

Google Drive Organisation

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 01



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 1 â€" GOOGLE DRIVE AND FILE ORGANISATION

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	1 of 6
Session title	Google Drive and File Organisation
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (basic computer skills assumed)
Prerequisite knowledge	Basic computer skills: creating and saving files, using a mouse and keyboard, basic internet browsing. If a learner cannot create a folder on a Windows desktop or save a file, give them

Item	Detail
	the 15-minute Desktop Refresher in Appendix 1A before this session.
Connection to previous work	This is the first session. It builds directly on the Typing & Computer Basics course â€" learners already know how to save a file to a folder on a computer. This session moves that same idea into the cloud.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged in; Google Chrome installed and updated; every learner has a working Gmail account (create in the first 10 minutes for anyone who lacks one â€" see Section C note); Wi-Fi tested and working; the 20 sample files loaded into a folder `Desktop\CEA-Samples` on each practice machine (file list in Section C); instructor computer connected to the projector; learner workbooks and the file-naming cheat sheet printed.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain in their own words** what cloud storage is, using an analogy, and give at least two reasons why it is safer and more convenient than keeping files only on one computer.
2. **Name and locate** the main parts of the Google Drive interface â€" *My Drive*, *Shared with me*, *Recent*, *Starred*, *Trash* and the **+ New** button â€" without help.
3. **Build a logical folder structure** of at least five folders with nested subfolders for a fictional business, following the rule of shallow, predictable, numbered folders.
4. **Apply a consistent file naming convention** using the `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1` format, and explain why `final_final_v3` and `Document1` are bad names.
5. **Upload files and a folder** to Google Drive using the **+ New** button and by dragging and dropping, then **move** each file into the correct folder.
6. **Share a file and a folder** and set the correct permission level (Viewer, Commenter or Editor), explaining the security danger of "Anyone with the link".
7. **Find any file within 30 seconds** using Drive search, search operators (`type:` , `owner:` , `is:starred`) and filters.
8. **Use starring and folder colours** to mark and visually organise important items.
9. **Recover a file** from the Trash and explain the 30-day deletion rule.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One desktop computer per learner (academy desktops). If two learners must share, pair them so one drives the mouse and the other reads the steps aloud, then swap at the guided exercise.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large TV.

Software

- Google Chrome (any recent version). Google Drive is a web service; it works in any modern browser, but we standardise on Chrome in this academy.
- Windows 10 or Windows 11 on the practice machines.

Accounts

- A Gmail address for every learner. Gmail is **free**, and Google Drive comes free with it (currently 15 GB of storage shared across Gmail, Drive and Photos â€" Google may change this number over time; the idea of "free storage with your account" stays the same).
- If a learner has no Gmail account, the instructor creates one in the first 10 minutes using the sign-up page. They need a phone number for verification; the academy keeps a few test numbers ready but the learner's own is preferred.
- **Important accuracy note:** you do **not** need to install anything and you do **not** pay anything to use Drive at the beginner level. Ignore any pop-up asking to upgrade to a paid plan â€" the free tier is enough for this course.

Sample files

- The academy places 20 sample files in `Desktop\CEA-Samples` on each machine before class. The list (fictional data only):
  1. `Invoice-001.pdf`
  2. `Invoice-002.pdf`
  3. `Receipt-Mile1.jpg`
  4. `Receipt-Mile3.jpg`
  5. `Customer-Measurements-Adaeze.xlsx`
  6. `Customer-Measurements-Ngozi.xlsx`
  7. `Logo-draft.png`
  8. `Logo-final.png`
  9. `Flyer-August.jpg`
  10. `Flyer-September.jpg`
  11. `Price-List.txt`
  12. `Order-Emeka.csv`
  13. `Order-Funmi.csv`
  14. `Bank-Statement-Sept.pdf`
  15. `Tax-Receipt.pdf`
  16. `Product-Photo-Ankara-1.jpg`
  17. `Product-Photo-Ankara-2.jpg`
  18. `Supplier-Contacts.xlsx`
  19. `Social-Media-Calendar.docx`
  20. `Customer-Feedback-Form.docx`

Worksheets / printed materials

- Worksheet 1.1 â€" "Name the Part of Drive" (printed, 1 page, a blanked-out diagram of the interface).
- Worksheet 1.2 â€" "My Naming Convention Practice" (in the learner workbook, Part 3).
- File-Naming Cheat Sheet (one per learner, printed).

Tools

- Google Drive (drive.google.com) â€" free web service.
- Google Chrome browser.

Internet

- **Required** for this whole session. Drive is a cloud service; without internet the lesson cannot run. Test the academy Wi-Fi before class and have a mobile hotspot as backup.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility or prefer Microsoft

- Microsoft OneDrive (free 5 GB with a free Microsoft account) works almost identically: *My Files*, *Shared*, *Recycle Bin*, and the same Viewer/Commenter/Editor idea. If a learner strongly prefers Microsoft, they may follow the same procedures in OneDrive. The concepts â€" folders, naming, sharing, permissions â€" are the same; only the button names change slightly.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, open a plain photo of a physical flash drive (a stock image or a photo of one plugged into a laptop). Do **not** open Drive yet. Just show the flash drive.

What the instructor says:

> *"Let me tell you a short story. Mama Ngozi runs a provision shop near Mile 3 market here in Port Harcourt. She keeps all her records â€" sales, records of who owes her, supplier prices â€" in a notebook, and every night she types them into a small old laptop, then copies them to a flash drive for safety.*

One Monday morning, the laptop is stolen from the shop. The flash drive was inside the laptop bag. Gone. Two years of records â€" gone. Her customers still owe her money but she cannot prove how much. Her suppliers' records are lost.

Now here is the sad part: she did a reasonable thing. She backed up to a flash drive! But the backup was in the same bag as the thing it was backing up. If fire, theft or water hits that spot, you lose both.

*So what should she have done? [Pause. Let learners answer.] â€¦ Yes â€" she should have kept the records somewhere that is **not in her shop at all**. Somewhere a thief cannot reach, water cannot reach, fire cannot reach. Somewhere she can open from anywhere â€" from her phone at the market, from a computer at a cyber cafÃ©, from any device.*

*That place is called **cloud storage**. Today you will set up your own, using a free Google service called **Google Drive**."*

Expected learner response: Learners may say "she should have emailed it to herself", "save it on phone", "Google", or stay quiet. Accept all answers. Praise anyone who mentions Google or online backup, and gently correct "save on phone" by explaining that a phone can also be stolen â€" the point is that the copy lives on Google's servers, not on any one device.

Hook to close the opener (demonstrate live):

> *"Watch this." [Change the photos/videos you streamed to cover full opening and closing â€" see below.] Open Chrome, log in to your own Gmail, go to `drive.google.com`. Say: "This is my Drive. Everything I put here lives on Google's computers, not on this machine. If I take a hammer to this computer right now, my Drive files still exist. In the next 105 minutes, each of you will build your own organised Drive."*

Why this opener works: It starts from a real, emotionally true Nigerian scenario (stolen laptop, lost records, debts unprovable) that learners immediately understand, and it creates the gap the session will fill: how to keep your digital life safe and organised. It ends with a live demo, so learners see the promised tool within 90 seconds.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this quickly as an oral round-robin. Put the four questions on the projector. Call on learners by name so everyone is awake, and keep the pace fast.

Question 1: "On a Windows computer, how do you create a new folder on the Desktop?"

- Expected answer: Right-click on the Desktop â†' **New** â†' **Folder**, then type a name and press Enter.
- Common gap: some learners only know how to save a file to the Desktop and let the computer auto-create files with no organisation. Remind them that on a computer a folder is just a container for files â€" exactly the same idea exists in Drive.

Question 2: "What does `Ctrl + S` do, and why does it matter?"

- Expected answer: It **saves** the file you are working on. Without saving, your changes are lost when the power goes off or the app closes.
- Common gap: learners who only use phones may not know keyboard shortcuts. Show `Ctrl + S` physically and note that on the cloud we will see a very different behaviour â€" auto-save.

Question 3: "What is a file name, and what is a file extension?"

- Expected answer: The file name is what you call the file; the extension is the letters after the dot that tell the computer the file type â€" e.g. `.pdf`, `.jpg`, `.docx`.
- Common gap: confusing the two, or not knowing that the extension matters. Clarify that the extension tells the computer (and often us) what kind of file it is.

Question 4: "What does a file's location mean?"

- Expected answer: The path to where it lives â€" the folder and subfolders that contain it, for example `Desktop\CEA-Samples\Invoice-001.pdf`.
- Common gap: learners who save everything to one place ("It is on my Desktop somewhere") â€" this is exactly the habit we are correcting today.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Everything you just described â€" folders, file names, extensions, locations â€" exists in Google Drive too. The difference is where the files physically are. On your computer, they sit on a metal disk inside the machine in front of you. In the cloud, they sit on Google's computers, and you reach them through the browser. Same ideas, safer home. Let us go."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1 (creating a folder), spend 15 extra minutes on the Appendix 1A Desktop Refresher before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

These notes are the actual teaching. Read them as they are written â€" do not summarise.

F.1 What cloud storage actually is

The idea. Normally, when you save a file, it is written onto a physical piece of hardware â€" the hard disk inside the computer in front of you. That is called **local storage**. The file lives in one place, on one machine.

Cloud storage means the file is saved on computers owned by a company (in this case Google) somewhere else in the world, and you reach it over the internet. Your computer becomes a window through which you look at files that actually live far away.

Plain-English definition. Cloud storage is a service where your files are kept on powerful computers ("servers") in a data centre, and you use any device with internet â€" a desktop, a phone, a tablet â€" to upload, open, edit and retrieve them.

The word "cloud". There is no actual cloud in the sky. The word is a picture. When engineers draw a network diagram, they draw the internet as a fluffy cloud shape, because "the internet" is a big, vague, everywhere-and-nowhere network. So "cloud storage" simply means "storage on the internet somewhere". The files are on real, solid, air-conditioned machines in real buildings. Google has data centres on several continents.

Why it exists. Local storage has three weaknesses:

1. **It is fragile.** The machine can be stolen, dropped, get wet, or the disk can fail. Then the files are gone.
2. **It is trapped in one place.** To use a local file you must be sitting at that one computer.
3. **It is hard to share.** To give someone a local file you must copy it to a flash drive, or email an attachment â€" and then there are two copies that drift apart.

Cloud storage was invented to fix all three at once.

Familiar analogy â€" the generator and the public power supply. Think of the electricity in your area. Years ago, every shop that wanted power needed its own small generator â€" noisy, fuelled, and if the generator spoilt, the shop was in darkness. Today many people connect to the public power grid; the power is generated far away and delivered to everyone. Cloud storage is the "public grid" for files. Instead of every person running their own little "file generator" (their PC's disk), everybody can plug into one big reliable system. Your files stay safe even when your own machine has a problem.

What cloud storage does for you (the four benefits):

- **Access anywhere.** Log in from any computer, tablet or phone.
- **Backup and safety.** Even if your computer is stolen or breaks, the files survive.
- **Easy sharing.** Send a link instead of an attachment; the person sees the latest version.
- **Version history.** You can recover an older version of a file if you make a mistake.

Worked example â€" Adaeze types a CV. Adaeze is a learner at CEA and runs a small sewing business, *Adaeze Fashion*. On Monday she types her CV on the academy computer and saves it to Google Drive (not just the Desktop). On Friday she is at home; she opens her phone, opens the Drive app, and the CV is there. On Sunday she goes to a job interview and prints it at a business centre. She never copied it to a flash drive, never emailed it to herself, never lost it. The same file, reachable from three different places.

Common misconception #1 â€" "The cloud is not safe; I have heard of hackers." This is understandable but confused. Your personal Drive is protected by your Google password, and Google encrypts your data. The realistic danger is not Google's servers â€" those are far more secure than a shop laptop. The real danger is **your own password habits**: a weak password, or sharing files with the wrong setting. We teach safe sharing in Section F.7.

Common misconception #2 â€" "If I have no internet, my files are gone." In fact your files are still safe on Google's servers; you simply cannot reach them at that moment. Google Chrome can also be set up for **offline access**, so that files you have

opened recently stay available even with no internet. Treat internet as the road to your files, not the files themselves.

An honest limitation. Cloud storage depends on internet and on Google staying in business. Google is one of the largest companies in the world, but for truly critical records a wise person keeps a second copy in a different place as well â€" for example a printed copy or an external drive stored elsewhere. **One backup is good; the rule of professionals is: important data lives in two places.** Cloud storage is one strong place to keep a copy.

F.2 The Google Drive interface â€" a guided tour

How to get there. Open Google Chrome. In the address bar type `drive.google.com` and press Enter. If you are already logged into Gmail, Drive opens straight away. If not, it asks you to sign in with your Google account.

The main parts of the screen (menu wording may vary slightly between Google versions and between a computer and a phone, but these are the standard parts):

1. My Drive â€" your personal space. This is where your own files and folders live. When people say "my Drive", they usually mean this.

2. Shared with me â€" files and folders other people have shared with you. Important: these files are **not yours**; they live in the other person's Drive and were simply shared to you. If that person removes your access, they disappear from your list. Do not confuse "Shared with me" with your own backup.

3. Recent â€" the files you last opened, newest first. A shortcut for "where was I?".

4. Starred â€" files and folders you have marked with a star, like a bookmark or a favourite. Use it for your most important items.

5. Trash â€" deleted files. In Drive, deleting a file does **not** destroy it immediately; it moves to Trash, where it stays for about **30 days** before being permanently removed. This is your safety net. You can restore a file from Trash, or empty the Trash to delete forever.

6. Storage â€" shows how much of your free space you are using. With the free plan you currently get about 15 GB shared across Gmail, Drive and Photos.

7. The + New button (top-left) â€" the main way to create things. Clicking it gives: **New folder**, **File upload**, **Folder upload**, and shortcuts to create **Google Docs**, **Google Sheets**, **Google Slides**, **Google Forms**, and more.

8. The Search bar (top) â€" type a file name or a search operator to find anything. We cover this in Section F.6.

9. View options â€" a toggle between **List view** (rows, good for seeing details) and **Grid view** (icons, good for photos). A **Sort** option lets you sort by name, last modified or last opened.

10. The Details pane (an â"˜ information icon, top-right) â€" shows information about the selected file: who owns it, when it was modified, its size, and its sharing status.

Say to the class:

> *"Do not be afraid of this screen. It has only a few real places: your stuff (My Drive), other people's stuff shared with you (Shared with me), your recent and starred shortcuts, and the bin (Trash). Everything else is decoration."*

Common misconception. Learners sometimes think files in **Shared with me** are now safe in their own Drive. They are not. If your friend deletes the file, it deletes for you too. If you need it permanently, make your own copy: right-click the file â†' **Make a copy**.

F.3 Creating a logical folder structure

The idea. A folder structure is the way you group files so that (a) you can find things quickly and (b) a stranger could guess where a file belongs. Bad structure creates digital noise; good structure creates calm.

Why it matters. If all 200 of your files sit loose in *My Drive* with no folders, finding one becomes a hunting game and you will waste minutes every day. A good structure means you always know where to look and where to put things.

Familiar analogy â€" the market stall versus the supermarket. A roadside seller who throws everything in one big bag cannot find a single sachet of milk without emptying the bag. A supermarket arranges goods into sections â€" beverages, provisions,

toiletries â€" and inside each section by type. You walk straight to what you need. Your Drive is your digital supermarket; folder structure is your shelving.

The rules of a good structure:

1. **Shallow, not deep.** Two to three levels is plenty. A folder inside a folder inside a folder inside a folder becomes a maze. If you are five levels deep, flatten it.
2. **Numbered top folders for sort order.** Prefix main folders with `01-`, `02-`, `03-` so they always appear in the order you want, instead of alphabetically.
3. **Predictable names.** Anyone should be able to guess which folder a file goes into.
4. **One folder per purpose.** Do not mix invoices and photos in the same folder.
5. **Consistent style.** If you use hyphens in one folder name, use hyphens in all. If you use Title Case, keep it. Consistency is what makes a system feel professional.

Suggested scheme â€" Adaeze Fashion (our running example). Adaeze sews and sells clothes and does a little social-media marketing. A simple, professional structure for her:

```
My Drive
â”""â”€â”€ Adaeze Fashion
    â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Admin
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Invoices
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Receipts
    â”‚   â””â”""â”€â”€ Tax-and-Licences
    â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Designs
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Logos
    â”‚   â””â”""â”€â”€ Sketch-Photos
    â”œâ”€â”€ 03-Customers
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Orders
    â”‚   â””â”""â”€â”€ Measurements
    â”œâ”€â”€ 04-Marketing
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Flyers
    â”‚   â””â”""â”€â”€ Social-Media-Posts
    â””â""â”€â”€ 05-Archive
```

Why this works. Adaeze has a main folder named after the business. Inside it, five numbered areas cover everything she does: Admin (money paperwork), Designs (creative work), Customers (people and their orders), Marketing (selling), Archive (old stuff). Any new file has an obvious home. A shop assistant she hires tomorrow can guess the system.

A second, different scheme â€" organising by year. If your work is mostly per-year (school, church, yearly reports), you may prefer a date-first structure:

```
My Drive
â”""â”€â”€ Church-Office
    â”œâ”€â”€ 2025
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Services
    â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Events
    â”‚   â””â""â”€â”€ 03-Finance
    â””â""â”€â”€ 2026
        â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Services
        â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Events
        â””â""â”€â”€ 03-Finance
```

How to decide. Ask: "Do I mostly look for things by *what they are* (invoices, photos) or by *when they happened* (2025, 2026)?" Business admin usually goes by type; records and reports often go by year. Either is fine â€" the bad option is having no system at all.

How to create a folder in Drive (exact steps):

1. Click **+ New** (top-left).
2. Click **New folder**.
3. Type the name, e.g. `Adaeze Fashion`.
4. Click **Create**.
5. To make a subfolder, **double-click** the parent folder to open it, then repeat **+ New â†' New folder**.

To rename or recolour a folder: right-click it â†' **Rename**, or right-click â†' **Change color** and pick a label colour. Colour is only visual â€" it does not change who can access the folder â€" but a consistent colour scheme (red for urgent, green for money)

helps your eyes find things fast.

Common misconception. New users often create all folders at the top level, so *My Drive* becomes a cluttered list of twenty folders. Instead, group them: one business folder, with the categories inside it. The top level should have only a handful of big ideas.

Limitation to be honest about. There is no single "correct" structure that Google enforces; Drive does not stop you from making a mess. Your structure is only as good as your consistency in keeping it. The system collapses the moment you dump a file in the wrong place and stop caring.

F.4 File naming conventions

The idea. A naming convention is a rule you follow every time you name a file, so that the name itself tells you (and anyone else) exactly what the file is, when it was made, and which business it belongs to â€" without opening it.

Why it matters. The file name is the first and cheapest information you get. A name like `Document1.docx` forces you to open the file to find out what it is. A name like `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-001 - v1.pdf` tells you everything at a glance.

Familiar analogy â€" labelling jars in a kitchen. A good cook labels every jar: "Rice", "Beans", "Sugar â€" 2025". An unlabelled jar could be anything and risks a nasty surprise. File names are your labels.

The recommended CEA convention:

```
YYYY-MM-DD - ProjectName - Description - vN.ext
```

Break it down:

- `YYYY-MM-DD` â€" the date, written year first. `2026-10-09` means 9 October 2026. Writing the year first makes files sort in true chronological order when you sort by name; if you wrote `09-10-2026` they would sort by day, which scrambles them.
- `ProjectName` â€" the business or project, e.g. `AdaezeFashion`.
- `Description` â€" what the file actually is, e.g. `Invoice-001`, `Colour-Sketch`, `Customer-Feedback`.
- `vN` â€" the version number, e.g. `v1`, `v2`, `v3`. This replaces the chaotic `final`, `final2`, `final_final_FINAL_use-this-one`.
- `.ext` â€" the file extension, which the computer adds for you.

Worked examples:

- `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-001 - v1.pdf`
- `2026-10-12 - AdaezeFashion - Customer-Measurements-Ngozi - v2.xlsx`
- `2026-11-01 - ChurchOffice - Harvest-Programme-Flyer - v3.jpg`

Bad names and why:

Bad name	The problem
`Document1`	Tells you nothing. Which document? Whose? When?
`final_final_v3_really_final`	No date, no project, no meaning. A sign of chaos.
`New folder (2)`	Which one is the real one? You will never know.
`INVOICE`	No date, no client, no version â€" you cannot tell it from last month's invoice.
`ada's cv new version latest.docx`	Spaces and apostrophes are messy; "latest" means nothing in a month.

How to rename a file in Drive: right-click the file â†' **Rename** (or click the file, then use the three-dot **â‹®** menu â†' **Rename**), type the new name, press Enter.

Good habits to teach:

- Rename **immediately** when you create or upload a file. Never leave `Untitled` or `Document1`.
- Use **hyphens or underscores** instead of spaces where your tools allow, because some systems handle spaces badly in links and downloads. Hyphens are the CEA preference.
- Do not use these characters in a file name: `\ / : * ? " < > |`. Google Drive will reject or alter them.
- Keep version numbers increasing: v1, v2, v3. Never go backwards.

- Keep names reasonably short. A 90-character name is hard to read.

Common misconception. Learners think the date in the file name should be the date they *created* the file. Actually, it is more useful to use the date the file *is about* or is *due* â€" the date that helps you find it later. For an invoice dated 9 October, that is the invoice date. For an assignment due on 20 October, many people prefer the due date. Agree on one meaning and keep it consistent.

Limitation. A naming convention only pays off if the whole team follows it. If you are the only person in your business, you only have to convince yourself. If you have staff, write the rule down and put it on the wall.

F.5 Uploading files and folders

The idea. Uploading means copying a file **from your computer up to** Google Drive. After uploading, a copy exists in the cloud; the original still sits on your computer.

Two ways to upload:

Way 1 â€" the + New button (precise and safe):

1. Open the folder in Drive where the file should go (double-click into it).
2. Click **+ New** â†' **File upload** (for one or more files) or **+ New â†' Folder upload** (to upload a whole folder including what is inside it).
3. A Windows file-picker window opens. Navigate to `Desktop\CEA-Samples`.
4. Select the file(s) â€" hold `Ctrl` to select several at once â€" and click **Open**.
5. Watch the upload progress in the bottom-right corner. When it says **"# uploads complete"**, the files are in Drive.

Way 2 â€" drag and drop (fast and visual):

1. Arrange your windows so you can see both the Windows folder and the Google Drive browser window side by side.
2. Select files/folders in Windows and drag them onto the Drive window.
3. Release the mouse when Drive highlights. The upload begins.

Which way to teach first? The **+ New** button, because it is deliberate and easy to explain, and because with drag-and-drop learners often drop files into the wrong folder without noticing.

Familiar analogy. Uploading is like carrying a photocopy of a document to a safe deposit box in a bank across town. The original stays with you; a protected copy now lives elsewhere. If your house burns, the bank copy survives.

What "Move to" does (important). If you uploaded a file to the wrong place, do not panic and do not upload again. Right-click the file â†' **Move to** â†' choose the folder â†' **Move**. This relocates the file without making a duplicate.

Common misconception. Learners think uploading *moves* the file off their computer. It does not â€" it **copies**. This is actually a good thing: you now have the local copy and the cloud copy. But it also means new users can get confused about which copy is "the real one". Teach the habit: for work files, treat the Drive copy as the master and stop editing the Desktop copy.

Limitation / honest note. Uploading many large files (videos, big photo sets) can be slow and uses your data. The free 15 GB also fills up. For heavy media work, Google Drive is manageable for beginners but professionals use paid storage or video platforms.

F.6 Finding files quickly â€" search and filters

The idea. You should never scroll and hunt. You should **search**. A well-organised Drive plus a smart search finds almost anything in seconds.

Basic search. Click the **Search bar** at the top and type part of the file name or words from inside the file. Drive searches both file names and (for many file types) the text inside documents.

Advanced search operators. You can type special commands into the search bar. These are the most useful for beginners:

What you type	What it finds
`type:pdf`	Only PDF files (also `type:image`, `type:document`, `type:spreadsheet`)
`owner:me`	Only files you own

What you type	What it finds
`is:starred`	Only files you have starred
`is:trashed`	Files currently in the Trash
`from:adaeze@gmail.com`	Items shared by that person
`to:me`	Items shared with you
`modified:today`	Files changed today (`modified:2026-10-09` for a date)
`before:2026-10-01`	Files modified before that date
`title:invoice`	Files whose name contains "invoice"

Worked example â€" Adaeze finds a lost invoice. Adaeze needs the invoice she sent to a client last month. Instead of opening folder after folder, she clicks the search bar and types:

```
title:Invoice type:pdf modified:2026-09
```

Drive instantly lists all PDF invoices modified in September 2026. She opens the right one in under 10 seconds.

Filters (the visual alternative). If you prefer clicking to typing, click the small **filter icon** at the right end of the search bar. A panel appears letting you filter by **Type** (folder, document, PDF, imageâ€¦), **People** (owner), **Modified date**, **Location**, and **Shared to**. This does the same job as the operators, without memorising any.

Starring â€" your personal bookmark. Right-click a file â† ' **Add to Starred** (or open the file and click the star). Starred files appear under **Starred** in the left menu. Use it for the handful of files you open every day.

Say to the class:

> *"Remember the goal: **find any file within 30 seconds.** If you cannot, your structure or your naming is letting you down. Fix the structure once; save time every day."*

Common misconception. Learners search for a file they think they uploaded but cannot find it. Usually it was uploaded into the wrong folder, or it is still uploading, or it was never uploaded. Check **Recent** (shows newest activity) and the **upload progress** area.

F.7 Sharing files and folders â€" and the security lesson

The idea. Sharing lets another person open your file or folder, without you emailing a copy. They always see the latest version.

How to share a file (exact steps):

1. Right-click the file â† ' **Share** (or select it and click the **Share** button).
2. In the box that opens, type the person's **email address**.
3. Choose their **permission level** (see below).
4. Optionally add a short message.
5. Click **Send**. The person gets an email with a link.

How to share a folder: exactly the same, right-click the folder â† ' **Share**. Everything inside the folder is shared with those permissions â€" present and future.

The three permission levels â€" this is the heart of the lesson:

Level	What the person can do	Use it when
Viewer	Read and download only. Cannot change anything.	Sending a final invoice, a CV, a finished flyer.
Commenter	Read, and leave comments, but cannot edit the content.	Asking a colleague for feedback on a draft.

Level	What the person can do	Use it when
Editor	Read, comment, **and change or delete** the content.	Working together on the same document in real time.

The golden rule â€" least privilege. Give the **lowest** level of access that still lets the person do their job. If they only need to read, give **Viewer** â€" never Editor. This protects you from accidental or careless changes.

Link sharing, and the danger of "Anyone with the link". When you click **Share**, there is also a section usually called **General access**. It may say **Restricted** (only the people you list) or **Anyone with the link**. If you choose **Anyone with the link**, a warning appears that the file can be opened by anyone who has the URL â€" *even people outside the academy or outside Nigeria* â€" and they do not need to sign in.

Say this clearly and slowly:

> *"Listen well, because this causes real chaos. If you set a file to 'Anyone with the link' and you paste that link in a WhatsApp group, you have just published your file to the whole internet. Anyone â€" a competitor, a scammer, a stranger â€" can open your invoice, your customers' phone numbers, your bank statement. It does not matter that they were not invited. The link is the key."*
>
> *"So the rule is: use **Restricted** by default, and add people by email. Only ever use 'Anyone with the link' deliberately, for something truly public like a flyer you want the whole world to see â€" and even then, think twice."*

Worked example â€" sharing Adaeze's price list. Adaeze wants a customer, Mr. Okoro, to see her price list. She right-clicks `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Price-List - v1.pdf` â†' **Share** â†' types `mr.okoro@example.com` â†' sets **Viewer** â†' **Send**. Mr. Okoro can read the prices but cannot change them. If he needs to suggest a correction, she could switch him to **Commenter** instead. She should **not** make him an Editor, because then he could accidentally alter her prices.

Common misconceptions:

- "If I share as Editor, they can share it to others too." True â€" an Editor can often re-share, so be careful. When in doubt, Viewer.
- "If I remove the person, the file is safe." Removing access does stop new openings, but if the person already downloaded or copied the content, you cannot take it back. Share deliberately the first time.
- "Shared with me means it is my file." No â€" as in Section F.2, that file belongs to someone else. Copy it if you need it.

Limitation. Once a file is out, it is out. Cloud sharing is powerful but it removes the friction that used to protect you. Think before you click **Send**.

F.8 Summary of the lecture

- **Cloud storage** = files on Google's computers, reachable from anywhere, safer than a single local machine.
- The Drive screen has: **My Drive**, **Shared with me**, **Recent**, **Starred**, **Trash**, the **+ New** button and the **Search bar**.
- Build a **shallow, numbered, predictable folder structure** â€" no more than 2â€"3 levels.
- Name every file with the `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1` convention.
- **Upload** with **+ New â†' File upload** or drag-and-drop, then use **Move to** to put files right.
- **Find** with search operators like `type:pdf`, `is:starred`, `owner:me`; use **Starred** and folder **colours** for quick visual access.
- **Share** with **Viewer / Commenter / Editor**, always using **least privilege**. Beware **"Anyone with the link"**.
- **Trash** keeps deleted files for about **30 days** â€" your safety net.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A logged-in Google account on the projector machine, already at `drive.google.com`.
- A clean starting state: an empty *My Drive* (or a clearly separate folder you will delete afterwards) so learners watch a structure grow from nothing.

- The 20 sample files on the projector machine in `Desktop\CEA-Samples`.
- A second email address (a colleague's, or a spare academy address such as `cea.assessment@gmail.com`) for the sharing demonstration.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" the interface tour (3 minutes)

Say: "Watch my screen. I am going to point at the five places you must know."

1. Click **My Drive**. Say: "My personal space."
2. Click **Shared with me**. Say: "Other people's files, shared to me. Not my backup."
3. Click **Recent**. Say: "What I opened last."
4. Click **Starred**. Say: "My bookmarks."
5. Click **Trash**. Say: "My bin â€" 30 days to change my mind."
6. Point at **+ New** and the **Search bar**. Say: "Create here; find here."

Question to ask: *"Which of these is a place you should never store your only copy?"* â†' **Shared with me** (it belongs to someone else).

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" build a structure and upload (6 minutes)

Say: "Now we build Adaeze Fashion's Drive from scratch."

1. Click **+ New â†' New folder**. Type `Adaeze Fashion`. Click **Create**.
2. **Double-click** `Adaeze Fashion` to open it.
3. Repeat **+ New â†' New folder** five times to create: `01-Admin`, `02-Designs`, `03-Customers`, `04-Marketing`, `05-Archive`.
4. Double-click `01-Admin`; create `Invoices`, `Receipts`. Say: "This is a subfolder â€" level two."
5. Go back to **My Drive**. Click **+ New â†' File upload**, navigate to `Desktop\CEA-Samples`, select `Invoice-001.pdf` and `Invoice-002.pdf`, click **Open**. Point at the upload progress. Say: "These landed in My Drive â€" the wrong place on purpose."
6. Now **right-click** `Invoice-001.pdf` â†' **Move to** â†' `Adaeze Fashion` â†' `01-Admin` â†' `Invoices`. Click **Move**.
7. **Deliberately rename badly first:** rename `Invoice-002.pdf` to `Document1`. Ask the class: *"What is wrong with this name?"* Then rename it to `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-002 - v1.pdf`. Say: "That is a name you can trust."

Mistakes to watch and correct:

- Learner double-clicks *into* a folder by mistake and creates a nested folder in the wrong place â†' teach them to check the breadcrumb at the top.
- Learner drags a file into the Drive window but onto the wrong folder â†' show **Move to** to fix it.
- Learner uploads the same file twice â†' show that duplicates waste storage; use search before uploading.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" share safely (3 minutes)

Say: "Watch how sharing works â€" and how one wrong click is dangerous."

1. Right-click `04-Marketing` â†' **Share**.
2. Type the spare email `cea.assessment@gmail.com`.
3. Set the role dropdown to **Viewer**. Click **Send**.
4. Tell the class the recipient can read but not change anything.
5. Now click **Share** again and point at the **General access** section. Click the dropdown to show **Anyone with the link**. **Read the warning aloud.** Then set it **back to Restricted**. Say: "Always come back to Restricted."

Question to ask: *"If Mr. Okoro only needs to read my price list, which permission do I give?"* â†' **Viewer**, not Editor.

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" search, star and recover (3 minutes)

1. Click the **Search bar**, type `type:pdf`, press Enter. Point out that only PDFs are listed.
2. Clear it, type `owner:me is:starred`. Say: "Show me my star."
3. Right-click `Invoice-001.pdf` â†' **Add to Starred**. Then click **Starred** in the left menu and show it there.
4. Right-click a file â†' **Remove**. Say: "It is in the bin, not dead." Open **Trash**, right-click the file â†' **Restore**. Say: "30 days. Never empty the Trash in a panic."

Expected results are all shown live; the key learning is that nothing here is destructive and everything is reversible (until the Trash is emptied).

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner builds their own organised Drive structure for a fictional business and organises 20 sample files.

Starting materials: A logged-in Google account on each machine; the 20 sample files in `Desktop\CEA-Samples`; the learner's name for the folder title.

Scenario: You have just been hired as the office administrator for *Adaeze Fashion*, a growing tailoring and clothing business in Port Harcourt. Adaeze has 20 files dumped on the office desktop. Your job: build her a proper Drive.

Procedure (the instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; the instructor walks the room):

1. Go to `drive.google.com` in Chrome. Confirm you are logged in.
2. Click **+ New â†' New folder**. Name it `Adaeze Fashion - [Your Name]` (so your copy does not clash with anyone else's). Press **Create**.
3. **Double-click** your new folder to open it.
4. Create five subfolders: `01-Admin`, `02-Designs`, `03-Customers`, `04-Marketing`, `05-Archive`.
5. Open `01-Admin` and create two subfolders: `Invoices`, `Receipts`.
6. Open `03-Customers` and create two subfolders: `Orders`, `Measurements`.
7. Go back out to *My Drive*. Click **+ New â†' File upload**, and upload **all 20** sample files from `Desktop\CEA-Samples`. **Pause and predict:** "*Where will these 20 files land â€" in my Adaeze folder or loose in My Drive?*" (Answer: loose in My Drive â€" you uploaded from the top level.)
8. Now **move** each file into the correct folder using **right-click â†' Move to**:
   - `Invoice-001.pdf`, `Invoice-002.pdf` â†' `01-Admin â†' Invoices`
   - `Receipt-Mile1.jpg`, `Receipt-Mile3.jpg` â†' `01-Admin â†' Receipts`
   - `Bank-Statement-Sept.pdf`, `Tax-Receipt.pdf` â†' `01-Admin`
   - `Logo-draft.png`, `Logo-final.png`, `Product-Photo-Ankara-1.jpg`, `Product-Photo-Ankara-2.jpg` â†' `02-Designs`
   - `Customer-Measurements-Adaeze.xlsx`, `Customer-Measurements-Ngozi.xlsx` â†' `03-Customers â†' Measurements`
   - `Order-Emeka.csv`, `Order-Funmi.csv`, `Customer-Feedback-Form.docx` â†' `03-Customers â†' Orders`
   - `Flyer-August.jpg`, `Flyer-September.jpg`, `Social-Media-Calendar.docx`, `Supplier-Contacts.xlsx`, `Price-List.txt` â†' `04-Marketing`
9. **Pause and predict:** "*Which folder got the most files?*" (Marketing and Designs are busy.)
10. **Rename at least 5 files** using the convention. Examples:
    - `Invoice-001.pdf` â†' `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-001 - v1.pdf`
    - `Logo-final.png` â†' `2026-09-30 - AdaezeFashion - Logo-Final - v2.png`
    - `Flyer-August.jpg` â†' `2026-08-15 - AdaezeFashion - Flyer-August - v1.jpg`
11. **Star** two important files (e.g. the Logo-final and Supplier-Contacts).
12. **Share** your `04-Marketing` folder with the instructor's assessment email as **Viewer**.
13. Use the **Search bar** and type `type:pdf`. **Pause and predict:** "*How many PDFs should appear?*" (Invoice-001, Invoice-002, Bank-Statement, Tax-Receipt = 4, plus any you uploaded.)
14. Prove you can find a file in **under 30 seconds**: search `title:Logo`, open it, and note the time.

Expected result: A folder `Adaeze Fashion - [Your Name]` containing five numbered folders, two levels where relevant, with all 20 files moved to sensible places, at least 5 files renamed to the convention, 2 files starred, Marketing shared as Viewer, and a successful search.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Files not appearing after upload â†' check the **upload progress** area; wait for "uploads complete". Big JPGs can be slow.
- File in the wrong folder â†' use **Move to** (never re-upload).
- Shared folder shows as Editor to the recipient â†' change the role in **Share** back to Viewer.

- Search returns nothing â†' the file may be named differently than you remember; try a shorter word.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Folder `Adaeze Fashion - [Your Name]` exists
- ☐ Five numbered subfolders created
- ☐ At least two sub-subfolders created
- ☐ All 20 sample files uploaded
- ☐ All 20 files moved into correct folders
- ☐ At least 5 files renamed with the convention
- ☐ Two files starred
- ☐ Marketing folder shared as **Viewer**
- ☐ Found one file by search in under 30 seconds

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Build a Drive structure for a **different** fictional business and organise a small set of files on your own, without copying the instructor's Adaeze example layout.

Scenario: You are the new secretary at *Grace Chapel*, a small church in Rumuola, Port Harcourt. The church office has a messy Google Drive. The pastor has asked you to set up a clean structure for the new year, 2026.

Requirements:

1. Create a top-level folder named `Grace Chapel - [Your Name]`.
2. Inside it, design a folder structure of at least **five folders**. You choose the categories, but they must suit a church office (think: services, events, finance, members, media). Use numbered prefixes for sort order.
3. Include at least **two nested subfolders** somewhere in your structure.
4. Create at least **three sample files** inside the folders (you may create blank Google Docs to stand in for files, or copy from `CEA-Samples`). Give each file a proper name using the convention `YYYY-MM-DD - GraceChapel - Description - v1`.
5. **Share** one folder as **Commenter** with the instructor's assessment email (a Commenter can suggest, but not silently change, the church's files).
6. **Star** one file you consider most important.
7. Prove you can find a file in under 30 seconds using any search operator you learned.

Constraints:

- Your structure must be **logical and shallow** â€" no folder more than three levels deep.
- At least one file must be renamed from a bad name like `Document1` into the convention.
- Do **not** use "Anyone with the link" anywhere.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- A top-level folder with at least 5 numbered folders exists.
- At least 2 nested subfolders exist.
- At least 3 correctly named files exist in sensible folders.
- One folder is shared as **Commenter** (not Editor, not Viewer unless justified).
- One file is starred.
- A search returned the target file in under 30 seconds.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: A church structure could be `01-Services`, `02-Events`, `03-Finance`, `04-Members`, `05-Media`. Put `01-Services/Sunday-Bulletins` and `03-Finance/2026-Receipts` as your nested folders.
- Hint 2: To create a blank Google Doc as a stand-in file, click **+ New â†' Google Docs**, type a word, then click the document title at the top-left to rename it, and it auto-saves to your current Drive location.

- Hint 3: To share as Commenter, click the **Share** button, and change the dropdown beside the email from Editor to **Commenter**.

Instructor answer key (do not show learners):

Example structure that satisfies the brief:

```
Grace Chapel - [Name]
â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Services
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Sunday-Bulletins
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Sermon-Notes
â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Events
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ 2026-Programmes
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Photos
â”œâ”€â”€ 03-Finance
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ 2026-Receipts
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ 2026-Expenses
â”œâ”€â”€ 04-Members
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Contact-List
â””â”€â”€ 05-Media
```

Example correctly named files:

- `2026-10-09 - GraceChapel - Invitation-Letter - v1`
- `2026-10-12 - GraceChapel - Sunday-Bulletin - v1`
- `2026-10-15 - GraceChapel - Harvest-Budget - v1`

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Top-level folder with 5+ numbered folders (2)
- Two nested subfolders present (2)
- Three files named to the convention (2)
- Files placed in correct/sensible folders (1)
- Folder shared as Commenter correctly (2)
- One file starred and search proven (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Chinedu* runs *Chinedu Electronics*, a phone-accessory shop near Garrison in Port Harcourt. He has two staff and keeps sales records, supplier invoices, warranty cards and customer contact lists. Until now, everything has lived on one office desktop computer, with a weekly copy onto a flash drive that stays in the office drawer.

Relevant facts.

- Last rainy season, water came through the roof and soaked the drawer. The flash drive survived but Chinedu panicked.
- His accountant needs the monthly invoices, but Chinedu has to copy them to a flash drive and physically carry them across town.
- A customer once claimed a warranty, and Chinedu could not find the original receipt because it had been saved as `scan1.pdf` and was lost among hundreds of files.
- He has a smartphone with internet but no laptop of his own.

Decision point. Should Chinedu (a) keep doing what he is doing, (b) move everything to Google Drive with a proper folder structure and naming, or (c) buy a second external hard drive and keep two local backups?

Possible approaches and trade-offs.

1. **Stay local, add a second flash drive.** Cheap and familiar, but both copies still live in the same shop, exposed to the same fire, flood and theft. Finds are still slow because naming is chaotic. *Trade-off: lowest cost, highest risk.*
2. **Move to Google Drive with structure and naming.** Free, reachable from his phone, safe from shop disasters, and shareable with the accountant by link. Requires a little learning and internet. *Trade-off: small learning effort today, big daily time savings and safety.*

3. **Two external drives kept in two locations.** Safer than one, but still manual, still not shareable instantly, still requires copying for the accountant, and still relies on nobody forgetting to update the backup. *Trade-off: better than one drive, but no access-anywhere and no easy sharing.*

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2, with a small nod to approach 3: move the working records to Google Drive, organised as below, and keep one offline copy of the *most critical* financial records as a printed or external backup elsewhere. This matches exactly the skills learned today.

```
Chinedu Electronics
â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Finance
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Invoices
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Supplier-Receipts
â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Customers
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Contacts
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Warranty-Cards
â”œâ”€â”€ 03-Products
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Price-Lists
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Product-Photos
â””â”€â”€ 04-Staff
```

Every file named `YYYY-MM-DD - ChinéduElectronics - Description - v1`. The `02-Customers/Contacts` folder shared with the accountant as **Viewer** when needed.

Trade-offs of the recommendation. Chinedu must have internet when he wants to open files (though offline access can be enabled), and he must actually follow the naming rule. If he half-follows it, he is back where he started. The system only works if it is used consistently.

Professional connection. This is exactly what an office administrator, a small-business manager or a personal assistant does daily. The skill of turning a chaotic pile of files into a safe, findable, shareable drive is one of the most employable digital skills. When an employer asks "are you organised?", this is what they mean â€” and now Chinedu (and the learner) can answer with a system, not just a promise.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this as the session's live troubleshooting guide. When a learner is stuck, do not give the answer immediately â€” point them to the relevant row and ask them to check.

K.1 Everything is dumped in My Drive with no folders

Symptoms: Dozens of loose files at the top level; nothing is grouped. **Likely cause:** Learner uploads without first opening the destination folder, or does not believe folders are necessary. **How to investigate:** Look at the top level; count the loose files. **Corrective steps:** Create the folder structure, then **select several files** (Ctrl-click), right-click â†' **Move to** the folder. **How to confirm resolved:** The top level shows only a few folders, not files. **Prevention:** The habit "open the folder *before* you upload".

K.2 Bad file names â€" `Document1`, `Untitled`, `final_final`

Symptoms: Files that mean nothing without opening them. **Likely cause:** No naming convention applied; learner in a hurry. **Corrective steps:** Right-click each file â†' **Rename** into `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1`. **Prevention:** Rename at the moment of creation; keep the cheat sheet visible.

K.3 Over-sharing: everything set to Editor or "Anyone with the link"

Symptoms: A recipient can delete files; or a link is open to the whole internet. **Likely cause:** Default role left as Editor; General access left as "Anyone with the link". **How to investigate:** Open **Share** on the file/folder and read the role and General access setting. **Corrective steps:** Change role to **Viewer** or **Commenter**; set General access back to **Restricted**; remove any unintended people. **How to confirm resolved:** The Share panel shows only the intended people, at the correct roles, with General access "Restricted". **Prevention:** The least-privilege rule; the Visual warning is there for a reason â€" read it.

K.4 "I cannot find my file"

Symptoms: A learner insists a file exists but cannot locate it. **Likely causes:** (a) It uploaded to the wrong folder. (b) It is still uploading. (c) It was never uploaded. (d) It was moved to Trash. **How to investigate:** Click **Recent**; check **Trash**; use search

`title:`; check the upload progress area. **Corrective steps:** Use **Move to** to put it right; **Restore** from Trash if needed; re-upload if it never arrived. **Prevention:** Confirm "uploads complete"; file immediately after upload.

K.5 The recipient did not receive the share email

Symptoms: You shared a file but the person says they got nothing. **Likely causes:** (a) Wrong email typed. (b) The email went to their Spam folder. (c) The person is signed into a different Google account. **How to investigate:** Re-open **Share** and check the exact email; ask them to check Spam; ask which account they signed in with. **Corrective steps:** Correct the email, resend; ask them to search "in:anywhere" in Gmail or check Spam. **Prevention:** Double-check the address before clicking Send.

K.6 Duplicate files everywhere

Symptoms: The same invoice appears three times. **Likely cause:** Re-uploading instead of moving or copying. **Corrective steps:** Keep one master; delete the duplicates (they go to Trash); use **Make a copy** only when you genuinely need a new independent copy. **Prevention:** Search before you upload.

K.7 Storage is full

Symptoms: A message says storage is full; uploads fail. **Likely cause:** Too many large videos/ photos, or a full Gmail, filling the shared 15 GB. **How to investigate:** Click **Storage** in the left menu to see what is using the space. **Corrective steps:** Empty the **Trash** (it counts toward storage); delete large unwanted files; or upgrade to a paid plan if genuinely needed. **Prevention:** Keep media files lean; empty the Trash monthly.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: For every row above, the *likely* cause becomes a *confirmed* cause only after you check it â€" see the exact role in the Share panel, see the file in Trash, see the upload progress. Teach learners to **confirm before they fix**, so they solve the real problem, not a guessed one.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Organised Drive"

Purpose: To prove you can independently design a folder structure, apply a naming convention, organise real files, share with the correct permission, and find any file quickly â€" the core skills of the Week 1 mini-project.

Realistic scenario: A client has hired you as a virtual assistant. Their small business, *Naija Kitchen*, sells local food and has a messy Google Drive. They want you to set it up properly so they can find anything instantly and share what they choose.

Detailed instructions:

1. Create a top-level folder named `Naija Kitchen - [Your Full Name]`.
2. Design a folder structure with **five or more folders**, using numbered prefixes. Categories should suit a food business (e.g. `01-Menu`, `02-Orders`, `03-Suppliers`, `04-Finance`, `05-Marketing`, `06-Staff`). Include at least **two nested subfolders**.
3. Upload or create **20 files** inside the correct folders, including at least: 3 invoices/receipts, 3 customer orders, 3 menu or price documents, 3 photos, and a mix of others. (You may use the 20 samples from class or create your own.)
4. **Rename at least 8 files** using the convention `YYYY-MM-DD - NaijaKitchen - Description - v1`.
5. **Share one folder** as **Viewer** with the academy assessment email, and **one different folder** as **Commenter**. Do not use "Anyone with the link" anywhere.
6. **Star exactly two** files.
7. Write a **short paragraph (5â€"8 lines)** in your workbook explaining your structure: why you chose those folders, how your naming works, and what permission you used and why.

Required deliverables:

- A shared link to your `Naija Kitchen - [Your Full Name]` folder (set to **Restricted**, with the assessment email added).
- A screenshot or list of your folder structure (you may use the Details pane or simply list it).
- Your workbook paragraph.

Submission format: Paste the folder link and your paragraph into the class submission document, or hand the written paragraph to the instructor and share the folder link by email.

Deadline: Before Session 2 (Email Management)

Marking rubric (25 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Folder structure	5	5+ numbered folders, logical, shallow (max 3 levels), with 2+ nested subfolders
File naming convention	5	8+ files follow `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1`; clear and consistent
Organisation	5	All 20 files sit in correct, sensible folders
Sharing and permissions	5	Viewer and Commenter used correctly; nothing set to "Anyone with the link"
Completeness and explanation	5	All required file types present; clear workbook paragraph explaining the system

Common mistakes to avoid: dumping files in *My Drive*; using `Document1`-style names; sharing as Editor by default; forgetting the nested subfolders; leaving General access on "Anyone with the link".

Instructor reference solution:

```
Naija Kitchen - [Name]
â”œâ”€â”€ 01-Menu
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Price-Lists
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Recipe-Cards
â”œâ”€â”€ 02-Orders
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ 2026-October
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Completed
â”œâ”€â”€ 03-Suppliers
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Contacts
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Supplier-Invoices
â”œâ”€â”€ 04-Finance
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Receipts
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Bank-Statements
â”œâ”€â”€ 05-Marketing
â”‚   â”œâ”€â”€ Flyers
â”‚   â””â”€â”€ Social-Media
â””â”€â”€ 06-Staff
    â”œâ”€â”€ Contacts
    â””â”€â”€ Schedules
```

Example file names: `2026-10-09 - NaijaKitchen - Invoice-001 - v1.pdf`, `2026-10-10 - NaijaKitchen - Menu-October - v2.pdf`, `2026-10-11 - NaijaKitchen - Order-Emeka - v1.csv`. A model workbook paragraph: *"I chose six folders because a food business deals with menu, orders, suppliers, money, marketing and staff. I numbered them so they sort in the order I use them. My files start with the date, then 'NaijaKitchen', then what the file is. I shared Menu as Viewer because suppliers only need to read prices, and Orders as Commenter so staff can add notes without deleting records."*

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key that follows.)

Q1. Short answer. In one or two sentences, what is cloud storage, and how is it different from storing files only on your own computer?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which permission lets a person **comment on but not edit** your document? a) Viewer b) Commenter c) Editor d) Owner

Q3. Explain in your own words. Why is the folder structure rule "shallow, numbered and predictable" important? Give one consequence of ignoring it.

Q4. Practical identification. Write the correct permission (Viewer / Commenter / Editor) for each situation: a) Sending your final invoice to a customer. b) Asking a colleague to suggest corrections on a draft flyer. c) Working together with a partner on the same budget at the same time.

Q5. Error detection. A learner shares a file and chooses **Anyone with the link**, then posts the link in a busy public WhatsApp group. What is the danger, and how should they fix it?

Q6. Scenario. Adaeze needs to find all PDF invoices she created in September 2026. Write a Drive search that would help, and name one other way she could narrow the search without typing an operator.

Q7. Short answer. How long does Google Drive keep a deleted file in the Trash, and how would you recover it?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q7)

A1. Cloud storage means files are saved on Google's computers (servers) and reached over the internet, so they are accessible from any device and survive if one computer is lost or damaged. Local storage keeps files on one machine only, where they are lost if it is stolen or breaks, and are hard to share.

A2. (b) Commenter.

A3. Shallow (2â€“3 levels) keeps navigation fast; numbered prefixes keep folders in a chosen order; predictability means anyone can guess where a file belongs. Ignoring it leads to a maze of folders or a pile of loose files, so finding a file takes minutes instead of seconds.

A4. a) Viewer; b) Commenter; c) Editor.

A5. The danger is that anyone who has the link â€” including strangers, competitors and scammers â€” can open the file; the link effectively publishes it. To fix it: open **Share**, change **General access** back to **Restricted**, then share explicitly by email to the intended people at the right permission level. (Note: if someone already downloaded it, you cannot fully take it back â€” hence foresight matters.)

A6. A search such as `title:Invoice type:pdf modified:2026-09` (accept `type:pdf before:2026-10-01 after:2026-08-31` or similar). Alternative: click the **filter** icon at the right of the search bar and choose **Type = PDF** and a **Modified date** range in September 2026.

A7. About **30 days**. Recover it by opening **Trash** in the left menu, right-clicking the file and choosing **Restore**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that your files do not have to live dangerously on one computer. You met Google Drive, free cloud storage tied to your Gmail account, and you learned the five parts of the screen that matter: My Drive, Shared with me, Recent, Starred and Trash. You built a shallow, numbered folder structure for a fictional business, gave files clean names with the `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1` convention, uploaded and moved 20 files into place, shared a folder with the correct permission, learned the danger of "Anyone with the link", and found files quickly with search. You also learned that a deleted file lives in the Trash for about 30 days before it is gone for good.

Five important takeaways:

1. Cloud storage keeps your files on Google's computers so they survive theft, fire and computer failure â€” and are reachable anywhere.
2. A good folder structure is shallow, numbered and predictable; the top level should hold a few big ideas, not dozens of loose files.
3. Name every file `YYYY-MM-DD - Project - Description - v1` â€” never `Document1` or `final_final`.
4. Share with **least privilege**: Viewer to read, Commenter to review, Editor to co-edit. Keep General access on **Restricted**.
5. Use search (`type:pdf`, `owner:me`, `is:starred`) and the Starred list to find anything in under 30 seconds.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain cloud storage to a friend using an analogy?
- Can I build a five-folder structure with subfolders without help?
- Can I rename a messy file into a clean, dated name?
- Can I share a folder as Viewer and explain why not as Editor?
- Can I find a specific file using a search operator in under 30 seconds?

Connection to the next session. You now have a safe, organised home for all your files. But think about your email inbox â€” it is probably the other place where things get lost, buried under junk and newsletters. Next session we take the same organising mindset to **Gmail**: labels, filters, inbox zero, templates and signatures, so a client's order never gets buried again.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner opens `drive.google.com` and names the five main parts without prompting.
- The learner creates a folder structure with logic they can explain ("this folder is for money matters").
- The learner renames a `Document1` file into the convention on the first try.
- The learner chooses Viewer for a read-only share and can say *why* not Editor.
- The learner finds a file by search in under 30 seconds.
- The learner reacts to the "Anyone with the link" warning with caution rather than confusion.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Files in Shared with me are backed up in my Drive." â†' They are not; make a copy if you need them.
- "Uploading moves the file off my computer." â†' It copies; the original stays.
- "Editor is the friendliest option, so I always use it." â†' Use least privilege; Editor can change or delete.
- "If the internet is off, my files are lost." â†' They are safe on Google's servers; you just cannot reach them right now.
- "The date in the name is when I made the file." â†' It is usually more useful as the date the file is about or is due; agree on a meaning.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Sort-the-files drill:** give a printed list of 10 files and 4 folders; ask the learner to draw lines showing where each file goes.
2. **Name-fixer drill:** give 8 bad file names; ask the learner to rewrite each in the convention.
3. **Permission-sorting drill:** give 10 sharing situations; ask which permission (Viewer/Commenter/Editor) is right for each.
4. **Search drill:** give three "find this file" tasks and have the learner write the search operator for each.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** Provide the folder structure on a printed card and a partially completed Drive; the learner only uploads and moves the files and renames five.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** Add colour-coding to the top folders by purpose, set up **offline access** for one folder, and write a one-page "Drive Use Policy" for a fictional business explaining the naming rule and the sharing rule.

Timing guidance: If the room is slow or the Wi-Fi is weak, reduce the file upload to 10 files (keep the structure and naming), shorten the case study (Section J) to a 2-minute mention, and protect the guided practical (Section H) â€" the practical is the priority. Do not sacrifice Section F.7 (sharing security): that is the single most important safety lesson in the session.

APPENDIX 1A â€" 15-MINUTE DESKTOP REFRESHER (only if needed)

Run this before Section D only if learners cannot create or save a folder on the computer.

1. Right-click an empty part of the Desktop â†' **New** â†' **Folder**. Name it `test`. Press Enter.
2. Double-click `test` to open it. Right-click inside â†' **New** â†' **Text Document**. Name it `hello`. Type some words. Press `Ctrl + S` to save.
3. Go up one level (click the Back arrow) and note that `test` contains `hello.txt`.
4. Drag `hello.txt` onto the Desktop. Note that moving a file changes its location (its path).
5. Conclude: "A folder is a container; a file lives inside a folder; the path is the route to it. Cloud storage keeps the same ideas but the folders live online."

Confirm each learner can create a folder, save a file, and state a file's location before proceeding.

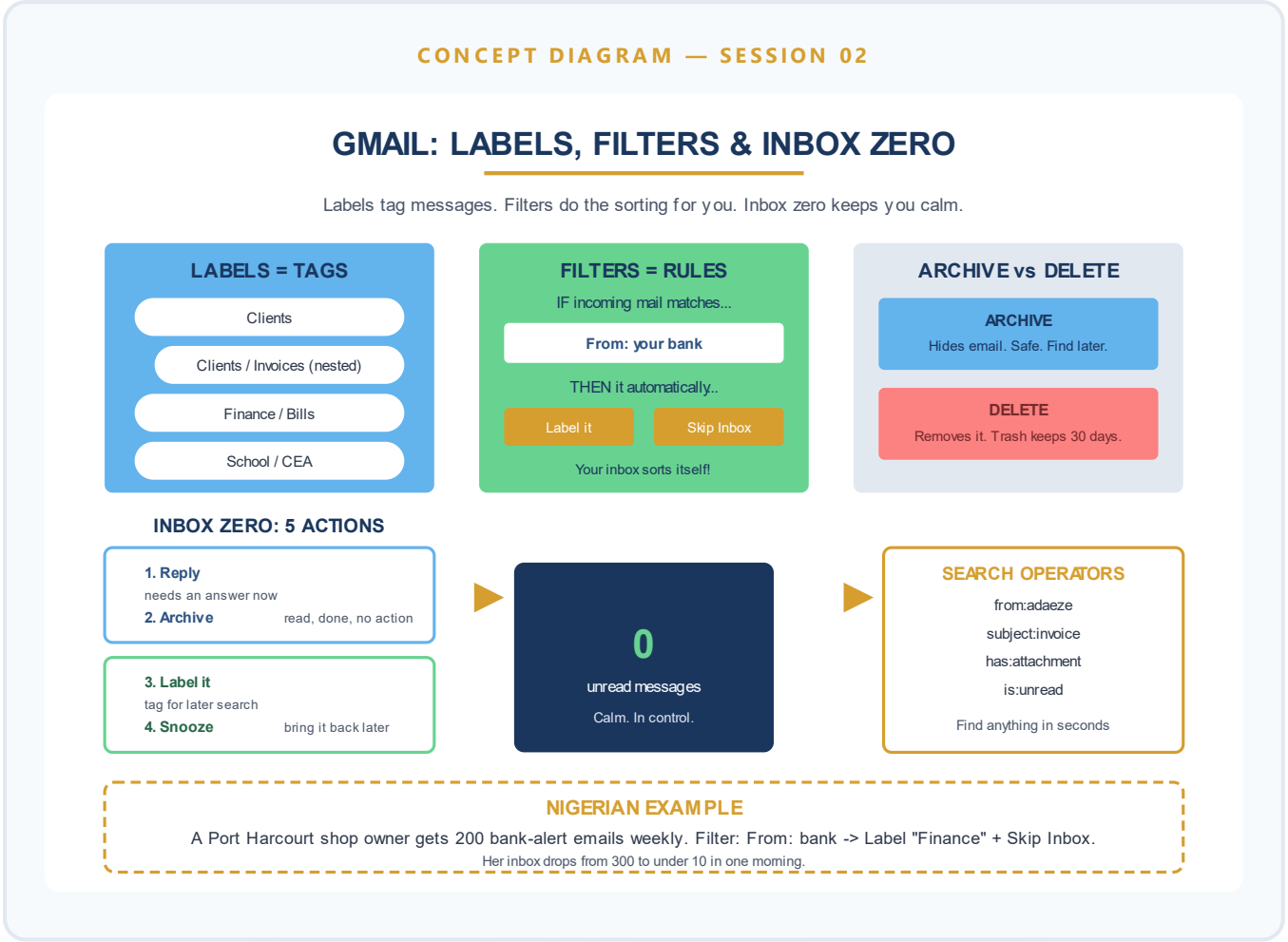
END OF SESSION 1

Next: Session 2 â€" Email Management with Gmail.

SESSION 02 OF 6

Gmail Management

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 02



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 2 â€" EMAIL MANAGEMENT WITH GMAIL

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	2 of 6
Session title	Email Management with Gmail
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (builds on the organisation mindset of Session 1)
Prerequisite knowledge	Session 1 (Google Drive and File Organisation). Learners must be able to log into a Google account, name and organise files, and share with Viewer/Commenter/Editor. They must also be

Item	Detail
	able to send a basic email.
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 we organised files in Drive. Email is the other great source of digital clutter â€" most people's inboxes are a dumping ground. This session applies the same "structure, naming, least privilege" thinking to email, so a client's order never gets buried under 2000 unread messages.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged in; Chrome open; every learner logged into Gmail; the instructor has prepared a **practice inbox** â€" either a shared demo account filled with about 12 fake emails (see Section C), or a set of sample email screenshots; the email-template examples and label-structure handout printed; projector connected; internet working.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain in their own words** why an organised inbox matters, and describe the cost of an inbox left in chaos.
2. **Navigate the Gmail interface** â€" Inbox, Starred, Snoozed, Sent, Drafts, Spam, Trash, the Compose button, the category tabs (Primary, Social, Promotions, Updates, Forums) and the search bar.
3. **Create labels**, including **nested labels** (e.g. `Clients/Invoices`), and apply them to messages.
4. **Create a filter** that automatically labels, archives, stars or marks incoming mail, and explain what each filter action does.
5. **Apply the inbox-zero strategy** â€" process each email using archive, delete, reply, label or snooze â€" and clear a practice inbox to near zero.
6. **Search Gmail effectively** using operators such as `from:`, `subject:`, `has:attachment` and `is:unread`.
7. **Distinguish** between archiving, deleting and trashing an email, and explain when each is appropriate.
8. **Create a professional signature** and **save an email template** (Templates feature).
9. **Schedule an email** to send later, and **snooze** an email to return at a chosen time.
10. **Explain the difference between Gmail labels and folders**, and why labels are more flexible.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with a working mouse/keyboard.
- Instructor computer connected to the projector.

Software

- Google Chrome (any recent version).
- Gmail â€" a **free** web service. No installation and no payment.

Accounts

- Every learner needs a working Gmail account. This is free. If a learner has only ever used the Gmail app on a phone, that is fine â€" today we use the browser version so we can see all the settings.

Practice inbox (prepared by the instructor)

- The instructor sets up a **demo/practice Gmail account** (or gives each learner a known set of test emails sent to their own account) containing roughly 12 fictional messages, for example:
    1. A Jumia-style promotional email (`noreply@shop.example`).
    2. A bank transaction alert (`alerts@bank.example`).
    3. A genuine client order enquiry titled "Request for 3 Ankara gowns".
    4. A scholarship/deadline reminder titled "Application deadline approaching".
    5. A newsletter from a news site.

6. An email with a large PDF attachment (`has:attachment`).
7. An unread school/assignment email.
8. A receipt from an online payment.
9. A social-media notification (`noreply@social.example`).
10. A supplier price list from a real business contact.
11. A spam message (or one pre-marked as spam).
12. A personal email from a friend.

- **Alternative if a shared account is not practical:** the instructor demonstrates on the projector using their own demo account, and learners perform the same actions on their own real inboxes (which is actually more useful, because it is their real clutter).

Worksheets / printed materials

- Handout 2.1 â€" "Label Structure Example" (one per learner).
- Handout 2.2 â€" "Email Template Examples" (a client follow-up and an introduction template).
- Gmail Search Operators Cheat Sheet (one per learner).
- Worksheet 2.3 â€" "Design My Labels" (in the learner workbook, Part 3).

Tools

- Gmail in the browser â€" `mail.google.com` .
- Optional: Google Tasks and Google Keep side panels (introduced, not required).

Internet

- **Required.** Gmail is a cloud service.

Alternative for learners who prefer Microsoft

- Microsoft Outlook.com (free with a Microsoft account) offers folders (instead of labels), rules (instead of filters) and quick parts/templates. The concepts are identical; only the names change. Learners may follow along in Outlook.com if they strongly prefer it, but the instructor demonstrates in Gmail as standard.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: On the projector, show a screenshot (or the live demo account) of an inbox with a large number of unread messages â€" something like **2,347 unread**. You can make this yourself by sending many test emails, or use a realistic mock screenshot. Do not show a neat inbox; show the chaos.

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at this inbox. Two thousand, three hundred and forty-seven unread emails. Tell me â€" if a customer sent you an order this morning, could you find it in here? [Pause.] No. It is buried.*
>
> *Let me tell you what happens to real people. Mr. Eze runs a small business. He uses one Gmail for everything â€" bank alerts, church announcements, Jumia adverts, school notices, supplier price lists, and real customer orders. All in one pile. One day, a big customer emails to place a large order. But Mr. Eze is busy; the email sits, unread, under a hundred promotions. Three days later the customer gets tired, and takes the business to someone else. Mr. Eze never even knew he had lost the order.*
>
> *The problem was not that Mr. Eze was lazy. The problem is that his email had **no system**. Today, you will build a system so that a client order is never lost again. You will learn labels, filters, search, templates, signatures â€" the same idea as organising your Drive, but for your inbox."*

Expected learner response: Learners may laugh nervously, admit their own inbox is the same, or describe a time they missed something important. Accept all answers. Connect their stories back to the theme: it is not about being tidy for tidiness's sake â€" it is about **not losing money or opportunities**.

Quick hook â€" demonstrate search: On the projector, in the demo account, click the search bar and type `is:unread subject:order` and press Enter. Show how the invisible order pops out of the noise instantly. Say:

> *"In 5 seconds, we found what a scrolling person would miss in 20 minutes. By the end of today, you will know how to do that and much more."*

Why this opener works: It starts from a pain every learner recognises (an overflowing inbox) and attaches a real consequence (a lost customer) that matters in the Nigerian small-business context. It ends with a live "wow" moment â€” search cutting through the noise â€” that motivates the rest of the session.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "From Session 1 â€” what is the difference between local storage and cloud storage?"

- Expected answer: Local files live on one computer; cloud files live on Google's servers and can be reached from any device with internet.
- Common gap: learners may describe cloud as "saving online" without the safety idea. Re-state that cloud means the file survives even if the computer dies.

Question 2: "What does least privilege mean when sharing, and which permission should you use to let someone read but not change a file?"

- Expected answer: Give the lowest access that still allows the job; use **Viewer** to read only.
- Common gap: learners default to Editor. Remind them: Viewer to read, Commenter to review, Editor to co-edit.

Question 3: "Why do we name files with `YYYY-MM-DD` at the front?"

- Expected answer: So they sort in true chronological order; the year first keeps files from different years in the right order.
- Common gap: thinking the date must be today's date; remind them it is the date the file is about.

Question 4: "How do you find a specific file in Drive quickly?"

- Expected answer: Use the search bar with the file name or an operator like `type:pdf`, `owner:me` or `is:starred`.
- Common gap: scrolling folders by hand. Reinforce that search is faster and smarter.

Question 5: "What is the danger of sharing with 'Anyone with the link'?"

- Expected answer: Anyone with the link â€” even strangers â€” can open the file, which effectively publishes it.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Notice the pattern in what you just answered: organise into containers, name clearly, give least access, and search instead of scrolling. Everything you did for files, we now do for email. The containers become labels, the organising rule becomes a filter, and the search bar stays the search bar. Same brain, new tool."*

If the room struggles with Question 2 or 4, spend a few extra minutes reinforcing those before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

These notes are the actual teaching. Read them as written.

F.1 Why an organised inbox matters

The idea. Email is not just messages; in most workplaces it is the *front door* of the business. Orders arrive by email, invoices are sent by email, job offers come by email, bank alerts come by email. If the front door is a pile of rubbish, real opportunities get buried and lost.

Plain-English definition. Inbox management is the habit of processing your email deliberately â€” deciding quickly what each message is, where it belongs, and what action it needs â€” instead of letting it pile up.

Why it exists as a skill. Email has no natural structure. Unlike a shop with shelves, an inbox is one long, endless list. The provider (Google) does not know what matters to *you*; only you do. So the user must supply the structure.

Real-life comparison â€" the letterbox versus the mailroom. A house letterbox just collects everything: bills, adverts, personal letters, junk. A professional office has a **mailroom**: someone sorts each item and sends it to the right department â€" accounts get the bills, sales get the orders, and the rubbish goes in the bin. Most people's inbox is the letterbox. An organised inbox is the mailroom.

What an organised inbox gives you:

- **Nothing important is missed.** Orders and deadlines stand out.
- **Speed.** You find an old email in seconds with search, not minutes with scrolling.
- **Peace of mind.** Opening your email is calm, not stressful.
- **Professionalism.** A prompt, tidy email reply signals that you are reliable.

Worked example â€" Adaeze Fashion. Adaeze gets about 30 emails a day: customer enquiries, fabric supplier invoices, bank alerts, Jumia adverts, church announcements, school notices for her children. Without a system, she missed a â‚¦150,000 fabric order because it arrived during a Jumia sale flood. With a simple system (a `Customers` label, a `Finance` label, and a filter that sends adverts straight to `Promotions`), her real orders rise to the top and she never loses one again.

Common misconception. Learners think inbox zero means "delete every email". It does **not**. Inbox zero means **your inbox is empty of things that still need a decision** â€" not that you have no emails. Most useful emails get *archived* (kept, but out of the inbox) or *labelled*, not deleted. We cover this in Section F.6.

Honest limitation. No system can make you read your email. The tools only remove friction. If you do not check in at least once a day, even the best setup fails. Email management is a habit first, a technology second.

F.2 The Gmail interface â€" a guided tour

How to get there. In Chrome, type `mail.google.com` and press Enter. If you are logged into your Google account, your inbox opens.

The main parts of the screen (menu wording can vary slightly between Google versions, and between the web version and the phone app â€" the ideas are stable):

1. Compose button (top-left) â€" the big button to write a new email.

2. The left menu (sidebar):

- **Inbox** â€" new messages.
- **Starred** â€" messages you have starred.
- **Snoozed** â€" messages you have told Gmail to bring back later.
- **Sent** â€" everything you have sent.
- **Drafts** â€" messages you started but have not sent.
- **More** (a dropdown) â€" contains **Spam**, **Trash**, **All Mail**, **Important**, and **Categories**.
- **Labels** â€" your own custom labels, listed underneath. This is where your system shows up.

3. Category tabs (at the top of the inbox). Gmail can sort incoming mail into tabs: **Primary** (real people and important mail), **Social** (social networks), **Promotions** (adverts and offers), **Updates** (receipts, confirmations), **Forums** (group discussions). These are *not* folders, and they are configurable in **Settings â†' Inbox**. They are a first, automatic layer of sorting.

4. The search bar (top). Types a search term or an operator to find messages. This is the most powerful tool in Gmail.

5. The settings gear (top-right) â†' **See all settings**. Where labels, filters, signatures, templates and many options live.

6. Right side panels. Calendar, Keep and Tasks can appear here. We meet Tasks properly in Session 4, but note that they live beside your email.

Say to the class:

> *"Gmail is not complicated. On the left, your places: Inbox, Sent, Drafts, Spam, Trash and your Labels. On top, the search bar and the settings gear. Everything else, Google does for you."*

Common misconception. Learners sometimes think the **Promotions** and **Social** tabs are folders that hold the "real" email. They are only Gmail's automatic guess at sorting. A genuine bank alert sometimes lands in **Updates**, and an important customer email can accidentally land in **Promotions**. So do **not** ignore those tabs â€" check them, or better, create a filter to send important senders to the Primary tab.

F.3 Labels and nested labels â€" Gmail's flexible filing system

The idea. A **label** is a tag you stick on an email to say what it is about. Instead of one big pile, you can mark an email as "Customers", "Finance", "School", and so on.

Why labels instead of folders? This is the key difference and a very common exam question.

	Folders (old-style email)	Labels (Gmail)
An email lives in	Exactly **one** folder	Can carry **many** labels at once
Example	An order from a customer that is also a payment goes in either "Customers" OR "Finance"	The same email gets **both** "Customers" and "Finance"
Removing it from the inbox	You must move or delete	You **archive** it; it keeps its labels

Because a real email often fits more than one category, labels are more powerful. An email with a receipt for a client order is *both* about a customer *and* about money. With folders you would have to choose; with labels you can apply both.

Analogy. Think of coloured stickers, not boxes. A folder is a box â€" an item goes in one box only. A label is a sticker â€" you can put three different stickers on the same envelope.

Nested labels. You can group labels under a parent using a forward slash `/`. For example:

- `Clients` (parent)
  - `Clients/Orders`
  - `Clients/Invoices`
  - `Clients/Complaints`
- `Finance` (parent)
  - `Finance/Bank-Alerts`
  - `Finance/Receipts`
- `Personal`
  - `Personal/School`
  - `Personal/Church`

When you create a label named `Clients/Orders`, Gmail automatically creates `Clients` as its parent. Nested labels keep the sidebar tidy instead of showing a long flat list.

How to create a label (exact steps):

1. In the left sidebar, scroll down to the **Labels** section.
2. Click **Create new label** (or the **+** sign, depending on version).
3. Type the label name. To nest it, tick **Nest label under** and choose the parent, **or** simply type the full name with a slash, e.g. `Clients/Orders`.
4. Click **Create**.

How to apply a label to an email:

- Open the email, click the **label icon** (looks like a tag) in the toolbar, tick the labels you want, and click **Apply**. Or
- Select emails in the list with the checkbox, then click the label icon. Or
- **Drag** an email from the list onto a label in the sidebar.

How to colour a label: in the sidebar, hover over the label, click the three-dot **â‹®** â†' **Label color**, and pick one. Colours are visual only; they help your eyes triage quickly.

Recommended starter set for a beginner (7â€"10 labels maximum):

- `Action` (needs a reply or work â€" red)

- `Waiting` (you are waiting for someone â€" yellow)
- `Clients` (with nested `Clients/Orders`, `Clients/Invoices`)
- `Finance` (bank, receipts, payments â€" green)
- `School` or `Work`
- `Personal`
- `Reference` (keep for later)
- `Promotions` (offers and adverts â€" grey)

Common misconception. Learners create **30 labels** and then feel overwhelmed. Fewer, well-chosen labels beat many. If a label has fewer than a handful of emails and probably always will, you do not need it â€" use search instead.

Limitation. A label is only as useful as your discipline in applying it. A label you never use, or apply inconsistently, adds clutter rather than removing it. Start small and grow only when a real need appears.

F.4 Filters and rules â€" making Gmail work automatically

The idea. A **filter** is a rule you set once. It tells Gmail: "When an email arrives matching *this condition*, do *these actions* automatically." Labels are manual; filters are automatic. Filters are what turn a system from "I tidy up every day" into "the tidying happens by itself".

Why they matter. You cannot manually label and file every future email forever. A filter handles the recurring things â€" bank alerts, newsletters, invoices from a regular supplier â€" without you lifting a finger.

Familiar analogy â€" the automatic gate. A filter is like an automatic gate with a number-plate reader: "when *this* car arrives, open the gate and let it into *this* compound." You set the rule once; the gate obeys forever.

Filters have two halves:

1. **The condition (criteria)** â€" what the incoming email must match. Options include:
   - **From** (sender's address)
   - **To**
   - **Subject** (words in the subject line)
   - **Has the words** (words anywhere in the email)
   - **Doesn't have**
   - **Has attachment** (yes/no)
   - **Size** (bigger/smaller than a number)
   - **Date within** (a time period)
   - or a raw **search** box where you can type operators directly.
2. **The action** â€" what Gmail should do. Options include:
   - **Apply the label** (choose one of your labels)
   - **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)** â€" the email is filed but does not clutter the inbox
   - **Mark as read** (so it is not "unread")
   - **Star it**
   - **Apply to matching conversations** (also affects existing old emails)
   - **Forward it** to another address
   - **Delete it**
   - **Never send it to Spam**
   - **Always mark it as important**
   - **Categorize as** (Primary, Social, Promotions, etc.)

How to create a filter (exact steps):

1. Click the **settings gear** (top-right) â†' **See all settings**.
2. Click the **Filters and Blocked Addresses** tab.
3. Scroll down and click **Create a new filter**.
4. Fill in the condition, e.g. **From:** `alerts@bank.example`

5. Click **Create filter**. (A small dialog offers "Create filter" on the search box directly â€" this is a shortcut.)
6. Tick the actions you want, e.g. **Apply the label: Finance/Bank-Alerts** and **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)**.
7. If you want it to also affect old emails already in the inbox, tick **Also apply filter to matching conversations**.
8. Click **Create filter**.

Worked examples:

- **Bank alerts:** From `alerts@bank.example` â†' apply label `Finance/Bank-Alerts`, Skip the Inbox. Result: money messages instantly filed; inbox stays clean.
- **Shopping adverts:** From contains `jumia` â†' apply label `Promotions`, Skip the Inbox. Result: adverts never touch your inbox.
- **Invoices:** Subject contains `Invoice` â†' apply label `Finance/Receipts`, **Star it**. Result: every invoice is flagged and filed automatically.
- **Important client:** From `bigclient@example.com` â†' apply label `Clients`, **Never send it to Spam**, Always mark as important. Result: this client never gets lost, never gets flagged as junk.

Say to the class:

> *"Think about what lands in your inbox every single week â€" bank alerts, adverts, newsletters, invoices from the same person. Name those. Each one deserves a filter. Then those emails sort themselves, and your inbox only holds the things that truly need your attention today."*

Common misconceptions:

- "A filter only works on new email." By default yes â€" but you can tick **Also apply filter to matching conversations** to catch old ones too.
- "A filter can only do one thing." No â€" a single filter can label, archive, star and mark as read all at once.
- "Creating a filter that archives everything is smart." It is dangerous if the condition is too broad. If you type `has:attachment` and Skip the Inbox, **every** email with an attachment disappears from your inbox. Always test a filter on a small condition first.

Limitation. Filters match on rules, not meaning. Gmail cannot know that *this* advert is important while *that* one is not. Keep filters simple and specific; a filter that is too clever often misfires.

F.5 Searching Gmail effectively

The idea. The search bar is your fastest route to any email, even years old. Learn a few operators and you can find almost anything in seconds.

Basic search. Type a word and press Enter â€" Gmail searches senders, recipients, subjects, and the body of messages.

The most useful operators:

What you type	What it finds
`from:adaeze@example.com`	Emails from that sender
`to:me`	Emails addressed to you
`subject:invoice`	Emails with "invoice" in the subject
`has:attachment`	Emails with any attachment (`has:pdf` , `has:document` also work)
`is:unread`	Unread emails
`is:starred`	Starred emails
`is:important`	Gmail-important emails
`is:snoozed`	Snoozed emails
`newer_than:7d`	Emails from the last 7 days (`newer_than:1m` = last month)
`older_than:1y`	Emails older than a year

What you type	What it finds
`in:inbox`	Only the inbox (not archive)
`in:anywhere`	Everywhere, including Spam and Trash
`label:finance`	Emails with a particular label
`category:promotions`	Emails in a category tab
`filename:report.pdf`	Emails with an attachment of that name
`larger:10M`	Emails larger than 10 MB

Combining operators. You can join them for laser precision. Example: find unread emails with attachments from a client in the last month:

```
from:client@example.com has:attachment is:unread newer_than:1m
```

Worked example â€” Adaeze finds a fabric invoice. Adaeze's supplier sent a fabric invoice three months ago. She types:

```
from:supplier@fabrics.example subject:invoice older_than:60d
```

and there it is, in seconds.

Say to the class:

> *"Stop scrolling. The moment you catch yourself hunting through pages of email, stop and search.* `from:`, `subject:`, `has:attachment`, `is:unread` *â€” four operators solve most of your problems."*

F.6 Inbox zero â€” the three homes for an email

The idea. Inbox zero is a method, not a number. When you open an email, you decide, once, which of three homes it goes to â€” and you empty your inbox of undecided mail.

The three homes and three fates for any email:

Fate	What happens	Use it when
Archive	The email leaves the inbox but is **kept** in **All Mail**. You can always find it by search or label.	The email needs no further action but you may want it later (receipts, references, confirmations).
Delete (Trash)	The email moves to **Trash** and is permanently removed automatically after about **30 days**.	Junk, spam, things of no value.
Keep / Act	The email stays or gets a label, a star, or a snooze, because it needs an action.	Real orders, replies you owe, deadlines.

Crucial distinction â€” archive vs delete:

- **Archive** = "remove from my inbox, but keep the email." Most of your email should end up archived, not deleted.
- **Delete** = "send to Trash, remove for good after 30 days." Only for genuinely worthless mail.

The inbox-zero workflow â€” process one email at a time:

1. Open the top email.
2. Ask: **Does this need me to do something?**
   - **No, and I do not need it** â†' **Delete** (junk).
   - **No, but I might need it later** â†' **Archive** (and optionally label it).
   - **Yes, but I can do it in under 2 minutes** â†' **Do it now**, then archive.
   - **Yes, but it will take longer** â†' **Star** or **Snooze** it, or add a task, and archive it out of the inbox so it does not nag you.

3. Repeat until the inbox is empty or nearly empty.

The 2-minute rule. If a task takes less than two minutes, do it immediately rather than filing it. It is quicker to act than to manage the reminder.

How to archive: select the email and click the **archive icon** (a box with a downward arrow), or press `E` if keyboard shortcuts are on. To find it later, click **All Mail** or search.

How to delete: click the **trash icon**, or press `#`.

Real-life comparison. Inbox zero is like washing plates after each meal instead of letting a mountain grow in the sink. A few minutes a day keeps the whole kitchen usable. Letting it pile up turns a small chore into a dreaded task.

Common misconception. "Inbox zero means I must reply to everything." No â€" many emails need only to be archived. Inbox zero means nothing is left *undecided*, not that you replied to all 30 messages.

Limitation. Inbox zero is a habit, and habits need rhythm. Plan a fixed time â€" say, morning and evening â€" to process email. If you only do it once a week, the pile returns.

F.7 Snooze and Schedule Send â€" time-shifting email

The idea. Gmail lets you move email through **time**, not just space.

Snooze â€" make an email come back later. If an email needs action but not *now*, snooze it. It disappears from the inbox and reappears at the time you chose â€" like an assistant handing it back to you at the right moment.

How to snooze: hover over the email in the list, click the **clock icon**, and choose a time (Later today, Tomorrow, Next week, or a custom date and time). The email moves to **Snoozed** and returns automatically.

Use it for: "I will reply to this supplier tomorrow morning"; "Remind me about this deadline next Monday".

Schedule Send â€" write now, send later. If you need to send an email but want it to arrive at a specific time (e.g. 8am when the office opens, or after you have finished something), do not wait around. Write it and schedule it.

How to schedule send:

1. Click **Compose** and write your email.
2. Instead of clicking **Send**, click the small **down arrow** beside the Send button.
3. Choose **Schedule send**.
4. Pick a date and time, then confirm.

The email sits in the **Scheduled** area until that time, then sends itself. This is useful for sending a reminder the night before but having it arrive in working hours, or for sending across time zones.

Worked example â€" Adaeze. Adaeze wants to send a follow-up to a client but it is 11pm. She does not want to seem to be working all night, and she wants the client to see it first thing. She writes it and uses **Schedule send** for 8:00am the next day. It arrives at a professional hour.

Common misconception. Learners think a snoozed email is deleted. It is not â€" it is waiting in **Snoozed** and will return exactly as promised.

Limitation. Snooze and schedule rely on your phone or computer being on with a connection to display the reminder. They are powerful but not magic; check your **Snoozed** list occasionally to make sure nothing is stuck.

F.8 Signatures and templates

The idea. Two features save enormous time and make you look professional.

A signature is a block of text (your name, role, phone, business) that Gmail can automatically add to the bottom of every email. It stops you retyping your details.

How to create a signature (exact steps):

1. Click the **settings gear** â†' **See all settings**.
2. Stay on the **General** tab; scroll down to **Signature**.
3. Click **Create new**, name it (e.g. "Main"), and click **Create**.
4. In the box, type your details, for example:

```
Warm regards,
Adaeze Okafor
Founder, Adaeze Fashion
ðŸ“ž 0803 000 0000
â‰‰ adaeze@adaezefashion.example
Port Harcourt, Rivers State
```

5. Under **Signature defaults**, choose when it should appear (new emails, replies, or both).
6. Scroll to the bottom and click **Save Changes**.

A template (the feature is called **Templates**; it used to be called Canned Responses) is a ready-made email you can insert into any message with two clicks. Perfect for repeated messages: order confirmations, price enquiries, follow-ups, introductions.

How to turn on Templates first:

1. **Settings gear** â†' **See all settings** â†' **Advanced** tab.
2. Find **Templates** and select **Enable**.
3. Click **Save Changes** at the bottom.

How to create and use a template:

1. Click **Compose**. Write the email you want to reuse, leaving blanks to fill in, e.g.:

```
Subject: Following up on your order [Order Number]

Dear [Customer Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am following up on your recent order with Adaeze Fashion.

[Add the specific update here.]

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Warm regards,
Adaeze
```

2. Click the **three-dot menu (â‹®)** at the bottom-right of the compose window.
3. Choose **Templates â†' Save draft as template â†' Save as new template**.
4. Give it a name.
5. Later, to use it: **Compose â†' three-dot menu â†' Templates â†' [your template name]** â€" it is inserted instantly, and you fill in the blanks.

Say to the class:

> *"If you type the same kind of email more than twice, it should be a template. Your signature and your templates are your professional uniform â€" they make every message look consistent and save you minutes every day."*

Common misconception. Learners expect templates to auto-personalise ("dear Ada", "dear Emeka"). Templates are static â€" you insert them and then edit the blanks. (Smart personalisation needs more advanced tools we do not cover here.)

Limitation. A template used without editing looks careless. Always fill in the specific details before sending.

F.9 Attachments and Drive integration

The idea. You can attach files to email, and you can link to files in Drive. Knowing when to attach and when to link is important.

Attaching a file: in the Compose window, click the **paperclip icon**, choose the file from your computer, and it uploads with the email. The recipient gets a copy.

Linking from Google Drive: in the Compose window, click the **Google Drive icon** (a triangle) in the toolbar. A panel opens showing your Drive files; select one and choose whether to **attach** it as a copy or **insert** it as a **link**. Inserting a link is often better for big files, and it means the recipient always sees the latest version.

Why link instead of attach?

- Large files send faster and do not fill anyone's inbox.
- The recipient always opens the **current** version, not an old copy.
- You control access â€" but remember Section 1: only share with people who should have access.

Worked example. Adaeze sends a customer a 20-page catalogue. Instead of attaching a heavy file, she uploads the catalogue to Drive once and sends the **link**. If she updates pages later, the customer's link always shows the latest version. If she had attached it, she would have to resend every update.

Common misconception. Learners think a Drive link is automatically private. It follows the sharing setting from Session 1 â€" keep it **Restricted** and add only the intended people.

Limitation. A link depends on the recipient's access. If the file is Restricted and you have not shared it with them, the link will not open. Check the sharing before you send.

F.10 Summary of the lecture

- An organised inbox is a **mailroom**, not a **letterbox** â€" it protects you from losing money and opportunities.
- Gmail uses **labels** (tags), not folders â€" one email can have many labels. Use **nested labels** like `Clients/Orders`.
- **Filters** are automatic rules: condition + action (label, archive, star, mark read).
- Search with operators: `from:`, `subject:`, `has:attachment`, `is:unread`, `newer_than:7d`.
- **Inbox zero** = archive, delete or act; nothing left undecided. **Archive vs delete** is the key distinction.
- **Snooze** brings mail back later; **Schedule send** sends it later.
- A **signature** is your automatic professional block; **Templates** save repeated emails.
- **Attach** for small copies; **link from Drive** for large files and always-latest versions.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A logged-in demo Gmail account on the projector, ideally with the 12 practice emails from Section C already in the inbox.
- The sample label structure and template examples in the handouts, printed for learners.
- A second email address (e.g. `cea.assessment@gmail.com`) to send test emails to.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" tour and labels (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch the left side of my screen. This is where my system will appear."

1. Point to **Inbox, Starred, Snoozed, Sent, Drafts**, and under **More**, show **Spam**, **Trash**, **All Mail**.
2. Show the category tabs: **Primary, Social, Promotions, Updates, Forums**.
3. In the **Labels** section, click **Create new label**. Name it `Clients/Orders`. Point out that Gmail creates `Clients` as the parent automatically. Say: "The slash makes a nested label."
4. Open one practice email ("Request for 3 Ankara gowns") and apply `Clients/Orders` using the label icon.
5. Right-click the label in the sidebar â†' **Label color** â†' choose green. Say: "Colour is for my eyes only; it changes nothing about access."

Question to ask: "*Can this customer email also carry a* `Finance` *label at the same time?*" â†' Yes â€" that is exactly what labels allow and folders do not.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" a filter (4 minutes)

Say: "Now I make it automatic. I never want to file bank alerts by hand again."

1. **Settings gear â†' See all settings â†' Filters and Blocked Addresses â†' Create a new filter.**
2. In **From**, type `alerts@bank.example`. Click **Create filter**.
3. Tick **Apply the label: Finance/Bank-Alerts** and **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)**. Also tick **Never send it to Spam**.
4. Tick **Also apply filter to matching conversations** so old bank alerts are filed too. Click **Create filter**.

5. **Deliberately make a bad filter first** (optional but powerful): create a filter matching **Has the words**: `sale` with action Skip the Inbox. Ask: *"What is the danger?"* â†' Real emails containing the word "sale" (like an invoice saying "for sale") vanish from the inbox. Delete that test filter.

Mistakes to watch and correct: filters that are too broad; forgetting to tick "Also apply to matching conversations" when the learner wants old mail covered; deleting the wrong filter.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" inbox zero on 10 emails (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch me empty this inbox in front of you. I decide, I act, I move on."

Process ~10 practice emails on the projector, narrating each decision:

- Jumia advert â†' **Delete**.
- Newsletter â†' **Archive**.
- Bank alert â†' already auto-filed by the filter; point at it.
- Client order â†' **Star** it, apply `Clients/Orders`, leave it to reply, or reply quickly then archive.
- Scholarship reminder â†' **Snooze** to tomorrow 8am.
- Receipt â†' **Archive** (label `Finance/Receipts`).
- Spam â†' mark **Report spam**.

Count down the inbox as you go. Say: "Notice I archived far more than I deleted. Archive is my friend."

Question to ask: *"I archived that receipt. Is it gone forever?"* â†' No, it is in All Mail; find it by searching.

G.5 Demonstration 4 â€" signature, template, schedule, snooze (3 minutes)

1. **Settings â†' General â†' Signature â†' Create new.** Type the sample Adaeze signature. **Save Changes.**
2. **Settings â†' Advanced â†' Templates â†' Enable â†' Save Changes.**
3. **Compose** a short follow-up email. Open the **â‹®** menu â†' **Templates â†' Save draft as template**. Name it "Client Follow-up".
4. Compose again, **â‹® â†' Templates â†' Client Follow-up**, and show it appearing instantly.
5. Click the **down arrow** beside Send â†' **Schedule send** â†' pick tomorrow 8:00am. Say: "It is written; it will send itself."
6. On a practice email, hover and click the **clock** to **Snooze** it to tomorrow.

Expected results: the signature appears on new mail; the template inserts; the scheduled email shows in **Scheduled**; the snoozed email shows in **Snoozed**.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, learners set up labels, one working filter, a signature and a professional email template in their own Gmail.

Starting materials: A logged-in Gmail account per learner. If using their real inbox, warn them to work only on their own messages and never delete anything important â€" they may practise on test emails the instructor sends.

Scenario: You have just been made the office assistant at *Adaeze Fashion*. The manager wants a clean, professional email system set up today.

Procedure (instructor calls out each step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open `mail.google.com` and confirm you are logged in.
2. In the left sidebar, scroll to **Labels** and click **Create new label**.
3. Create the parent label `Clients` (no slash).
4. Create a nested label `Clients/Orders` (type the slash). Confirm that it appears *under* Clients.
5. Create two more nested labels: `Finance/Bank-Alerts` and `Finance/Receipts`.
6. Create one simple label `Promotions`. **Pause and predict:** *"How many extra labels did Gmail create for me just by using slashes?"* (It auto-creates the parents `Clients` and `Finance`.)
7. Colour `Clients` green and `Promotions` grey (right-click a label â†' Label color).
8. **Create a filter:** Settings gear â†' **See all settings** â†' **Filters and Blocked Addresses** â†' **Create a new filter**.

9. For the condition **From**, type `alerts@bank.example` (use the instructor's test sender). Click **Create filter**.
10. Tick **Apply the label: Finance/Bank-Alerts** and **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)**. Click **Create filter**.
11. **Pause and predict:** "*When the next bank alert arrives, will it land in my inbox or not?*" (Not â€" it will be archived with the label.)
12. Ask the instructor to send a test email from the bank address. Confirm it did **not** appear in the inbox but shows under the label.
13. **Create a signature:** Settings gear â†' **See all settings** â†' **General** tab â†' scroll to **Signature** â†' **Create new**. Type your professional block (name, business, phone, email). **Save Changes.**
14. **Enable Templates:** Settings â†' **Advanced** tab â†' **Templates** â†' **Enable** â†' **Save Changes**.
15. **Create a template:** Compose â†' write a short "Client Follow-up" email with `[blanks]` â†' **â‹®** menu â†' **Templates â†' Save draft as template â†' Save as new template**. Name it "Client Follow-up".
16. Compose a new email, insert your template via **â‹® â†' Templates**, confirm your signature is at the bottom, and **schedule** it to send tomorrow at 8:00am (down arrow beside Send â†' Schedule send).
17. Snooze a test email to tomorrow (hover â†' clock icon).

Expected result: Four new labels (with two auto-parents), a working bank-alert filter that archives and labels, a signature on new mail, a saved "Client Follow-up" template, one scheduled email, and one snoozed email.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Filter does nothing â†' the **From** address may not match exactly. Check the sender address character by character.
- Label does not appear nested â†' the slash was missing or a space was typed around it.
- Signature not showing â†' confirm **Save Changes** was clicked at the bottom of Settings.
- Templates option missing â†' confirm **Templates** was enabled under **Advanced** and settings saved.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ `Clients` and `Clients/Orders` labels exist (nested)
- ☐ `Finance/Bank-Alerts` and `Finance/Receipts` exist
- ☐ `Promotions` label exists
- ☐ Labels coloured
- ☐ One filter created and tested with a real test email
- ☐ Professional signature saved and visible on a new email
- ☐ Templates enabled
- ☐ One template saved ("Client Follow-up")
- ☐ One email scheduled
- ☐ One email snoozed

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Build a small email-management system for a **different** organisation on your own, without copying the Adaeze structure.

Scenario: You are the volunteer communications officer for *Rumuola Youth Foundation*, a small NGO in Port Harcourt that runs skills programmes for young people. The foundation gets lots of email: donations, volunteer interest, government/partner correspondence, programme applications, media requests, and a flood of newsletters. The coordinator is overwhelmed.

Requirements:

1. Create a set of labels suited to an NGO: at least **two parent labels**, each with at least **one nested child label** (e.g. `Donors/Receipts`, `Programmes/Applications`, `Volunteers`, `Partners/Grant-Info`).
2. Give at least two labels a **colour**.
3. Create **one filter** for a recurring sender whose mail should bypass the inbox â€" for example all mail from `noreply@` or a newsletter address. The filter must **apply a label and skip the inbox**.
4. Create a **professional signature** for the fictional role: your name, "Communications Officer, Rumuola Youth Foundation", a phone number and the email address.

5. Create **one email template** called "Volunteer Welcome" that thanks a new volunteer and lists three next steps, with `[brackets]` for details to fill in.
6. **Snooze** one email to come back in **two days**.
7. Draft (do not necessarily send) a short email using the template, and **schedule** it for tomorrow at 9:00am.

Constraints:

- No more than **eight** labels total â€” do not overload the sidebar.
- The filter must not archive emails that merely *contain* the word "donation" (too broad) â€” match a specific sender instead.
- Use least privilege thinking: describe, in one line in your workbook, why you would never give a donor Editor access to your records.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- At least two parent labels, each with a nested child label.
- Two coloured labels.
- One tested filter that labels and skips the inbox.
- One professional signature.
- One saved template ("Volunteer Welcome").
- One snoozed email and one scheduled email.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: To nest a label, type the full name with a slash, e.g. `Donors/Receipts`, or tick **Nest label under** and pick the parent.
- Hint 2: The template is saved through the **â‹®** menu inside the Compose window, after enabling Templates in **Advanced** settings.
- Hint 3: Snooze is the **clock icon** when you hover over an email; Schedule send is the **down arrow** beside the Send button.

Instructor answer key (do not show learners):

Example label set (8 labels including parents):

```
Donors
  Donors/Receipts
  Donors/Thank-You
Programmes
  Programmes/Applications
Partners
  Partners/Grant-Info
Volunteers
Newsletters
```

Example filter: Condition **From** `newsletter@ngo-news.example` â†’ actions: apply label `Newsletters`, Skip the Inbox. (Accept any specific recurring sender.)

Example signature:

```
Kind regards,
[Learner Name]
Communications Officer, Rumuola Youth Foundation
ðŸ“ž 0803 000 0000 | âœ‰ info@rumuolayouth.example
```

Example template "Volunteer Welcome": Subject "Welcome to Rumuola Youth Foundation!" â€” body greeting `[Volunteer Name]`, thanks them, lists three next steps (complete the form, join the WhatsApp group, attend the orientation on `[date]`), sign-off.

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Two parent labels with nested children (2)
- Two coloured labels (1)
- Working filter (label + skip inbox) (2)
- Professional signature (1)
- Saved "Volunteer Welcome" template (2)
- Snooze + scheduled email (1)

- Sensible least-privilege note (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *Mrs. Eucharia* is the bursar (finance officer) at a small secondary school in Port Harcourt. She uses one Gmail account for everything: fee receipts, parent enquiries, staff memos, ministry circulars, supplier invoices, bank alerts, and dozens of newsletters and prayer-chain forwards. During the busy start-of-term period she receives over 150 emails a day. In one week, she missed two important messages: a ministry deadline for submitting enrolment figures, and a parent's complaint about a wrong fee charge. Both was buried under promotional mail.

Relevant facts.

- The ministry deadline email came from a known government sender with "Enrolment Return" in the subject.
- The parent complaint came from a parent's personal address with "Wrong charge" in the subject.
- She receives regular bank alerts from a single sender, and a daily newsletter she rarely reads.
- She is not a "computer person" but she is willing to learn, and she does everything in a browser.

Decision point. How can Mrs. Eucharia make sure that high-value email (government, parents, bank) stands out, while low-value email (newsletters, adverts) stops cluttering her inbox â€" without learning anything complicated?

Possible approaches and trade-offs.

1. **Create 30 labels and try to file everything by hand daily.** Powerful but fragile: she will fall behind, and manual filing is exactly what failed. *Trade-off: too much effort, not sustainable.*
2. **A small system: 5â€"7 labels plus 3â€"4 filters that auto-file the recurring mail.** Low effort, high payoff. Government and parent mail get labelled and never sent to Spam; bank alerts auto-file; newsletters auto-archive. *Trade-off: a little setup time now, a calm inbox forever.*
3. **Set up a second email account and tell people to use it.** Confusing for parents and government; creates two places to check. *Trade-off: adds complexity, not removes it.*

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. A small, targeted system:

Labels: `Ministry` , `Parents` , `Finance/Bank-Alerts` , `Staff` , `Newsletters` , `Reference` .

Filters:

- From the ministry sender â†' label `Ministry` , **Never send to Spam**, **Always mark important**, plus a **star**.
- From any address with "Wrong charge" in the subject â†' label `Parents` , mark important.
- From the bank alert sender â†' label `Finance/Bank-Alerts` , Skip the Inbox.
- From the newsletter sender â†' label `Newsletters` , Skip the Inbox.

She sets aside two fixed times each day (morning and after school) to process the inbox to zero using the 2-minute rule and snooze.

Trade-offs of the recommendation. Filters only catch what she plans for; a brand-new sender she did not anticipate still lands in the inbox â€" but because everything is labelled and the inbox is processed twice daily, nothing sits for long. She must keep the filters updated as senders change.

Professional connection. This is precisely the work of an administrative officer, bursar, secretary or personal assistant. The ability to design a resilient inbox â€" labels, filters, search, templates â€" is a directly employable skill. When Mrs. Eucharia shows her system to the school board, she is demonstrating digital productivity competence, not just "knowing how to use email".

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Point learners to the row; make them confirm the cause before fixing.

K.1 Too many labels â€" sidebar chaos

Symptoms: Dozens of labels; the sidebar is harder to read than the inbox. **Likely cause:** Labeling every conceivable topic at once. **How to investigate:** Count the labels; ask whether each is used weekly. **Corrective steps:** Delete unused labels (right-

click â†' **Remove label** â€" this does not delete emails, only the tag); merge similar ones; use **search** instead of micro-labels. **Prevention:** Start with 5â€"7 labels; grow only on real need.

K.2 A filter that archives everything

Symptoms: Expected emails vanish from the inbox. **Likely cause:** The filter condition is too broad (e.g. matching a common word). **How to investigate:** Settings â†' Filters; read the condition of each filter. Check **All Mail** or the relevant label for the "missing" mail. **Corrective steps:** Edit the filter to be specific (match a full sender address, not a common word); or delete it. **Prevention:** Test a filter on new mail before applying it to old conversations.

K.3 Archived email "disappears"

Symptoms: Learner thinks archiving deleted the email. **Likely cause:** Misunderstanding archive vs delete. **How to investigate:** Look in **All Mail** or search for it. **Corrective steps:** Explain archive keeps it; find it by search or a label. Reassure. **Prevention:** Teach that archive = "out of inbox, still kept"; delete = "to Trash for 30 days".

K.4 Missing important email â€" it went to Spam

Symptoms: A genuine email is never seen. **Likely cause:** Gmail guessed it was junk; meanwhile the learner never checks Spam. **How to investigate:** Search `in:anywhere` or open **Spam**. **Corrective steps:** Mark it **Not spam**; create a filter for that sender with **Never send it to Spam**; add them to contacts. **Prevention:** Check Spam weekly; add trusted senders to contacts.

K.5 Signature not appearing

Symptoms: New emails have no signature. **Likely cause:** Settings not saved; or signature defaults set to only one mode (e.g. only replies). **How to investigate:** Reopen **Settings â†' General â†' Signature** and check the box is filled and **Save Changes** was clicked. **Corrective steps:** Edit the signature, set defaults for new mail and replies, save. **Prevention:** Always scroll to the bottom of Settings and click **Save Changes**.

K.6 Template option is missing

Symptoms: No **Templates** choice in the compose **â‹®** menu. **Likely cause:** Templates not enabled, or advanced settings not saved. **How to investigate:** Settings â†' **Advanced** tab â†' check **Templates = Enable**. **Corrective steps:** Enable and **Save Changes**; refresh Gmail; reopen Compose. **Prevention:** Enable Templates at the start of setup, before creating any.

K.7 Attachments too large to send

Symptoms: Gmail refuses a large attachment. **Likely cause:** The file exceeds the size limit (Gmail's limit is around 25 MB; larger files require Drive). **Corrective steps:** Upload the file to Drive, set sharing to **Restricted** with the recipient added, and insert the **Drive link** instead of attaching. **Prevention:** For any large file, default to a Drive link.

K.8 Deleting the wrong email

Symptoms: An important message was deleted. **Likely cause:** Mistaken click or a careless bulk delete. **How to investigate:** Open **Trash**. **Corrective steps:** Select the message and click **Move to Inbox**, or right-click â†' **Move to â†' Inbox**. **Prevention:** Archive instead of delete when unsure; Trash keeps mail for about 30 days.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed. The *likely* cause is a hypothesis; it becomes *confirmed* only after checking â€" see the filter's condition, see the email in Spam, see Templates enabled. Teach learners to verify before fixing.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Managed Inbox"

Purpose: To demonstrate that you can independently set up and maintain a clean, professional Gmail system â€" the Week 1 email deliverable â€" using labels, filters, a signature and a template.

Realistic scenario: You have been hired to manage email for a small business of your choice (or use Adaeze Fashion). The owner wants a professional inbox that never loses a client message and replies in a consistent, branded way.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose a fictional business (or use Adaeze Fashion). Decide its main types of email.

2. Create **at least five labels**, including at least **two nested labels** (a parent with a child). Colour at least two.
3. Create **two working filters**, each with a clear condition and action. One filter must **auto-label and skip the inbox** for a recurring sender. One filter must **star** or **mark important** a high-value sender.
4. Create a **professional signature** with your name, role, business, phone and email.
5. Create **two email templates**: a "Client Follow-up" and a "New Enquiry Reply" (or two suitable for your business).
6. Process your (test or real) inbox to **fewer than 10 messages** using archive, delete, label, snooze and archiving. Do not delete anything important.
7. **Schedule** one email for tomorrow morning using a template.
8. Write a short paragraph (5â€"8 lines) explaining: your label structure, what your filters do, and how your inbox-zero routine fits your day.

Required deliverables:

- A screenshot (or list) of your labels, showing the nested ones.
- A list of your two filters (condition + action).
- A screenshot or text of your signature.
- The names of your two saved templates.
- A screenshot of your inbox showing fewer than 10 messages, plus your Snoozed and Scheduled items.
- Your workbook paragraph.

Submission format: Add all screenshots and the paragraph to the class submission document, or share via the class folder. Set any shared screenshots to **Restricted** â€" do not expose personal email content publicly.

Deadline: Before Session 3 (Google Docs and Google Sheets).

Marking rubric (25 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Labels and nesting	5	5+ labels; 2+ nested; sensible names and at least two coloured
Filters	6	Two working filters; clear conditions; correct actions (auto-file + star/important)
Professional signature	4	Complete, tidy, correct details, appears on new mail
Templates	5	Two saved, reusable templates with clear blanks
Inbox management	3	Inbox under 10; snooze and schedule demonstrated; nothing important lost
Explanation paragraph	2	Clear, accurate description of the system and routine

Common mistakes to avoid: creating too many labels; filters that are too broad; forgetting to save settings; templates with no blanks to fill; deleting important mail instead of archiving.

Instructor reference solution:

Labels:

```
Action
Waiting
Clients
  Clients/Orders
  Clients/Invoices
Finance
  Finance/Receipts
Newsletters
```

Filters:

- From `newsletters@example.com` â†' apply `Newsletters`, Skip the Inbox.
- From `bigclient@example.com` â†' apply `Clients`, Star it, Never send to Spam.

Signature:

```
Warm regards,
[Name]
```

```
[Role], Adaeze Fashion
ðŸ“ž 0803 000 0000 | â✉ [email]
Port Harcourt, Rivers State
```

Templates: "Client Follow-up"; "New Enquiry Reply." *Paragraph model:* "I use a few labels: Action for things needing me, Waiting for things I'm owed, Clients for customers with orders and invoices nested inside, Finance for money and receipts, and Newsletters for bulk mail. My first filter auto-files all newsletters out of my inbox; my second stars everything from my biggest client so I never miss them. Every morning and evening I process the inbox to zero using the two-minute rule and snooze."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key that follows.)

Q1. Short answer. In one or two sentences, explain the difference between a Gmail **label** and a traditional email **folder**.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which search would find all **unread emails that have an attachment**? a) `is:unread from:attachment` b) `has:attachment is:unread` c) `subject:unread attachment` d) `unread:yes file:yes`

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the difference between **archiving** an email and **deleting** it, and which should you do more often?

Q4. Practical identification. Name the filter **action** you would choose for each situation: a) You want every bank alert to leave your inbox automatically. b) You want every invoice email to be flagged for attention. c) You want a bulk newsletter out of your inbox but kept for later.

Q5. Error detection. A learner sets up a filter with the condition **Has the words:** `sale` and the action **Skip the Inbox**. What is the problem, and how would you fix it?

Q6. Scenario. Adaeze wants to send a follow-up email at 8:00am tomorrow but it is 11:00pm tonight. Which Gmail feature should she use, and how is it different from **Snooze**?

Q7. Short answer. Why is it a bad idea to create thirty labels on your first day?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. A folder holds an email in one place only; a **label** is a tag, so a single email can carry **many** labels at the same time. Labels are more flexible because real email often belongs to several categories at once.

A2. (b) `has:attachment is:unread`.

A3. Archive removes the email from the inbox but **keeps** it in All Mail, findable by search or label. **Delete** moves it to **Trash**, where it is permanently removed after about 30 days. You should archive far more often than you delete â€" most useful email should be kept, just out of the inbox.

A4. a) Apply label + **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)**; b) **Star it** (and/or apply a label); c) apply a label + **Skip the Inbox** (keeps it for later without cluttering the inbox).

A5. The condition is far too broad: any email containing the word "sale" â€" including genuine messages â€" will vanish from the inbox. Fix it by matching a specific sender or phrase instead (e.g. From `deals@shop.example`), or delete the filter.

A6. Schedule Send (the down arrow beside Send). It sends a *new* email at a chosen future time. **Snooze** is different: it hides an email that already arrived and brings it back at a chosen time; it does not send anything.

A7. Too many labels recreate clutter and become hard to maintain; you will not use most of them consistently. Start with 5â€"7 meaningful labels and grow only when a real, repeated need appears; use search for one-off lookups.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you turned your inbox from a letterbox into a mailroom. You learned the parts of Gmail, and the big idea that Gmail uses **labels** (tags), not folders â€" so one email can belong to several categories at once, including nested labels like `Clients/Orders`. You built **filters** that file and flag email automatically, learned to **search** with operators like `from:`, `subject:`, `has:attachment` and `is:unread`, and adopted the **inbox-zero** habit â€" deciding each email's fate (archive, delete or

act) so nothing is left undecided. You also set up a professional **signature**, saved reusable **templates**, and learned to **snooze** and **schedule send**. Finally, you saw when to attach a file and when to link to Drive instead.

Five important takeaways:

1. An organised inbox protects money and opportunities; it is a mailroom, not a letterbox.
2. **Labels** (including nested ones) beat folders because one email can carry many labels.
3. **Filters** are automatic rules â€" condition plus action â€" that file your recurring email for you.
4. **Archive vs delete**: archive keeps email out of the inbox but safe; delete sends it to Trash for 30 days. Archive more than you delete.
5. **Search**, not scrolling: `from:`, `subject:`, `has:attachment`, `is:unread` find almost anything in seconds.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I explain labels versus folders to a friend?
- Can I create a nested label and apply it without help?
- Can I build one filter that labels and skips the inbox?
- Can I clear an inbox to near zero using archive, delete, label and snooze?
- Can I set up a signature and reuse a template?

Connection to the next session. Your inbox is now organised, and you can send professional, consistent emails. Next session we move from *sending* messages to *creating* the documents themselves â€" **Google Docs** for written documents and **Google Sheets** for numbers â€" including how to share, comment and collaborate on a live document, and how Docs and Sheets link back to the Drive folder you built in Session 1.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner explains labels vs folders correctly, including that one email can have several labels.
- The learner creates a nested label on the first try.
- The learner designs a filter with a specific condition and a sensible action, and can explain the risk of a broad condition.
- The learner reaches inbox zero in the practice inbox using archive more than delete.
- The learner uses search operators instead of scrolling.
- The learner sets up a signature and saves a template without prompting.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Labels are the same as folders." â†' They are tags; many per email.
- "Archiving deletes the email." â†' It keeps it in All Mail.
- "Inbox zero means I must reply to everything." â†' It means nothing left undecided.
- "A filter with 'Skip the Inbox' is safe for any condition." â†' Broad conditions hide important mail.
- "Spam is always junk." â†' Real mail sometimes lands there; check weekly and mark 'Not spam'.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Label-sorting drill:** give ten email subjects and ask which label each deserves; draw the nested structure.
2. **Filter-building drill:** give five recurring senders and ask the learner to write the condition and action for each.
3. **Archive-or-delete drill:** give ten emails and ask "archive or delete, and why?"
4. **Search drill:** give four "find this" tasks and ask for the operator(s).
5. **Template drill:** have the learner turn a common reply into a reusable template.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide the label names and one filter condition on a card; the learner creates them and the signature only.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** design a complete filter system of five rules for a fictional shop (bank, supplier, customers, adverts, government), write a one-page "Email Handling Policy" (how often to check, response-time targets, what to archive vs

delete), and set up a Google Tasks reminder linked from a starred email.

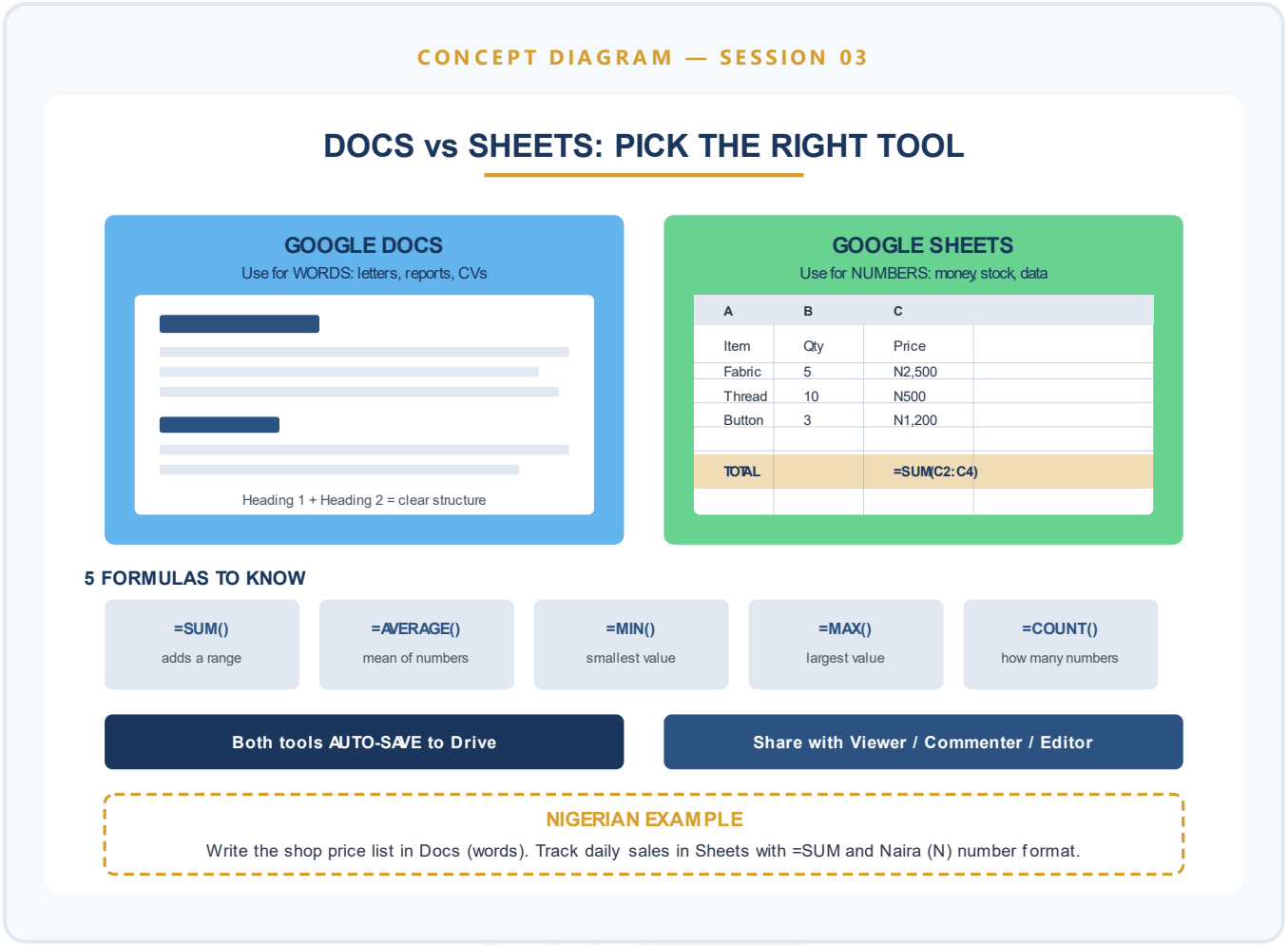
Timing guidance: If the room is slow, reduce practice to 8 emails and skip the Drive attachment sub-demonstration (Section F.9) to a mention; protect the filter creation and inbox-zero practice, which are the core skills. If Wi-Fi is weak, pre-send the test emails before class so they are already waiting.

END OF SESSION 2

Next: Session 3 â€" Google Docs and Google Sheets.

SESSION 03 OF 6

Google Docs Sheets



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 3 â€" GOOGLE DOCS AND GOOGLE SHEETS

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	3 of 6
Session title	Google Docs and Google Sheets
Week / Module	Week 1 â€" Module: Cloud Storage and Email
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner (builds on Sessions 1â€"2)
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1 and 2. Learners must be able to log in, navigate Google Drive, create folders, share with Viewer/Commenter/Editor, and find files by search. Basic typing is assumed.

Item	Detail
Connection to previous work	In Session 1 you built a safe, organised home for your files. In Session 2 you organised your email and learned to share with least privilege. Now you create the *content* that lives in that home: written documents in **Google Docs** and spreadsheets in **Google Sheets** â€" and you learn to collaborate on them live, using the sharing rules you already know.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged in to a Google account; Chrome open; a learner Doc and a learner Sheet created beforehand in the Drive structure from Session 1 (or created live); the sample business-letter text and the sample expense data ready to paste (Section C); document and spreadsheet templates prepared; the Docs and Sheets cheat sheets printed; projector connected; internet working.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Create a document** in Google Docs and give it a clear title, and explain that Docs **auto-saves** to Drive.
2. **Format a document** using the toolbar â€" font, size, bold/italic/underline, alignment, lists â€" and apply **heading styles** (Heading 1, 2, 3) to create structure.
3. **Insert** a table, an image and a hyperlink, and explain when each is useful.
4. **Set up page settings** and **export/download** a document as a **PDF** and as a **.docx** Word file.
5. **Share a document** with the correct role (Viewer, Commenter, Editor), and use **commenting** and **suggesting mode** for collaboration.
6. **Use version history** to view and restore an earlier version of a document, and explain what auto-save means for safety.
7. **Create a spreadsheet** in Google Sheets and identify **cells, rows, columns and ranges** using cell references like `B2`.
8. **Enter and format data**, including formatting numbers as **Naira (â‚¦)** currency.
9. **Write basic formulas** â€" `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT` â€" and explain what each does.
10. **Create a simple chart**, **freeze a header row**, and **sort and filter** data.
11. **Explain the difference** between Docs and Sheets and choose the right tool for a task.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops) with a working mouse and keyboard.
- Instructor computer connected to the projector.

Software

- Google Chrome (any recent version).
- Google Docs and Google Sheets â€" both are **free** web services included with a Google account. No installation, no payment.

Accounts

- A working Google account (the same one from Sessions 1 and 2).

Sample files / sample content

- **Sample business letter text** (to paste into Docs; learners may also type it):

```
Adaeze Fashion
12 Agrrey Road, Rumuola
Port Harcourt, Rivers State
0803 000 0000 | adaeze@adaezefashion.example

9 October 2026
```

```
The Manager
Rivers State SME Support Scheme
Government House Road
Port Harcourt

Dear Sir/Madam,

REQUEST FOR SME GRANT APPLICATION FORM

I write on behalf of Adaeze Fashion, a small tailoring and clothing business based in Port Harcourt. We have been in operation for t

We recently expanded into ready-to-wear Ankara designs and require additional funding for two industrial sewing machines and fabric

We hereby request the application form and guidelines for the grant. We are ready to provide all required documents, including our b

Thank you for your consideration. We look forward to your response.

Yours faithfully,

Adaeze Okafor
Founder, Adaeze Fashion
```

- **Sample expense data** (to paste into Sheets):

```
Date        Item                Category        Amount
2026-10-01  Fabric - Ankara      Materials       45000
2026-10-02  Thread and buttons   Materials        6500
2026-10-03  Electricity bill     Utilities       18000
2026-10-05  Sewing machine oil   Equipment        2500
2026-10-06  Transport to market  Transport        4000
2026-10-08  Fabric - Lace        Materials       62000
2026-10-09  Airtime and data     Utilities        3000
2026-10-10  Packaging bags       Materials        7500
2026-10-12  Rent - shop space    Rent            35000
2026-10-14  Tailor wages         Salaries        40000
```

Worksheets / printed materials

- Handout 3.1 â€" "Docs Toolbar and Heading Styles" (one per learner).
- Handout 3.2 â€" "Sheets Formulas Cheat Sheet" (`SUM` , `AVERAGE` , `MIN` , `MAX` , `COUNT` with examples).
- Worksheet 3.3 â€" "Design My Own Sheet" (in the learner workbook, Part 3).

Tools

- Google Docs (`docs.google.com`), Google Sheets (`sheets.google.com`), Google Drive.

Internet

- **Required.** Docs and Sheets are cloud services.

Alternative for learners who prefer Microsoft

- Microsoft Word Online and Excel Online (free with a Microsoft account) work very similarly: headings via **Styles**, comments, tracking changes, and Excel formulas (`SUM` , `AVERAGE` , etc.) with the same names in most cases. Learners may follow along in Word/Excel Online if they strongly prefer, but the instructor demonstrates in Google Docs and Sheets as standard.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes)

Instructor setup: Have a real (or realistic) Word document open on the projector, and a second window ready with a Google Doc. Do **not** reveal the trick yet.

What the instructor says:

> *"Let me tell you about Funmi. Funmi is a student here in Port Harcourt. She has a big assignment due at 8am. She types it all night in Microsoft Word on her laptop. At 2am the power goes off â€" the laptop battery is old and dies instantly. She had not saved since 9pm. Five hours of work, gone. She had to start again and she missed the deadline.*

Now watch this." [Open the Google Doc on the projector. Type a sentence. Pause. Point to the top of the screen.]

*"See that little message at the top that says **'Saved to Drive'**? I did not press Save. I do not have a Save button â€" well, I have Ctrl+S, but the document saves itself as I type. Every single keystroke goes to Google's servers. If this computer catches fire right now, my document is still safe. Funmi's problem cannot happen here.*

*But Docs is not only about saving. Today you will also learn to make a document look professional â€" with headings and tables and images â€" and to work on it **together** with other people at the same time. Then we will switch to **Google Sheets** and learn to make the computer do the maths: adding up your sales or expenses with one short formula instead of a calculator."*

Expected learner response: Learners commonly share their own "lost work" stories. Accept them warmly and connect them: "Every one of those stories is a reason this tool exists."

Hook â€" demonstrate collaboration: On the projector, open the same Google Doc on the instructor's phone or a second logged-in window, type a change, and let learners watch it appear in the other window within a second. Say:

> *"Two people, two devices, one document, live. That is what you will be able to do before this session ends."*

Why this opener works: It starts with a universally painful and very Nigerian problem â€" power cuts destroying unsaved work â€" and immediately delivers the solution visually ("Saved to Drive"). It ends with a live collaboration demo that creates curiosity about the rest of the session.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run as a fast oral round-robin. Put the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "Where do we save files in this course, and what does cloud storage protect us from?"

- Expected answer: In Google Drive; it protects us from theft, fire, flood and computer failure because the files live on Google's servers.
- Common gap: learners may still save to the Desktop from habit. Reinforce: create and edit in the cloud.

Question 2: "What are the three sharing roles, and which one lets a person comment but not change the content?"

- Expected answer: Viewer, Commenter, Editor; **Commenter** can comment but not edit the content.
- Common gap: confusing Commenter and Editor. Clarify.

Question 3: "Why do we keep General access on 'Restricted'?"

- Expected answer: So only the people we choose can open the file; "Anyone with the link" exposes it publicly.
- Common gap: learners think links are private by default.

Question 4: "In Gmail, what is a label, and how is it different from a folder?"

- Expected answer: A label is a tag; one email can have many; a folder holds an item in one place only.
- Common gap: some still think labels and folders are the same. A quick reminder is enough.

Question 5: "How do you find a file quickly in Drive?"

- Expected answer: Search bar with the name or operators like `type:` and `is:starred`.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have your files organised (Session 1) and your email organised (Session 2). Today we fill the folder with real work. A document lives in your Drive folder and can be shared like any other file. A spreadsheet does the same â€" but it also calculates. The sharing rules from Session 1 apply here exactly: Viewer to read, Commenter to review, Editor to co-work."*

If the room struggles with Question 2 or 3, spend a couple of extra minutes reinforcing sharing safety, because collaboration today depends on it.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

These notes are the actual teaching. Read them as written.

F.1 Google Docs â€” what it is and why it matters

The idea. Google Docs is a **word processor** that runs in your browser and saves to Google Drive. You use it to write and format documents: letters, reports, CVs, proposals, minutes, assignments.

Plain-English definition. A word processor is software for writing text and making it look good â€” choosing fonts, sizes, headings, lists, tables, images. Microsoft Word is the famous one you install; Google Docs is the free online version, and it lives in the cloud.

Why it exists. Word processing needs three things that paper typewriters cannot give: the ability to edit easily, the ability to format professionally, and the ability to share. Google Docs adds a fourth, powerful thing: **real-time collaboration** â€” several people can type in the same document at once.

Familiar analogy â€” the shared exercise book. Writing a letter in Microsoft Word is like owning one exercise book. If you want a colleague to work on it, you must photocopy it and pass it around â€” and now there are two versions that disagree. Google Docs is like a single exercise book lying open on a table that everyone you invite can write in at the same time, and at any moment you can look back and see who changed what.

What Docs does for you:

- **Auto-save** to Drive â€” no lost work, no Save button needed (the screen shows **Saved to Drive**).
- **Formatting** â€” make documents look professional.
- **Collaboration** â€” share, comment, suggest, edit together.
- **Version history** â€” see and restore earlier drafts.
- **Export** â€” download as PDF, Word (.docx), and more.

Worked example â€” Adaeze's grant letter. Adaeze needs to ask for an SME grant application form. She writes the letter in Google Docs, formats it properly, exports it as a PDF, and emails a Drive link to the grant office. Because it is a PDF, it looks the same on the officer's computer as it does on hers â€” the layout cannot shift. We build this exact letter in the practical.

Common misconception. "I must click Save." You do not. Docs saves continuously. You *can* press `Ctrl+S`, but it is not necessary â€” the honest truth is that if you see **Saved to Drive**, your work is safe. (The one thing not to do is close the tab mid-typing on a very slow connection; give it a second to catch up.)

Limitation. Google Docs is excellent for documents, but it is **not** strong at very complex print layouts (magazines, posters with detailed positioning) â€” for those, designers use specialised tools. For letters, reports, CVs and everyday business documents, Docs is more than enough.

F.2 The Docs interface and formatting basics

How to get there. Open Chrome and either:

- Go to `docs.google.com`, or
- Go to Drive, click **+ New â†' Google Docs**.

To name the document: click the box at the top-left that says **Untitled document**, type a clear name (use your naming convention, e.g. `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Grant-Letter - v1`), and press Enter. The title also becomes the file name in Drive.

The toolbar â€” the main controls:

Control	What it does
Styles dropdown (usually shows "Normal text")	Applies a style: Normal text, Title, Subtitle, **Heading 1**, Heading 2, Heading 3
Font	Changes the typeface (e.g. Arial, Times New Roman)
Font size	Changes the size (e.g. 11, 12, 14)
B / I / U	**Bold**, *Italic*, Underline
Text colour / highlight	Changes the colour of text or the marker behind it

Control	What it does
Insert link	Makes selected text open a website (see F.4)
Add comment	Opens a comment box on the selected text
Insert image	Adds a picture
Align	Left, Centre, Right, Justify
Line & paragraph spacing	Adjusts spacing
Bulleted / numbered list / checklist	Creates lists
Indent / outdent	Moves paragraphs in or out

Formatting text â€” the exact steps:

1. **Select** the text (click and drag over it, or double-click a word).
2. Apply the change from the toolbar â€” e.g. click **B** to bold it, or pick a font size.
3. To remove formatting, select it and use the **Format â† Clear formatting** option.

The golden formatting rule for beginners. Do not format word by word by hand. Instead, use **styles**. This is the most important formatting concept today â€” see F.3.

Common misconception. Learners bold and enlarge headings manually, one line at a time. That "looks" like a heading but is not really one â€” and later, tools like the table of contents and outline cannot see it. Use the **Styles** dropdown for headings; that is what it is for.

F.3 Heading styles â€” structure that works for you

The idea. A **heading style** is a pre-set format (size, boldness, spacing) applied to a title or section heading. Instead of guessing that "16pt bold" looks right, you apply **Heading 1**, **Heading 2** and **Heading 3**, which are consistent and carry meaning.

Why styles matter. Styles do more than make text look nice:

- They create an **outline** (the left-hand panel) that lets you jump around a long document.
- They let you build a **table of contents** automatically.
- They keep formatting **consistent** â€” every Heading 2 looks the same, with no accidental differences.
- If you change a style, every heading of that type updates at once.

Analogy â€” the street sign system. Numbered house numbers (1, 11, 111) tell the postman exactly where a house is. Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3 are like the levels of a building: floor, room, cupboard. Structure helps everyone find their way â€” including you, a month later.

How to apply a heading style:

1. Click on the line you want as a heading (e.g. the document title).
2. Open the **Styles** dropdown (it says "Normal text" by default).
3. Choose **Title** for the document title, **Heading 1** for main sections, **Heading 2** for subsections.
4. The line is formatted instantly, and the **outline** panel on the left updates.

Table of contents. For a long document (a report, a proposal), go to **Insert â† Table of contents**. Docs builds it from your headings. (It works best when you have used heading styles â€” a direct payoff of doing it right.)

Worked example. In Adaeze's grant letter, the document title "Adaeze Fashion" is the letterhead, not a heading; but in a longer *business profile*, she would make "About the Business" a Heading 1, "Products" a Heading 1, and "Pricing" a Heading 2 under Products. Then a table of contents builds itself at the top.

Common misconception. Learners think Heading 1 is "the biggest heading" only. Size is part of it, but the real value is the **structure** it records â€” which the outline and table of contents use.

F.4 Inserting tables, images and links

Tables. A table arranges information in rows and columns â€” perfect for price lists, timetables, comparisons.

- **Insert â†' Table**, then drag across the grid to choose rows and columns (e.g. 3 columns Ã— 4 rows), or use **Insert â†' Table â†' Insert table** and type the numbers.
- Fill the cells by clicking and typing. Add or delete rows by **right-clicking** a cell â†' **Insert row above/below**, **Delete row**.
- Table borders and cell background are edited via **Format â†' Table** or the border/shading controls.

Images. You can add pictures to make a document clearer or more attractive.

- **Insert â†' Image**, then choose **Upload from computer**, **Search the web**, **Drive**, **Photos**, or **By URL**.
- Resize by dragging a corner handle. Wrap text around it via the image options.
- For Adaeze's business profile, an image of her Ankara designs makes the profile come alive.

Links. A hyperlink is text you click to open a web page (or another file).

- Select the text, then **Insert â†' Link** (or press `Ctrl+K`), paste the web address, and press Enter.
- Example: the words "our website" could link to `https://adaezefashion.example`.

Say to the class:

> *"A table is for things that repeat in rows and columns â€" like a price list. An image is for things that are easier to see than to read â€" like a design. A link is for pointing someone somewhere else â€" like a website or a form. Use each for its proper job."*

Common misconception. Learners paste huge images straight from a phone, which makes documents slow. For a professional document, use reasonably sized images. (Google usually compresses them, but do not paste 20-megapixel photos when a smaller version will do.)

F.5 Page setup, auto-save and exporting (PDF and Word)

Page setup. To change margins, paper size and orientation: **File â†' Page setup**. Here you can set:

- **Orientation** â€" Portrait (tall) or Landscape (wide).
- **Paper size** â€" A4, Letter, etc.
- **Margins** â€" the white space around the edges.
- **Page colour** â€" usually left white.

Auto-save. As you type, Docs saves to Google Drive automatically. The top of the screen shows **Saved to Drive** when everything is up to date (it may briefly show "Savingâ€¦"). You do not need a Save button â€" but `Ctrl+S` does no harm.

Download / export. To give someone a copy in a fixed format:

- **File â†' Download**, then choose:
  - **Microsoft Word (.docx)** â€" for people who use Word.
  - **PDF Document (.pdf)** â€" for a fixed layout that looks the same everywhere (best for official letters and CVs).
  - **OpenDocument (.odt)**, **Rich Text (.rtf)**, **Plain text (.txt)**, **Web page (.html)**.

Why PDF is the professional default for finished documents. A PDF "freezes" the layout. Your letter looks identical on the grant officer's computer, whether they use Windows, Mac or a phone. If you send a `.docx`, the layout can shift if they have a different font or software version.

Other useful File options:

- **File â†' Make a copy** â€" create an independent duplicate (useful as a template).
- **File â†' Share â†' Publish to web** â€" turns it into a public web page (use with care; it is for things you genuinely want public).
- **File â†' Move** â€" relocate the document into the correct Drive folder (your Session 1 skill).

Worked example. Adaeze finishes her grant letter, clicks **File â†' Download â†' PDF Document (.pdf)**, and the PDF lands in her computer's Downloads folder. She uploads it to her `Adaeze Fashion/01-Admin` folder in Drive and emails the link. The officer sees exactly what Adaeze intended.

Common misconception. Learners think exporting removes the Google Doc. It does not â€" the Google Doc stays in Drive; the export is an extra copy on the computer.

F.6 Collaboration â€” sharing, commenting and suggesting

The idea. Docs is built for several people to work on one document. You already know the sharing roles from Session 1; now you use them *inside* a document.

Sharing a Doc:

1. Click the blue **Share** button (top-right).
2. Add people by email and choose their role:
   - **Viewer** â€” read only.
   - **Commenter** â€” can read and comment, and can use Suggesting mode, but cannot directly change the content.
   - **Editor** â€” can change anything.
3. Set **General access** to **Restricted** (default), and click **Send**.

The three modes (top-right, a dropdown). Inside the document, the mode button lets you switch how *you* work:

- **Editing** â€” you type directly; changes are immediate.
- **Suggesting** â€” your changes appear as **suggestions** (in a different colour) that others can **Accept** or **Reject**. This is like "tracked changes" in Word.
- **Viewing** â€” read only.

Suggesting mode is the collaboration superstar. When a colleague might disagree with your edit, suggest rather than change. The document owner accepts what they like and rejects what they do not â€” with a full record of who suggested what.

Comments. Leave a note without altering the text:

1. **Select** the words you are commenting on.
2. Click the **Add comment** icon in the toolbar, or press `Ctrl+Alt+M`, or use **Insert â†' Comment**.
3. Type your comment and click **Comment**.
4. The commenter or an editor can **Reply**, and when the issue is handled, click **Resolve** to remove it from view (it is kept in the history).

Mentioning people. In a comment, type `@` followed by a name to **assign** the comment and notify that person. They get an email and a notification.

Worked example â€" the collaborative letter. Adaeze shares her grant letter with her accountant as **Commenter**. The accountant selects the sentence about employment numbers and comments: *"We now have five staff, not four â€" please update."* Because he is a Commenter, he cannot silently change it. Adaeze updates it and clicks **Resolve**. Clean, tracked, professional.

Say to the class:

> *"If you are the owner, you edit. If you are reviewing someone else's work, you comment or suggest. Never silently change another person's document when the role they gave you was Commenter â€" that is the digital equivalent of changing someone's letter after they signed it."*

Common misconceptions:

- "If I share as Editor, the other person's changes appear instantly and I cannot stop them." True â€" that is why you use Commenter or Suggesting when you want control.
- "Resolving a comment deletes it forever." It hides it from view but keeps it in history; you can re-open resolved comments.

Limitation. Anyone with Editor access can also delete content. For important documents, prefer Commenter/Suggesting during review, and give Editor only to people you trust to co-own the document.

F.7 Version history â€" your time machine

The idea. Version history records every change made to a document, with who made it and when. You can look back and, if needed, restore an earlier version.

How to open it: File â†' Version history â†' See version history. A right-hand panel appears listing versions by date and time, often with the names of people who edited.

What you can do:

- Click any version to **preview** it (it highlights what changed).
- Click the three-dot **â‹®** next to a version â†' **Restore this version** to bring the whole document back to that state.
- **Name this version** â€" give an important milestone a label like "Draft for client review", so you can find it easily later.

Analogy -> Ctrl+Z beyond the grave. `Ctrl+Z` undoes your last few actions in the current session. Version history is `Ctrl+Z` that reaches back in time â€" days, weeks or months â€" and can recover even after you closed the document or someone else edited it.

Worked example. A staff member accidentally deletes a whole section of Adaeze's business profile. Adaeze opens **Version history**, finds the version from before the deletion, previews it (the section is present), and clicks **Restore this version**. The work is back in seconds.

Common misconception. Learners think the "Save" nature of Docs means there is only one version. There are many â€" Docs keeps the history automatically.

Limitation. Version history is powerful but not a substitute for good naming. For major drafts, you can also use **File â†' Make a copy** and give it a version number (v1, v2) so you have clearly separated files.

F.8 Google Sheets â€" what it is and how the grid works

The idea. Google Sheets is a **spreadsheet** â€" a grid of rows and columns used to store data and, crucially, to **calculate** with it. Where Docs is for words, Sheets is for numbers.

Plain-English definition. A spreadsheet is a grid where each box (cell) can hold a number, text or a formula. Change one number, and every formula that uses it updates automatically. This is why accountants, shop owners and analysts live in spreadsheets.

Why it exists. Imagine Adaeze adds up her monthly expenses on a calculator. If she later fixes one wrong amount, she must re-add everything. In a spreadsheet, she changes the one wrong cell and the total recalculates itself instantly. Spreadsheets also sort, filter and chart data.

The grid vocabulary â€" learn these exactly:

- **Column** â€" runs vertically, labelled with letters: A, B, C, Dâ€¦
- **Row** â€" runs horizontally, labelled with numbers: 1, 2, 3, 4â€¦
- **Cell** â€" one box, where a column and row meet. A cell is named by its column letter + row number: `B2` means column B, row 2.
- **Range** â€" a rectangle of cells, written as `firstcell:lastcell`, e.g. `C2:C11` means the cells from C2 down to C11.
- **Active cell** â€" the one currently selected (shown with a blue border); its reference appears in the **Name box** (top-left).
- **Formula bar** â€" the long bar near the top where you type or edit what is in the active cell.
- **Sheet tabs** â€" at the bottom; a single file (workbook) can contain several sheets, e.g. "October" and "November".

Analogy â€" the accountant's ledger book. A paper ledger has rows and columns where an accountant writes amounts and totals. A spreadsheet is the same ledger, but the totals do the arithmetic themselves and never make a mistake.

Worked example â€" naming a cell. In Adaeze's expense sheet, the first expense amount (Fabric - Ankara, â‚¦45,000) sits in column D, row 2 â€" so its reference is `D2`. If she wants the total of all amounts, she will ask Sheets to add the range `D2:D11`.

Common misconception. Learners think Sheets is "just a table like in Docs". A table in Docs only *displays* data; a spreadsheet *calculates* it. That is the whole reason to use Sheets.

F.9 Entering and formatting data (including Naira)

Entering data:

1. Click a cell (e.g. `A1`).
2. Type the content (a heading like "Date", or a value like `45000`).
3. Press **Enter** to move down, or use **Tab** to move right.
4. To edit, double-click the cell or select it and edit in the **formula bar**.

Entering dates and numbers. Sheets recognises dates if you type them in a clear format (e.g. `2026-10-01` or `01/10/2026`, depending on locale). Numbers are typed plainly (`45000`, no commas). Do **not** type the Naira sign into the cell if you want to

calculate â€" type the number and let Sheets add the formatting.

Formatting numbers as Naira (â‚¦):

1. Select the cells with amounts (e.g. `D2:D11`).
2. Go to **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency**.
3. In the currency settings, choose **Nigerian Naira (â‚¦)** from the currency dropdown (the exact wording can vary between versions; look for NGN / Naira, or type the â‚¦ symbol). Confirm.
4. The amounts now display as â‚¦45,000.00 etc. â€" but the underlying value is still the number 45000, so formulas still work.

(You can also use the quick **currency** and **percent** buttons on the toolbar, but those may default to a different currency â€" set the Naira custom currency once to be safe.)

Other useful formatting:

- **Bold** your header row so it stands out.
- **Borders** (the border icon) â€" draw lines around your table for readability.
- **Text wrapping and alignment** â€" centre headings with the align buttons.
- **Format â†' Number â†' Date** â€" to standardise date display.

Worked example. Adaeze types 10 expenses. The amounts go in column D as plain numbers. She selects `D2:D11` and applies **Custom currency â†' Nigerian Naira**, and the column shows â‚¦ signs. She bolds row 1. The sheet now reads like a proper business record.

Common misconception. Learners type "â‚¦45,000" by hand into cells. Then the cell holds *text*, not a number, and `SUM` cannot add it â€" you get 0 or an error. **Type the number; format the currency.** This is the single most common Sheets mistake (see Section K).

Limitation. Spreadsheets obey exactly what the cell *is*. A number stored as text looks fine but breaks calculations. When a total looks wrong, suspect a text-number first.

F.10 Basic formulas â€" making the computer do the maths

The idea. A **formula** is an instruction that starts with an equals sign `=` and calculates something. The result shows in the cell; the formula shows in the formula bar.

The five formulas for this session:

Formula	What it does	Example	Meaning
`=SUM(range)`	Adds all numbers in a range	`=SUM(D2:D11)`	Total of the amounts
`=AVERAGE(range)`	The mean (average) of the numbers	`=AVERAGE(D2:D11)`	Average expense
`=MIN(range)`	The smallest number	`=MIN(D2:D11)`	Cheapest expense
`=MAX(range)`	The largest number	`=MAX(D2:D11)`	Most expensive expense
`=COUNT(range)`	How many **numeric** cells there are	`=COUNT(D2:D11)`	Number of expenses recorded

How to write a formula:

1. Click the cell where you want the answer (e.g. `D13`).
2. Type `=` to begin.
3. Type the formula name and the range, e.g. `=SUM(D2:D11)`.
4. Press **Enter**. The answer appears.

- Shortcut for SUM: select the range and click the **Î£ (Sum)** button in the toolbar, or use the menu **Insert â†' Function â†' SUM**.

Important notes about these functions:

- `SUM` adds numbers.
- `AVERAGE` divides the total by how many numbers there are (ignoring blank and text cells).
- `MIN` and `MAX` give the smallest and largest

- `COUNT` counts only cells that contain **numbers** â€" if some cells contain text or are blank, `COUNT` skips them. (If you need to count all non-empty cells including text, that is `COUNTA` â€" an advanced note.)

Worked example â€" Adaeze's expense sheet. The ten amounts are in `D2:D11`. Adaeze writes:

- `=SUM(D2:D11)` â†' the total of all expenses.
- `=AVERAGE(D2:D11)` â†' the average expense.
- `=MIN(D2:D11)` â†' the smallest (â‚¦2,500, sewing machine oil).
- `=MAX(D2:D11)` â†' the largest (â‚¦62,000, fabric - lace).
- `=COUNT(D2:D11)` â†' 10 (ten expenses recorded).

She uses template labels so she knows what each number means: put "TOTAL" in `C13` and the formula in `D13`; "AVERAGE" in `C14` and its formula in `D14`, and so on.

Familiar analogy. A formula is like giving instructions to a very fast, very obedient clerk. You do not say "add these ten numbers in your head"; you say "add everything from D2 to D11" â€" and the clerk never makes an arithmetic mistake.

Common misconceptions:

- "I can just use the calculator app." You can, for one sum. But when one number changes, you must redo it. A formula updates itself.
- "Numbers typed with a â‚¦ sign work in SUM." They do not â€" that is text. Type plain numbers and format them.
- "COUNT counts every cell." `COUNT` counts only numbers; blank or text cells are skipped.

Limitation. These five functions are the foundation, not the whole story. Real accountants use many more (`IF`, `VLOOKUP`, pivot tables). You have the essential vocabulary now; the rest is a natural next step.

F.11 Charts, freezing, sorting and filtering

Charts â€" making numbers visible.

- Select your data (including headings), e.g. `A1:D11` or just `B1:C11`.
- Go to **Insert â†' Chart**.
- The **Chart editor** opens on the right. In **Setup**, choose the **chart type** â€" a **Column** chart (vertical bars) or **Bar** chart is a good start for comparing expenses by category; a **Pie** chart shows proportions.
- In **Customize**, you can add a title, change colours and label the axes.
- The chart appears on the sheet and updates automatically if the data changes.

Freezing a header row. When you have many rows, scroll down and the header (Date, Item, Category, Amount) scrolls out of sight, so you forget which column is which. **Freeze** it:

- **View â†' Freeze â†' 1 row** (freezes row 1), or **1 column**, or **Up to current row** if your cursor is on a lower row.
- Now the header stays visible as you scroll.

Sorting. To arrange data in order:

- Select the data range, then **Data â†' Sort range**, choose the column to sort by (e.g. Amount, largest first).
- To sort the whole sheet simply, use **Data â†' Sort sheet** â€" but be careful: it sorts everything, so know what you are doing.

Filtering. A filter hides rows that do not match a condition, without deleting them:

- Select the range, then **Data â†' Create a filter** (or click the **filter** icon in the toolbar).
- Small dropdown arrows appear in the header cells. Click one and choose what to show â€" e.g. show only expenses in the **Materials** category.
- Click **Filter** again (or **Data â†' Remove filter** â†' **Turn off filter**) to bring everything back.

Worked example. Adaeze filters her expense sheet to show only **Materials** expenses, sorts them by amount from largest to smallest, freezes the header row, and inserts a column chart comparing spending by category. In two minutes she can *see* that fabric is her biggest cost â€" an insight worth real money.

Common misconceptions:

- "Filtering deletes the hidden rows." It does not; it only hides them.
- "Sorting one column is safe." If you sort only one column of a table and not the rest, the rows no longer line up. Always sort the **whole range** (or use Sort sheet).

Limitation. Charts and filters are only as good as the data. If a number is stored as text, the chart may misbehave â€" another reason formatting and data types matter.

F.12 Summary of the lecture

- **Google Docs** = free online **word processor** that auto-saves to Drive (look for **Saved to Drive**).
- Format with the toolbar and structure with **heading styles** (Heading 1/2/3) â€" they power the outline and table of contents.
- Insert **tables, images and links**; set **page setup**; **download as PDF** or **.docx**.
- Collaborate with **sharing roles** (Viewer/Commenter/Editor), **comments** and **Suggesting mode**.
- **Version history** (File â†' Version history) shows and restores earlier drafts.
- **Google Sheets** = free online **spreadsheet**; cells have references like `B2`; ranges like `D2:D11`.
- Type **plain numbers**; apply **Naira formatting** with **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency**.
- Five core formulas: `=SUM`, `=AVERAGE`, `=MIN`, `=MAX`, `=COUNT`.
- **Insert â†' Chart** for charts; **View â†' Freeze** for the header; **Data â†' Sort / Create a filter** for organising rows.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A logged-in Google account on the projector.
- The sample business letter text and sample expense data ready to paste.
- A second email address for the sharing demonstration.
- A blank Doc and a blank Sheet created in Drive (or create them live).

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" a formatted Doc (6 minutes)

Say: "Watch me turn plain text into a professional letter."

1. In Drive, click **+ New â†' Google Docs**. Click **Untitled document** and rename it `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Grant-Letter - v1`.
2. Paste or type the sample business letter.
3. Apply formatting:
   - Select the first line ("Adaeze Fashion") and make it **bold** and larger. Say: "The letterhead."
   - Select the subject line and **bold** it.
   - Use the **Align** button to left-align the body.
4. **Deliberately do it the wrong way first:** make a heading bold + size 16 by hand. Say: "This looks like a heading, but Docs does not know it is one." Then click the line and choose **Heading 1** from the **Styles** dropdown. Point at the **outline** on the left updating. Say: "Now it is a real heading."
5. **Insert â†' Table**: choose a 3Ã—3 table. Fill in Product, Quantity, Price. Say: "Tables are for repeating rows and columns."
6. **Insert â†' Image** and add any picture (or skip if none ready). Resize by dragging a corner.
7. Select some words, press `Ctrl+K`, paste a web address, press Enter. Say: "That is a link."
8. Point at **Saved to Drive** at the top. Say: "No Save button needed."
9. **File â†' Download â†' PDF Document (.pdf)** and show the PDF appearing in Downloads. Say: "A fixed copy that looks the same everywhere."

Mistakes to watch and correct: manually formatting headings instead of using styles; pasting an enormous image; forgetting to rename from "Untitled document".

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" collaborate and version (4 minutes)

Say: "Now let's work on this letter together."

1. Click **Share**, add the second email as **Commenter**, set **Restricted**, click **Send**.

2. Switch the top-right mode to **Suggesting**. Type a change to a sentence. Show the suggestion appear in a different colour with an **Accept/Reject** option. Say: "I did not change the document; I suggested."
3. Select a phrase and press `Ctrl+Alt+M` to add a comment. Type *"Please confirm the number of staff."* Click **Comment**. Type `@` and pick a person to show the mention.
4. Click **Resolve** on the comment. Say: "Handled and hidden, not lost."
5. **File â†' Version history â†' See version history.** Preview an earlier version. Show **Restore this version**. Say: "My time machine."
6. Switch back to **Editing** mode.

Questions to ask: *"If I gave my accountant Viewer instead of Commenter, could he comment?"* â†' No. *"Can I undo a colleague's edit from last week?"* â†' Yes, via version history.

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" a Sheets expense tracker (5 minutes)

Say: "Now for the numbers. Watch the computer do the adding."

1. In Drive, click **+ New â†' Google Sheets**. Rename it `2026-10 - AdaezeFashion - Expense-Tracker - v1`.
2. Type the headings in row 1: **Date, Item, Category, Amount**.
3. Paste or type the 10 expense rows.
4. Select `D2:D11`, then **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency**, choose **Nigerian Naira (â,¦)**. Point at the â,¦ signs appearing.
5. Click `D13`. Type `TOTAL` in `C13`. In `D13` type `=SUM(D2:D11)` and press Enter. Say: "One formula, no calculator."
6. Add `AVERAGE` in `C14` / `=AVERAGE(D2:D11)` in `D14`; `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT` below it.
7. **Deliberately break it:** type an amount as `"â,¦1,000"` (with the sign, as text). Show the SUM not changing or erroring. Say: "Text is not a number." Fix it by typing `1000` and formatting.
8. **View â†' Freeze â†' 1 row.** Scroll to show the header stays.
9. **Data â†' Create a filter**, then filter to show only **Materials**.
10. **Insert â†' Chart** â€" pick a Column chart comparing amounts by category. Add a title.

Expected results: a clean, formatted tracker with a correct total, an average, smallest and largest values, a count, a frozen header, a working filter and a chart that updates when data changes.

Mistakes to watch and correct: typing currency signs; using the wrong range (e.g. `D2:D10` missing a row); sorting only one column; creating a chart from the wrong selection.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes)

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner formats a business document in Google Docs and builds a working expense tracker in Google Sheets.

Starting materials: A logged-in Google account; the sample letter text and expense data from Section C; the Drive folder `Adaeze Fashion - [Your Name]` from Session 1 (or create it now).

Part 1 â€" The Document (about 8 minutes)

1. In Drive, open your `Adaeze Fashion - [Your Name]` folder, then **+ New â†' Google Docs**.
2. Rename the document `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Grant-Letter - v1`.
3. Paste the sample business letter. (If you prefer, type the first paragraph in your own words.)
4. Select the first line and make it **bold** and larger â€" this is the letterhead.
5. Use the **Styles** dropdown to make the subject line "REQUEST FOR SME GRANT APPLICATION FORM" a **Heading 1**. **Pause and predict:** *"Will this show up in the outline on the left?"* (Yes.)
6. **Insert â†' Table** and add a small 3Ã—3 table under the letter listing three products and their prices.
7. **Insert â†' Image** and add any picture (use "Search the web" if you have none), then resize it.
8. Select the words "Rivers State SME Support Scheme" and press `Ctrl+K` to turn them into a link to `https://riversstate.gov.ng` (or any address).
9. Check the top of the screen says **Saved to Drive**. **Pause and predict:** *"If I close this tab now without pressing Save, is the document safe?"* (Yes â€" it auto-saves.)
10. **File â†' Download â†' PDF Document (.pdf)** and confirm the PDF appears in your Downloads.

Part 2 â€" The Spreadsheet (about 10 minutes)

11. Back in your Drive folder, click **+ New â†' Google Sheets**. Rename it `2026-10 - AdaezeFashion - Expense-Tracker - v1`.
12. In row 1, type the headers: `Date`, `Item`, `Category`, `Amount`.
13. Enter the 10 sample expense rows (Date in column A, Item in B, Category in C, Amount in D as **plain numbers**).
14. Select `D2:D11` and apply **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency â†' Nigerian Naira (â‚¦)**.
15. In `C13` type `TOTAL`; in `D13` type `=SUM(D2:D11)`.
16. In `C14` type `AVERAGE`; in `D14` type `=AVERAGE(D2:D11)`.
17. In `C15` type `LOWEST`; in `D15` type `=MIN(D2:D11)`. In `C16` type `HIGHEST`; in `D16` type `=MAX(D2:D11)`. In `C17` type `COUNT`; in `D17` type `=COUNT(D2:D11)`.
18. **Pause and predict:** "*What will AVERAGE give if the numbers sum to â‚¦213,500 across 10 expenses?*" (â‚¦21,350.)
19. **View â†' Freeze â†' 1 row.** Scroll down; confirm the header stays.
20. **Data â†' Create a filter**, then use it to show only **Materials** expenses.
21. **Insert â†' Chart** â€" choose a **Column chart**. Give it a title like "Expenses by Category".

Expected result: A formatted letter (letterhead, heading, table, image, link) saved as both a Google Doc and a PDF; and a spreadsheet with 10 correctly typed expenses, Naira formatting, five working formulas with correct values, a frozen header, a working filter and a chart.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- The `SUM` shows 0 â†' an amount is stored as text (has a currency sign or is left-aligned). Retype as a plain number.
- The formula shows as text instead of calculating â†' the cell probably does not start with `=`; retype it starting with `=`.
- Wrong total â†' the range is wrong (e.g. `D2:D10` instead of `D2:D11`).
- PDF missing â†' check the browser's **Downloads**; some browsers ask permission first.
- Chart looks wrong â†' the selected range probably included text or empty cells; reselect just the data.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Document renamed with the naming convention
- ☐ Letterhead bold/larger; subject is **Heading 1**
- ☐ A table with 3 products inserted
- ☐ An image inserted and resized
- ☐ A hyperlink created
- ☐ Top shows **Saved to Drive**
- ☐ PDF exported and confirmed
- ☐ Spreadsheet renamed; 10 expenses entered as plain numbers
- ☐ Amounts formatted as **â‚¦ Naira**
- ☐ `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT` all correct
- ☐ Header row frozen
- ☐ Filter created and used
- ☐ Column chart created

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: Create a **customer quotation document** in Docs and a **sales tracker** in Sheets for a **different** fictional business, on your own.

Scenario: You are the assistant manager at *Naija Kitchen*, a small local-food catering business in Port Harcourt. The owner needs a professional quotation letter for a customer, and a simple spreadsheet to track this week's sales.

Requirements â€" Part 1 (Docs quotation):

1. Create a Doc named `2026-10 - NaijaKitchen - Quotation-Letter - v1`.
2. Write a short quotation letter (about one paragraph of introduction and a closing), addressed to a customer who has ordered food for an event.

3. Make the business name the **letterhead** (bold, larger) and use **Heading 1** for the subject line "QUOTATION FOR CATERING SERVICES".
4. Include a **table** with at least four items and their prices (e.g. Jollof rice per plate, Grilled chicken, Small chops, delivery).
5. Add a **hyperlink** to a fake website (e.g. `https://naijakitchen.example`).
6. **Export** it as a **PDF**.
7. **Share** it with the instructor's assessment email as **Commenter**.

Requirements â€" Part 2 (Sheets sales tracker): 8. Create a Sheet named `2026-10 - NaijaKitchen - Sales-Tracker - v1`. 9. Headers in row 1: `Date`, `Customer`, `Item`, `Quantity`, `Unit Price`, `Total`. 10. Enter at least **8 sales rows**. For the **Total** column, write a formula per row that multiplies Quantity by Unit Price (e.g. in `F2`: `=E2*D2`). 11. Format the **Unit Price** and **Total** columns as **Naira (â‚¦)**. 12. Add summary formulas below the table: **total sales** (`=SUM(F2:F9)`), **average sale** (`=AVERAGE(F2:F9)`), **number of sales** (`=COUNT(F2:F9)`). 13. **Freeze** row 1 and create a **filter**. 14. Insert a **chart** showing sales totals.

Constraints:

- All money values must be **plain numbers** with Naira *formatting*, not typed currency signs.
- The row Total must be a **formula**, not a typed number.
- Do **not** type the totals by hand â€" that defeats the purpose.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Success criteria:

- A professional quotation Doc with letterhead, Heading 1, a four-item table, a link, exported to PDF and shared as **Commenter**.
- A sales Sheet with 8 rows, a per-row `=quantity*price` formula, Naira formatting, correct `SUM` / `AVERAGE` / `COUNT`, frozen header, a filter and a chart.

Hints available if stuck:

- Hint 1: For the row total, click the Total cell and type `=D2*E2` (whatever your quantity and unit-price columns are), then press Enter. Copy the formula down by dragging the small blue square (fill handle) at the corner of the cell.
- Hint 2: To format Naira, select the money cells â†' **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency** â†' choose **Nigerian Naira (â‚¦)**.
- Hint 3: The `SUM` goes in one cell and adds the whole Total column, e.g. `=SUM(F2:F9)`.

Instructor answer key (do not show learners):

Docs quotation â€" model content:

```
Naija Kitchen
Mile 3 Market Road, Port Harcourt | 0803 000 0000

QUOTATION FOR CATERING SERVICES   (Heading 1)

Dear Mrs. Amaka,

Thank you for your enquiry about catering for your event on 20 October 2026. Please find our quotation below. All prices are per the

[Table]
Item              | Quantity | Unit Price | Total
Jollof Rice (plate)| 50      | â‚¦2,500     | â‚¦125,000
Grilled Chicken    | 50       | â‚¦3,500     | â‚¦175,000
Small Chops (pack) | 30       | â‚¦2,000     | â‚¦60,000
Delivery           | 1        | â‚¦15,000    | â‚¦15,000
                                TOTAL: â‚¦375,000

We would be delighted to serve your guests. Visit us at https://naijakitchen.example.

Yours sincerely,
[Your Name], Assistant Manager
```

Sheets sales tracker â€" model:

- The per-row formula in `F2` is `=D2*E2`, dragged down to `F9`.
- Summary: `=SUM(F2:F9)`, `=AVERAGE(F2:F9)`, `=COUNT(F2:F9)`.
- Note: the quotation table in Docs does *not* calculate automatically (that is a limitation of a Docs table) â€" the totals there are typed. In Sheets, the totals are formulas.

Marking guidance (out of 10):

- Doc letterhead + Heading 1 (2)
- Doc four-item table with prices (2)
- Doc hyperlink + PDF export + shared as Commenter (2)
- Sheet 8 rows with quantity*price formulas (2)
- Naira formatting correct (1)
- SUM/AVERAGE/COUNT correct + frozen header + filter + chart (1)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY

Situation. *The Rumuola Youth Foundation* (the NGO from Session 2) is preparing a fundraising report for a partner organisation in Abuja. Two staff members â€" the programme officer and the accountant â€" must produce one report: written sections and a budget table. In the past they emailed a Word document back and forth. The file names became `report.doc`, `report_final.doc`, `report_final2.doc`, `report_final_REALLY.doc`. Twice, the partner received the wrong version, and once the accountant's budget numbers were missing from the version that was sent because the two editors had overwritten each other's changes.

Relevant facts.

- The report needs both narrative text (explaining the programmes) and a budget (numbers).
- Two people must contribute and review.
- The partner needs a fixed, professional final file.
- The team already uses Google accounts but has been "doing it the Word way".

Decision point. Should the Foundation (a) keep emailing Word documents, (b) build the report in a single Google Doc with a linked Google Sheet for the budget, using Suggesting mode and comments, or (c) have the accountant produce everything alone to avoid conflicts?

Possible approaches and trade-offs.

1. **Keep emailing Word versions.** Familiar but the version chaos continues; overwriting is likely; the partner may get the wrong file. *Trade-off: no learning curve, high error and embarrassment risk.*
2. **One Google Doc + a linked Google Sheet, with Suggesting mode and comments.** Everyone works in one live document; the accountant owns the numbers in the Sheet; the programme officer suggests text changes; version history keeps a full record; the final is exported as a PDF. *Trade-off: a short learning curve, but eliminates version chaos and overwriting.*
3. **Accountant does everything.** Removes conflict but overloads one person and loses the programme officer's expertise. *Trade-off: simpler human process, poorer report and a bottleneck.*

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. The programme officer drafts the narrative in a Google Doc and shares it as **Commenter** with the accountant for budget notes. The accountant keeps the budget in a **Google Sheet** â€" so the numbers calculate automatically and update when figures change â€" and the Doc links to it or pastes the final numbers once. Reviewers use **Suggesting mode** and **comments**. When approved, they **File â†' Download â†' PDF** and send the PDF (or a Restricted link). **Version history** is their safety net if anyone deletes a section.

Trade-offs of the recommendation. The team must learn Docs and Sheets and agree on who owns which part. If they edit the same sentence simultaneously, they can still clash â€" Suggesting mode and clear ownership reduce this. And a linked Sheet is only as good as the access setting: it must be shared with the right people, at the right role.

Professional connection. This is everyday work in offices, NGOs, schools and businesses: producing one accurate document from several contributors without version chaos. The skills â€" heading styles, tables, Suggesting mode, comments, version history, a calculated spreadsheet, and PDF export â€" are exactly the skills employers expect of an administrative or programme assistant. The team that masters this looks organised and trustworthy; the team that emails `final_final2` looks chaotic.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this as the session's live troubleshooting guide. Have the learner confirm the cause before fixing.

K.1 The `SUM` gives 0 or an error â€” numbers stored as text

Symptoms: `=SUM(D2:D11)` shows `0`, or the total is too low. **Likely causes:** (a) Some amounts were typed with a currency sign or comma (`â‚¦45,000`) and are stored as **text**. (b) Amounts were pasted from a source that treated them as text. (c) A trailing space. **How to investigate:** Click a suspicious cell â€” numbers are **right-aligned** by default; text is **left-aligned**. Look at the **formula bar**; if it shows `â‚¦45,000` as text, that is the cause. **Corrective steps:** Retype the value as a plain number (`45000`) and apply Naira **formatting** instead of typing the sign. You can also use **Format â†’ Number â†’ Number** to convert. **How to confirm resolved:** The cell right-aligns and the `SUM` updates. **Prevention:** Always type plain numbers; format the currency via the menu.

K.2 The formula shows as text instead of calculating

Symptoms: The cell displays `=SUM(D2:D11)` literally. **Likely cause:** The cell was formatted as **Plain text** before the formula was typed, or the leading `=` is missing. **How to investigate:** Check the formula bar and the cell's format. **Corrective steps:** Set the cell to **Format → Number → Number** (or Automatic), then retype the formula starting with `=`. **Prevention:** Format cells as numbers before writing formulas.

K.3 The heading does not appear in the outline / table of contents

Symptoms: The heading looks big but the outline is empty. **Likely cause:** The heading was formatted **by hand** (bold + size) instead of using the **Styles** dropdown. **How to investigate:** Click the line and look at what the Styles dropdown says â€” if it says "Normal text", it is not a real heading. **Corrective steps:** With the line selected, choose **Heading 1 / 2 / 3** from the Styles dropdown. **Prevention:** Always use styles for headings.

K.4 Shared the wrong way â€” Commenter cannot edit, or Editor changes silently

Symptoms: A reviewer complains they cannot type; or your document changes without your knowledge. **Likely cause:** Wrong sharing role. Commenter can only comment/suggest; Editor can change everything. **How to investigate:** Open **Share** and read each person's role. **Corrective steps:** Change the role to what is needed â€” Commenter for review, Editor only for trusted co-authors. **Prevention:** Use least privilege; prefer Suggesting mode during review.

K.5 Lost work "someone deleted a section"

Symptoms: Content that existed earlier is gone. **Likely cause:** An editor deleted it, or a bad paste replaced it. **How to investigate: File → Version history → See version history**; find the version before the deletion. **Corrective steps:** Preview that version and **Restore this version** (or copy the missing part back). **Prevention:** Keep a named milestone version before big edits; limit Editor access.

K.6 Chart looks wrong or empty

Symptoms: The chart shows odd values or nothing. **Likely cause:** The selected range included headings/empty cells incorrectly, or text-number cells were included. **How to investigate:** Check exactly which cells were selected for the chart; click a suspicious source cell. **Corrective steps:** Reselect just the data columns (including or excluding headers deliberately), and fix any text-numbers. **Prevention:** Clean your data types before charting.

K.7 Sorting scrambled the data

Symptoms: After sorting one column, the rows no longer match up (dates next to wrong items). **Likely cause:** Only one column was sorted instead of the whole table. **How to investigate:** Look down the rows â€” do the fields still belong together? **Corrective steps:** Undo (`Ctrl+Z`), then select the **entire range** and use **Data → Sort range**, or use **Sort sheet**. **Prevention:** Always sort the whole data range; watch the warning Sheets may show.

K.8 Exported PDF is missing or opens oddly

Symptoms: The downloaded PDF is not in the expected place or looks different. **Likely causes:** The browser saved it to a different folder; permission prompt was missed; unusual fonts/columns. **How to investigate:** Check the browser's **Downloads** list; open the PDF to inspect. **Corrective steps:** Re-export with **File → Download → PDF**; check page setup (margins/orientation) before exporting. **Prevention:** Use **File → Page setup** and preview before exporting official documents.

K.9 "I cannot find my Doc/Sheet in Drive"

Symptoms: The file is not where the learner expects. **Likely cause:** It was created in the wrong Drive location. **How to investigate:** Search Drive by name, or open **Recent**. **Corrective steps:** Open the file, use **File â†' Move** to put it in the correct folder. **Prevention:** Open the destination folder **before** clicking **+ New â†' Google Docs/Sheets**.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed. For each case, treat the cause as *likely* until you verify it â€" click the cell and see it is text, open the Share panel and see the role, open version history and see the deletion. Then fix the confirmed problem.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Business Docs"

Purpose: To demonstrate that you can independently produce a professionally formatted document and a working, calculating spreadsheet, and collaborate safely â€" the Week 1 document and spreadsheet deliverables.

Realistic scenario: You have been hired as an assistant by a small Port Harcourt business of your choice (or use Adaeze Fashion). The owner needs a polished one-page business document and a functional spreadsheet to track money.

Detailed instructions:

1. **Google Doc â€" Business Profile (or a quotation/invoice letter).** Create a document named `2026-10 - [Business] - Business-Profile - v1` containing:
   - A **letterhead** (business name, address, phone, email) â€" bold and professional.
   - A **Heading 1** for at least one main section.
   - At least two paragraphs of business description.
   - A **table** (e.g. products/services with prices).
   - At least one **image**.
   - At least one **hyperlink**.
   - Export it as a **PDF**.
   - Share it with the instructor's assessment email as **Commenter**.
2. **Google Sheet â€" Sales or Expense Tracker.** Create a sheet named `2026-10 - [Business] - Tracker - v1` containing:
   - Headers and at least **12 rows** of realistic data.
   - Money formatted as **Naira (â‚¦)** (values typed as plain numbers).
   - At least one **per-row formula** (e.g. `=quantity*price`).
   - Summary formulas: `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN` **or** `MAX`, `COUNT`.
   - A **frozen header row**, a **filter**, and a **chart**.
3. **Collaboration proof:** add one **comment** to your own document (e.g. a note to yourself) and **resolve** it; and capture a screenshot of **version history** showing at least two versions.
4. Write a short paragraph (5â€"8 lines) explaining which tool you used for which part of the task, and why Docs is right for the letter while Sheets is right for the money.

Required deliverables:

- The **PDF** of your profile/letter.
- A share link to the Doc (set to **Restricted**, with the assessment email added as **Commenter**).
- A share link to the Sheet (Restricted, assessment email added as **Commenter** or **Viewer**).
- Screenshots showing: the Sheet's formulas and Naira formatting; the chart; the version-history panel.
- Your workbook paragraph.

Submission format: Add the PDF and screenshots to the class submission document, and paste the two Restricted share links. Do not publish anything publicly.

Deadline: Before Session 4 (Task Management).

Marking rubric (30 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Doc formatting and structure	6	Letterhead, Heading 1 used, clean alignment; consistent style

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Doc table, image, hyperlink	5	Sensible table; image inserted; working link
Doc export and sharing	4	Exported to PDF; shared as **Commenter**; Restricted
Sheet data and formatting	5	12+ rows; money as plain numbers formatted â‚¦; tidy layout
Sheet formulas	6	Correct per-row formula; correct `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN/MAX`, `COUNT`
Sheet features and chart	2	Header frozen; filter works; chart present and correct
Collaboration and explanation	2	Comment resolved; version history shown; clear explanation of tool choice

Common mistakes to avoid: typing currency signs into cells; formatting headings by hand instead of styles; sharing as Editor by default; forgetting to export the PDF; mixing up column references in formulas.

Instructor reference solution:

Doc: A one-page profile titled with the business name as letterhead, "OUR SERVICES" as Heading 1, two description paragraphs, a 4-row price table, one image, a link to the business website, exported to PDF and shared as Commenter.

Sheet: Columns `Date, Item, Category, Amount` (or `Date, Customer, Item, Qty, Unit Price, Total`). Amounts as plain numbers formatted `â‚¦`. Per-row total `=E2*D2`. Summary: `=SUM(...)`, `=AVERAGE(...)`, `=MIN(...)`, `=MAX(...)`, `=COUNT(...)`. Header row frozen, filter applied to Category, a column chart of category totals.

Paragraph model: "I used Google Docs for the business profile because it is a written document I needed to format and export as a PDF. I used Google Sheets for the tracker because the numbers must calculate themselves â€" when I change one amount, the total, average and chart update. In the Sheet, I typed plain numbers and used the Naira custom currency format."

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key that follows.)

Q1. Short answer. Where does a Google Doc save your work, and how do you know it has saved?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which range represents the cells from **B2 down to B10**? a) `B2+B10` b) `B2:B10` c) `B2-B10` d) `B2..B10`

Q3. Explain in your own words. What is the difference between **Commenter** and **Editor** when sharing a document, and why does the difference matter?

Q4. Practical identification. Name the correct **formula** for each job: a) The total of the numbers in `D2:D11`. b) The average of the numbers in `D2:D11`. c) The largest number in `D2:D11`. d) How many numbers are in `D2:D11`.

Q5. Error detection. A learner types `â‚¦45,000` into a cell, then writes `=SUM(D2:D11)` and gets `0`. What is the problem and how do they fix it?

Q6. Scenario. You must send a finished CV to an employer. Should you send the Google Doc link, a `.docx` file, or a **PDF**? Explain your choice.

Q7. Short answer. What is **version history** for in Google Docs, and how do you open it?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q7)

A1. It saves automatically to **Google Drive**. You know it has saved when the top of the screen shows **Saved to Drive** (it may briefly show "Savingâ€¦").

A2. (b) `B2:B10`.

A3. A **Commenter** can read and leave comments or suggestions but cannot directly change the content; an **Editor** can change or delete the content. It matters because you should give people only the access they need â€" reviewing someone's draft should not mean the power to silently alter it. Use Commenter for review, Editor only for trusted co-authors.

A4. a) `=SUM(D2:D11)`; b) `=AVERAGE(D2:D11)`; c) `=MAX(D2:D11)`; d) `=COUNT(D2:D11)`.

A5. The value was typed as **text** because it includes the â‚¦ sign (and comma). `SUM` ignores text, so it adds nothing and returns 0. Fix: retype the value as the plain number `45000`, then apply **Format â†' Number â†' Custom currency â†' Nigerian Naira (â‚¦)**

to display the currency.

A6. Send a **PDF**. A PDF freezes the layout so the CV looks exactly as you designed it on any computer or phone, regardless of the employer's software or fonts. A `.docx` can shift when opened in a different version of Word; a Google Doc link depends on the employer having (and being comfortable with) access.

A7. Version history records every change with who made it and when, letting you look back and **restore** an earlier version if something is deleted or spoiled. Open it with **File â†' Version history â†' See version history**.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you moved from storing and sending to *creating*. In **Google Docs** you made a document that **auto-saves** to Drive (no lost work, even with power cuts), learned to format it and to use **heading styles** that build an outline and table of contents, inserted **tables, images and links**, set **page options**, and **exported** your work as a **PDF** or **Word** file. You learned to collaborate safely using **sharing roles**, **comments** and **Suggesting mode**, and you used **version history** as a time machine. In **Google Sheets** you learned the grid â€" **cells** like `B2`, **ranges** like `D2:D11` â€" typed data and formatted it as **Naira (â¦)**, and wrote five formulas: `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT`. You froze a header, sorted and filtered, and made a chart. Most importantly, you can now choose the right tool: **Docs for words, Sheets for numbers.**

Five important takeaways:

1. Google Docs auto-saves to Drive â€" look for **Saved to Drive** â€" so your work survives even a sudden power cut.
2. Use **heading styles** (not manual bold+size) to create real structure, outlines and tables of contents.
3. Collaborate with the right role: **Commenter** to review, **Editor** to co-edit; use **Suggesting mode** and **comments** for controlled feedback.
4. In Sheets, type **plain numbers** and apply **Naira formatting**; write formulas with `=` â€" `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNT`.
5. **Export finished documents as PDF** for a fixed, professional look; use **Docs for writing, Sheets for calculating**.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I create and format a document with a heading style and a table, without help?
- Can I export a document as a PDF?
- Can I share a document as Commenter and add/resolve a comment?
- Can I build a small spreadsheet with a `SUM` and an `AVERAGE` that updates itself?
- Can I explain when to use Docs and when to use Sheets?

Connection to the next session. You can now create and organise documents and spreadsheets. But there is one more kind of digital clutter: **tasks** â€" the things you must do, with deadlines and priorities. Next week opens with **Task Management**: capturing tasks, setting priorities and deadlines, organising them by project, and building the daily review habit that ties your Drive and Gmail systems together.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner applies a real **heading style** rather than hand-formatting, and can say why.
- The learner exports a document as PDF without help.
- The learner distinguishes **Commenter** from **Editor** and uses Suggesting mode appropriately.
- The learner types **plain numbers** and applies Naira **formatting**, and explains why.
- The learner writes a correct `=SUM(range)` and can point out the range on screen.
- The learner freezes a header and filters without prompting.
- The learner chooses Docs vs Sheets correctly with a reason.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "I must press Save." â†' Docs saves automatically; look for **Saved to Drive**.
- "Typing â¦ in the cell is fine." â†' It becomes text and breaks formulas.

- "A big bold line is a heading." â†’ Only the Styles dropdown makes a real heading.
- "Editor is friendliest, so share as Editor." â†’ Use least privilege; Commenter to review.
- "Filtering deletes data." â†’ It only hides rows.
- "Sorting one column is fine." â†’ Sort the whole range, or rows misalign.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Cell-reference drill:** give a small grid and ask for the reference of six named cells and the range of a shaded block.
2. **Formula drill:** give five spreadsheet tasks and ask the learner to write the formula for each.
3. **Format drill:** give a list of items and ask "type as number, or type as text?" and how to format currency.
4. **Docs structure drill:** give a paragraph and ask the learner to mark which lines should be Heading 1 vs normal.
5. **Tool-choice drill:** give ten tasks and ask "Docs or Sheets, and why?"

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a Doc with the letterhead already done and a Sheet with headers and two rows filled; the learner formats, adds formulas and exports.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the exercise as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** add a second sheet tab ("November") and a summary on the first tab that references it; add a pie chart of spending by category; set a named version ("Ready for client") in version history; and build a reusable **invoice template** in Docs with blanks.

Timing guidance: If the room is slow, trim the chart and filter steps to a demonstration only, and protect the Doc letter and the `SUM` / `AVERAGE` work, which are the core skills. If Wi-Fi is weak, keep the sample text ready to paste to save typing time. If the class is fast, add the Level 3 invoice-template challenge.

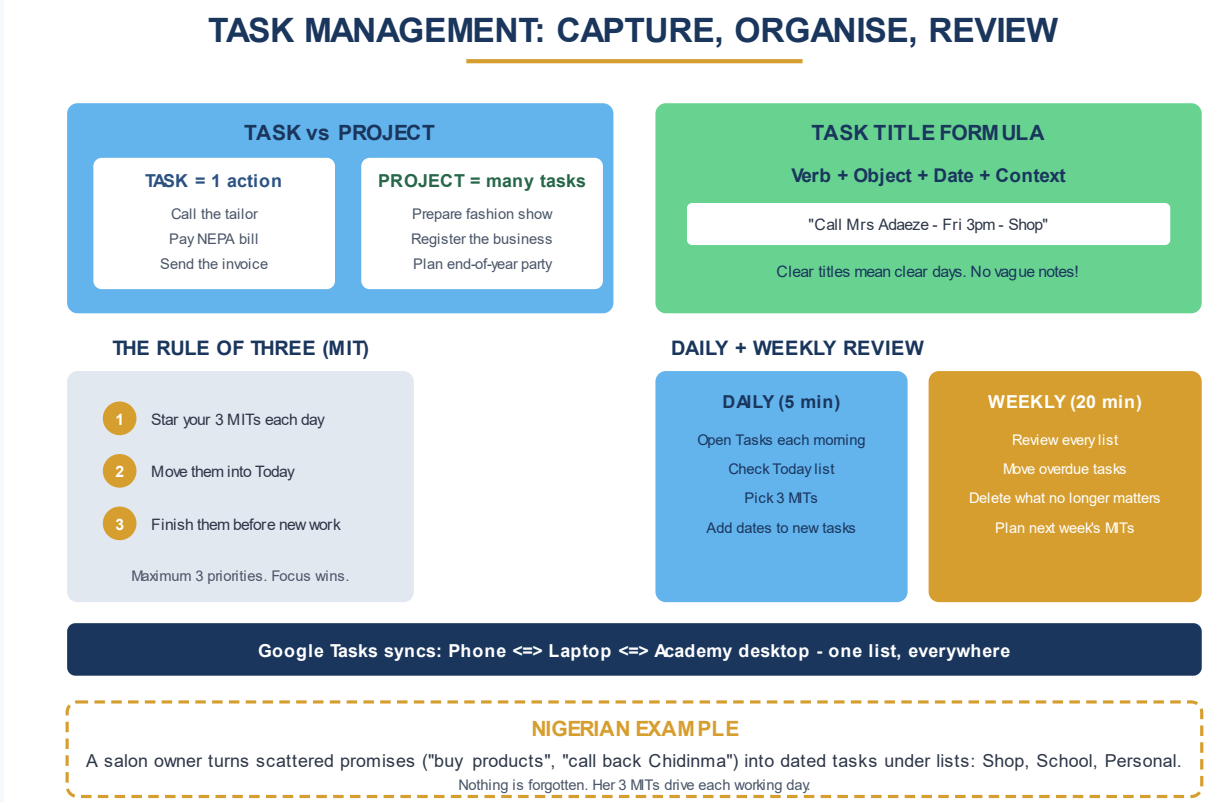
END OF SESSION 3

Next: Session 4 â€" Task Management.

SESSION 04 OF 6

Task Management

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 04



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 4 â€" TASK MANAGEMENT

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	4 of 6
Session title	Task Management
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Task Management and Workflow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"3. The learner should already be able to create a Google Drive folder, find a file, use Gmail labels, and write in Google Docs. If a learner cannot sign into Gmail or open Google

Item	Detail
	Tasks, run the 10-minute login refresher in Section E before continuing.
Connection to previous work	In Week 1 learners organised what they already had â€" files in Drive, email in Gmail, documents in Docs and Sheets. But organising what you *have* is only half of productivity. This session organises what you still need to *do* â€" your promises, deadlines and commitments â€" so that nothing important is forgotten.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged into Gmail; Google Tasks reachable at tasks.google.com and through the Gmail right-side panel; projector ready; printed Eisenhower matrix handout; printed "Task Anatomy" cheat sheet; a set of scenario cards for the guided and independent exercises.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Explain in their own words** why human memory and paper notebooks lose commitments, and why a digital task list prevents this.
2. **Distinguish a task from a project**, and give three examples of each, using a Nigerian small-business context.
3. **Open Google Tasks** in two ways â€" as a full page (`tasks.google.com`) and as the Gmail side panel â€" and describe the main parts of the screen.
4. **Create a task** with a clear title, written details (notes), a due date and a due time.
5. **Break a large task into subtasks** so that a big job becomes a short, doable checklist.
6. **Prioritise** using the star, the "Most Important Tasks" (MIT) method, and the Eisenhower matrix.
7. **Organise tasks into lists** that represent projects or contexts (for example `Shop` , `School` , `Personal`).
8. **Perform a daily review** and explain what the weekly review (the "weekly review ritual") adds.
9. **Explain how Google Tasks keeps tasks in sync** across a phone, a laptop and the academy desktop.
10. **Convert a messy scenario** (a list of scattered promises) into a clean, organised task system with dates and priorities.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops). A shared computer between two learners is acceptable; pair them so one types and one reads the list aloud, then swap halfway.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large screen.

Software

- Google Chrome (any recent version).
- Google Tasks â€" free, included with a Gmail account. Reachable at `tasks.google.com` , or from the right-side panel inside Gmail or Google Calendar.
- Google Keep â€" free, included with a Gmail account, at `keep.google.com` (used in this course only for **notes**, not tasks).

Accounts

- A Gmail account (created or already existing). The same account must be used on any phone the learner wants to sync with.

Sample files

- Scenario cards printed for the guided and independent exercises (contents given in Sections H and I). No computer files are needed for this session.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 4.1 â€" "Task or Project?" (printed, 1 page).
- Worksheet 4.2 â€" "My First Tasks" (in the learner workbook, Part 3).

- Handout 4.3 â€” Eisenhower matrix grid (printed).

Tools

- Google Tasks web app and the Gmail side panel.
- A phone with the Google Tasks app is optional but recommended to demonstrate syncing.

Internet

- Required. Google Tasks is a cloud tool; without internet it will not save. (The mobile app can work offline and sync later, but the desktop version we use in class needs internet.)

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any device that can open Chrome and log into Gmail works. If a learner has only a phone, pair them with a desktop user for the guided exercise, and afterwards let them repeat the steps on the Google Tasks phone app.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes) â€” "The Promise on Scrap Paper"

Instructor setup: On the projector, hold up (or show on screen) a small torn piece of paper with rough writing on it. Do not open any app yet.

What the instructor says:

> *"Look at this paper. On it is written: 'Give Ngozi the wedding dress Friday. Collect â‚¦15,000 balance.' Adaeze wrote this on Friday morning at her shop in Rumuola. By afternoon she was busy with three customers. On Saturday she found the paper inside a folded newspaper and threw the newspaper away. Ngozi never got her dress on Friday. Adaeze lost â‚¦15,000 and, worse, lost a customer who now tells people, 'That tailor is not reliable.'*
>
> *Now think about yourself. Where do you keep the things you must not forget â€” the school assignment due Thursday, the church meeting on Saturday, the money you promised to pay? A notebook? A phone note? Your head? Today we replace all of that with one free tool that remembers everything and even reminds you on the right day."*

The hook (do this live): Open `tasks.google.com` on the projector and type one task:

- Title: `Give Ngozi the wedding dress`
- Date: the coming Friday Say: "*Same promise. But now it can never be lost in a newspaper, and on Friday morning it will appear at the top of my list.*"

Expected learner response: Learners may say "I use my phone notes", "I write it in my exercise book", or "I just remember it". Accept all answers. Point out gently that phone notes and exercise books are a good start, but they do not put the item in front of you on the correct day, and they do not tell you what to do *first*. Confirm that today we add dates, priorities and reminders.

Why this opener works: It starts with a small, familiar, painful story (a lost customer) rather than a definition, and it gives an instant taste of the tool solving the exact problem â€” so the class begins with doing, not listening.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this quickly as an oral round-robin. Put the four questions on the projector.

Question 1: "In Google Drive, what does a good folder structure look like â€” deep or shallow?"

- Expected answer: shallow â€” about two to three levels, with a predictable naming pattern (for example `01-Admin`, `02-Designs`).
- Common gap: learners create many nested folders. Remind them: if you have to click four times to reach a file, the structure is too deep.

Question 2: "In Gmail, what is the difference between a label and a folder?"

- Expected answer: Gmail uses **labels** (like tags), and one email can carry more than one label. A traditional folder holds a file in only one place.
- Common gap: learners still picture folders. Re-state: labels let one message belong to many categories at once.

Question 3: "In Google Docs, where does your work go while you type â€" do you press Save?"

- Expected answer: no; Docs saves automatically to the cloud, and version history lets you recover older versions.
- Common gap: learners think they must save manually. Clarify that auto-save is on by default.

Question 4: "In Google Sheets, which formula adds up the numbers in cells `B2` to `B10`?"

- Expected answer: `=SUM(B2:B10)`.
- Common gap: learners forget the `=` sign at the start. Remind them every formula begins with `=`.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Week 1 was about putting your things in order â€" files, emails, documents. Week 2 is about putting your time in order. A tidy Drive is useless if you still forget to send the invoice that was due yesterday. Today we build the list that remembers for you."*

If more than a third of the class cannot answer Question 1, spend 8 extra minutes reviewing the Drive folder pattern before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 Why memory and paper fail

The idea. Every promise you make â€" to a customer, a lecturer, your church, your family â€" is an "open loop". It is something you have started in your mind but not yet finished. Open loops are heavy: they keep pulling at your attention.

Why it matters. The human brain is excellent at thinking and terrible at storing lists. Research on memory (and everyday experience) shows that a person can hold only a handful of items in mind at once. When you try to hold twenty promises, you do not remember all of them â€" you remember the loudest one and forget the rest.

Plain-English definition. A **task** is a single, specific thing you must do. **Task management** is the habit of writing every task down immediately, organising it, and reviewing it so that you act on the right things at the right time.

Real-life comparison. Your brain is a **general, not a filing cabinet**. It should be used for doing and deciding, not for storing hundreds of small notes. Writing a task down is like giving a heavy bag to a porter â€" your hands are free again.

The three ways people lose commitments:

1. **Memory** â€" you simply forget.
2. **Paper** â€" the notebook is at home, or the page is lost, or the writing is unclear.
3. **Chaos** â€" the note exists but lives in one of five places (phone notes, a WhatsApp message to yourself, the back of a receipt), so you cannot find it when you need it.

A digital task list fixes all three because it is always with you, searchable, and able to put the right item in front of you on the right day.

F.2 Task versus project â€" the most important distinction

Many beginners fail at task management because they mix two different things in the same list.

A task is a single action that one person can finish in one sitting. It starts with a verb.

- `Call Ngozi about the dress fitting`
- `Pay NEPA bill`
- `Email the invoice to Chinedu Electronics`

A project is an outcome that needs *several* tasks to complete. A project is a container of tasks.

- Project: **"Launch the October collection"** â€" contains tasks such as `Buy 10 yards of Ankara`, `Design the flyer`, `Sew sample dress`, `Photograph samples`, `Post on WhatsApp status`.

Why the difference matters. You cannot "do" a project in one action â€" you can only do the next task. Beginners write a project as if it were a task: `Prepare October collection`. That line sits in the list forever because it never feels "doable". The fix is to

break the project into tasks.

	Task	Project
Size	One action	Many actions
Example	`Text the tailor to confirm pickup`	"Produce the October collection"
Lives in Google Tasks as	a task in a list	a **list** (the list is the project)
Test	Can I start and finish it now?	Do I need several steps?

A useful rule: if you are not sure whether something is a task or a project, ask "Can I finish this in one go?" If no, it is a project â€" turn it into a list and add the first task.

F.3 Why a digital task list beats memory and notebooks

A notebook is not evil â€" it is a good first step and many successful people use one. But a digital list has advantages a notebook cannot match:

Feature	Notebook	Google Tasks
Always with you	Only if you carry it	Yes â€" phone, laptop, anywhere you sign in
Reminder on the due day	No, unless you check every morning	Yes â€" appears at the top on the day
Search	Slow, page by page	Instant
Reorder by urgency	Must rewrite the page	Drag, or sort by date
Sync	One copy only	Same list on every device
Lost or damaged	Gone	Safe on Google's servers
Break into subtasks	Rewrite	Built-in subtasks

Say this to the class:

> *"A notebook is a record of what you wrote. A digital task list is a tool that tells you what to do today. Those are different jobs."*

Important limitation (do not over-promise). Google Tasks is simple by design. It does not do complex project scheduling, Gantt charts or team assignments. For a small business, a church office or a student, simple is usually better â€" but be honest that a large company with fifty staff would need a heavier tool.

F.4 Google Tasks versus Google Keep â€" and why we choose Tasks

Both are free with a Gmail account, but they are built for different jobs.

Google Keep is a **note app**. It is for information you want to keep and read: ideas, meeting notes, a shopping list, a recipe, a photo of a receipt, a voice note, a sketch. It has colours, labels, and reminders, and you can copy a note into a Google Doc. It is excellent for capturing *information*.

Google Tasks is a **to-do app**. It is for *actions* you must complete. It has task lists, due dates, due times, notes on a task, and subtasks. It is built to answer the question "what do I do next?"

Recommendation for this course: use **Google Tasks** as your main task system, and use **Google Keep** only when you need to store a note, an idea or a shopping list that is not really an action with a deadline.

Common misconception. Learners try to run their whole life inside Keep checklists. That works for shopping but breaks down for deadlines because Keep is not built around due dates the way Tasks is. Keep the two tools in their proper lanes:

Question	Use
"I must DO this by a date"	Google Tasks
"I must REMEMBER this information"	Google Keep

F.5 Getting around Google Tasks

There are two ways to open Google Tasks, and learners should know both:

1. **As a full page** â€" type `tasks.google.com` in Chrome, or in Gmail click the **Tasks** icon (a small checklist) in the far-right side panel.
2. **As a side panel** in Gmail, Google Calendar or Google Docs â€" click the **Tasks** icon on the right edge, or click the blue-and-yellow checklist symbol to open it beside your email.

Main parts of the screen (wording may vary slightly by version):

- **Task lists column (left):** shows your lists. There is a default list called **My Tasks**. To add a new list, click **Create new list** (a `+` sign) at the bottom of the column and type a name.
- **Main list area (centre):** shows the tasks in the selected list.
- **Add a task box (top of the list):** the box that says **Add a task**. Type a title and press **Enter**.
- **The circle (checkbox):** to the left of every task. Click it to mark the task complete; the task moves to the **Completed** section at the bottom.
- **The star:** to the right of each task title. Click it to mark an important task. This is how you prioritise in Google Tasks.
- **Task details panel (right):** opens when you click a task. Here you find **Add details** (notes), the **date/time** button, and **Add subtasks**.

Say this to the class:

> *"Think of a list as a folder for actions. `My Tasks` is the drawer, and each list inside it â€" `Shop`, `School`, `Personal` â€" is a labelled section. A task lives in exactly one list, but you can move it any time."*

F.6 Creating a task the right way â€" title, details, date, subtasks

A good task title has four parts. Use the "Task Anatomy" rule:

> ***Verb + Object + (Due date) + (Context)***

Bad task	Why it fails	Good task
`shop`	No verb, no object, no date	`Buy 10 Ankara bundles from Mile 1 market â€" Friday 4pm`
`invoice`	Which invoice? For whom?	`Email October invoice to Chinedu Electronics â€" Tuesday`
`call`	Call who, about what?	`Call Mama Ngozi to confirm cake order â€" today 2pm`
`assignment`	Which subject, when due?	`Submit Eco 101 assignment â€" Thursday 9am`

How to create a task with full details (exact steps):

1. Open Google Tasks at `tasks.google.com`.
2. Make sure the correct list is selected on the left (for example `Shop`).
3. Click **Add a task**, type the title `Buy 10 Ankara bundles from Mile 1 market`, and press **Enter**.
4. Click on the task text to open the **details panel** on the right.
5. Under the title, click **Add details** and type the note: `Budget â‚¦50,000. Ask for the blue print. Collect receipt.`
6. Click the **date/time** button. A small calendar opens â€" click the due date, for example Friday. To add a time, click **Add time** and choose `4:00 PM`. Close the calendar.

7. Click **Add subtasks** and type each smaller step, pressing **Enter** after each: `Withdraw â‚¦50,000`, `Confirm market opens`, `Take a photo of the print`.
8. Click outside the panel to close it. The task now shows the date under its title.

Worked example â€” breaking down a big job:

Project: **"Prepare October Collection"** (this is a *list*). Tasks inside it:

- `Buy Ankara fabric` â€” subtasks: `Write fabric list`, `Withdraw money`, `Go to Mile 1 market`, `Confirm quality`.
- `Design flyer` â€” subtasks: `Choose colours`, `Draft in Canva`, `Get feedback`, `Export image`.
- `Sew sample dress` â€” subtasks: `Take Adaeze's measurements`, `Cut fabric`, `Sew`, `Iron and finish`.
- `Market the collection` â€” subtasks: `Post on WhatsApp status`, `Send to customer list`, `Take orders`.

Say this to the class:

> *"A subtask is a big task that has been cut into small pieces. When you look at a subtask, you should feel 'I can do that now' â€" not 'this is too big'."*

Important limitation. Google Tasks shows only about one level of subtasks. If a step needs its own sub-steps, make it a new task or a new list.

F.7 Priorities â€" how to decide what to do first

Here is a fact learners must accept: **Google Tasks does not have a numbered "high/medium/low" priority field.** Many beginners look for one and give up. Instead we create priority using three simple tools.

Tool 1 â€" The star. Tap the star beside a task to mark it important. You can sort the list so starred items appear together.

Tool 2 â€" The Most Important Tasks (MIT) method. Each day, choose at most **three** tasks as your MITs. Star them, and do them before anything else. This is powerful because it stops a long list from paralysing you.

Tool 3 â€" The Eisenhower matrix. Decide by asking two questions: *Is it important?* and *Is it urgent?*

	Urgent	Not urgent
Important	**Do it now** (customer order due today)	**Schedule it** (learn a new skill, plan the month)
Not important	**Delegate / do quickly** (some phone calls, admin)	**Delete or park it** (aimless scrolling, low-value meetings)

Say this to the class:

> *"Most people spend their whole day on things that are urgent but not important â€" other people's emergencies. The matrix helps you protect time for the important-but-not-urgent work that actually grows your business."*

Worked example â€" Adaeze's Tuesday:

Task	Important?	Urgent?	Decision
`Deliver Ngozi's dress today`	Yes	Yes	Do now
`Learn to use Google Sheets for invoices`	Yes	No	Schedule Thursday 4pm
`Reply to a supplier's promotional WhatsApp`	No	Yes	Do quickly, 2 minutes
`Reorganise all old receipts`	No	No	Park in `Later` list

Common misconception. Learners star *everything*. If every task is important, nothing is important. Guide them to a maximum of three stars per day.

F.8 Organising tasks by project, list and context

A long flat list of fifty tasks is almost as bad as no list. We organise so the right tasks appear at the right time.

By project. Create a list for each big project: `October Collection`, `Client Orders`, `Church Programme`.

By context. Create lists for where or how you do the work: `At Shop`, `At Computer`, `Phone Calls`, `Errands` (things to do when you are out).

By area of life. For a student or a busy worker, `School`, `Work`, `Personal`, `Church` keeps the lists short and clear.

Recommended setup for this course (keep it to three to five lists):

- `Today` â€" the tasks you will do today (moved here in your morning review).
- `Shop` (or your business/project name)
- `School` (or `Work`)
- `Personal`
- `Later` â€" ideas and tasks with no date yet, parked here so they do not clutter your active lists.

How to move a task between lists: drag the task onto the list name on the left, or click the task, open the details panel, and use the list selector. Wording may vary slightly by version.

The `Today` list is the most powerful idea in this session. Every morning, you look at all your lists and move the handful of tasks you will actually do today into `Today`. Whatever is in `Today` is your real plan.

F.9 The "capture everything, first" habit

The idea. When a promise, idea or task appears, you must catch it *immediately* â€" before it escapes. This is called **capture**. The rule is:

> ***Capture first. Organise later.***

When a customer calls with an order, do not stop to decide which list it belongs to. Just capture it: open Google Tasks, type the title, press Enter. Later, in your review, you move it to the correct list with the right date.

Why it works. If you wait to "organise it properly", you will forget it. Capture is a net; organising is sorting the catch. A cheap, fast net catches more than a slow, careful one.

Real-life comparison. A fisherman does not sort each fish as it lands. He catches them all in the net first, then sorts them on shore. Capture is the net.

Where to capture:

- Google Tasks on your phone (fastest).
- The Tasks side panel inside Gmail â€" you can even **drag an email into the Tasks panel** to turn it into a task, or use the "Add to Tasks" option in the email toolbar (wording may vary). This is a favourite trick: an email that needs action becomes a task in one second.

Common misconception. Learners think capturing "messily" is bad. It is not â€" an ugly task in the right app beats a perfect task still in your head.

F.10 The daily review and the weekly review ritual

A task list only works if you look at it. Two reviews keep the system alive.

The daily review (about 5 minutes, every morning):

1. Open Google Calendar and check what is fixed for today (meetings, appointments).
2. Open Google Tasks and look through your lists.
3. Choose your **three MITs** for the day and star them.
4. Move today's tasks into the `Today` list.
5. Reschedule anything that cannot be done today to a later date, or move it to `Later`.
6. Clear the `Completed` section so the list looks fresh.

The weekly review ritual (about 30 minutes, same day each week â€" many people use Friday afternoon or Sunday evening):

1. Go through every list and ask of each task: *Is this still needed?* Delete the stale ones.
2. Add any tasks you captured during the week but never organised.
3. Check next week's calendar and create tasks for anything coming.
4. Review each project list and decide the *next action* for each project.
5. Update due dates so nothing important is quietly overdue.
6. Empty the `Later` list of anything that is now ready to schedule.

Say this to the class:

> *"The daily review keeps you honest for one day. The weekly review keeps your whole system healthy. Skip the weekly review for three weeks and your list becomes a graveyard â€" full of old tasks you no longer believe in."*

A metaphor: the daily review is brushing your teeth; the weekly review is going to the dentist. Both are needed, at different frequencies.

F.11 Keeping tasks synced across devices

Google Tasks is a **cloud** tool, like Drive and Gmail. This means:

- Sign into the **same Google account** on your phone, your laptop and the academy desktop, and you see the **same tasks** everywhere.
- Add a task on your phone at the market â€" it appears on your computer when you sit down.
- Changes sync automatically when you are online. If the phone is offline, you can still tick a task, and it will sync when the internet returns.
- The phone app can also show reminders at the task's due time (based on your phone's notification settings).

Important caution. Everything is tied to your Google account. If you sign into a *different* account, you will see a *different*, empty set of tasks. If a learner's tasks "disappear", the first thing to check is: *am I signed into the right account?*

F.12 Summary of the session

- Memory and paper lose commitments; a **digital task list** remembers, reminds and searches for you.
- A **task** is one action; a **project** is many tasks. In Google Tasks, a project is a **list**.
- Use **Google Tasks** for actions and **Google Keep** for notes.
- A good task title = **verb + object + due date + context**.
- Break big work into **subtasks**.
- Prioritise with the **star**, the **MIT method** (three per day) and the **Eisenhower matrix**.
- **Capture everything first, organise later.**
- Run a **daily review** (5 minutes) and a **weekly review** (~30 minutes).
- Tasks **sync** through your Google account â€" always check you are signed in correctly.

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Chrome signed into a demo Gmail account (use a clean "demo" account, not the learner's).
- `tasks.google.com` open in one tab; Gmail open in another tab with the Tasks side panel visible.
- A scenario on paper: *Adaeze Fashion Design â€" one week of promises*.
- The projector showing the instructor's screen.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" Setting up lists (4 minutes)

Say: "First we build the shelves before we put anything on them."

Exact steps on the projector:

1. Open `tasks.google.com`.
2. In the left column, find the default list `My Tasks`.
3. Click **Create new list** (the `+` sign at the bottom of the list column).
4. Type `Shop` and press **Enter**.
5. Repeat for `School`, `Personal`, `Today` and `Later`.
6. Click the three-dot menu (â‹®) beside `My Tasks` and rename it to `Adaeze Fashion` (or delete it after moving any tasks).

Expected result: the left column now shows the lists.

Reasoning to explain: "We use few lists on purpose. Five clear lists beat thirty confusing ones."

Things to watch: learners sometimes create a list for every single customer. Stop them â€" a list is a project or an area, not a person.

Question to ask: "Why might `Today` be different from `Shop`?" â†' Because `Today` is about *when*, `Shop` is about *what*.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" Creating rich tasks, subtasks and dates (7 minutes)

Say: "Now watch a real promise become a task that cannot be forgotten."

Exact steps:

1. Select the `Shop` list.
2. Click **Add a task**, type `Sew Ngozi's wedding dress`, press **Enter**.
3. Click the task to open the details panel.
4. Click **Add details** and type: `White lace, size 12. Collect â‚¦15,000 balance on delivery.`
5. Click the **date/time** button, choose the coming Friday, click **Add time** and set `4:00 PM`.
6. Click **Add subtasks** and add: `Take final measurements`, `Cut lace`, `Sew dress`, `Iron and bag`, `Text Ngozi pickup time`.
7. Click the **star** beside the task.
8. Now create two more tasks quickly: `Buy matching thread and zip` (due Thursday) and `Pay shop rent` (due tomorrow). Star `Pay shop rent`.

Expected result: three tasks, one with a note, a date/time and five subtasks; two starred.

Reasoning to explain:

- The note holds the *information*, so the title stays short and readable.
- The date puts the task on the right day.
- Subtasks turn a scary job into a short checklist.

Mistakes/things to watch:

- A learner may type the whole story in the title. Show how much cleaner it is with a short title plus details.
- No date means it will sink down the list. Every real commitment deserves a date, or it belongs in `Later`.

Question to ask: "Ngozi's dress is a *task* or a *project*?" â†' A task, because it can be done as one job. `Prepare the October collection` would be a project (a list).

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" The daily review, live (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch the five-minute habit that makes all of this work."

Exact steps:

1. Pretend it is Friday morning. Open Google Calendar in another tab and read out one event: "*10am â€" church committee meeting*."
2. Back in Google Tasks, look at the `Shop` list.
3. Move `Pay shop rent` (due today) into the `Today` list by dragging it onto `Today` on the left.
4. Star it as the day's MIT, along with `Sew Ngozi's wedding dress`.
5. Move `Buy matching thread and zip` to the coming Monday because the market is closed.
6. Click the circle on one already-done task to mark it complete and show it drop into `Completed`.
7. Open the completed section and clear it.

Expected result: the `Today` list shows only what will really be done today, starred items at the top.

Reasoning: "A list you do not review is just another place promises die. Five minutes every morning keeps the system alive."

Question to ask: "What do we do with the tasks we did not finish today?" â†' Reschedule them to a realistic day, or move them to `Later`. Do not just leave them overdue.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes) â€" "My Task System"

Objective: With the instructor guiding step by step, each learner sets up their own Google Tasks with at least two projects (lists), creates tasks with dates, builds one task with subtasks, and performs a daily review.

Starting materials: Each learner has their own Gmail login. The instructor displays a scenario on the projector.

The scenario (read aloud):

> *You work for **Adaeze Fashion Design**. This week you must handle the following: deliver Ngozi's wedding dress on Friday, order new Ankara fabric from Mile 1 market, email October invoices to three customers, submit your Eco 101 assignment on Thursday, pay the shop rent tomorrow, and book a photographer for the new designs.*

Procedure (instructor calls out each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. Open `tasks.google.com` and confirm you are signed into **your own** Gmail account.
2. Create these lists: `Shop`, `School`, `Today`, `Later`. (Your green header will show the name in capital letters â€" that is fine; list names are what matter.)
3. Select the `Shop` list. Add this task, pressing **Enter** after each:
   - `Sew Ngozi's wedding dress` (due Friday 4pm, star it)
   - `Order Ankara fabric from Mile 1 market` (due Wednesday)
   - `Email October invoices to 3 customers` (due Tuesday)
   - `Pay shop rent` (due tomorrow, star it)
   - `Book photographer for new designs` (no date â€" put this in `Later`)
4. Open the `Sew Ngozi's wedding dress` task, add the note `White lace, size 12, â‚¦15,000 balance`, and add three subtasks of your own.
5. Select the `School` list. Add `Submit Eco 101 assignment` due Thursday. Add one more school task of your choice with a date.
6. **Pause and predict:** "Before we do the review, how many tasks are starred, and how many are in the `Today` list?" Have learners answer on paper. (Answer: two starred; `Today` is empty.)
7. Do a daily review: move `Pay shop rent` and `Sew Ngozi's wedding dress` into the `Today` list. Star nothing new.
8. Tick off `Pay shop rent` as if you had paid it, then open the `Completed` section and clear it.

Expected result:

- Four lists exist: `Shop`, `School`, `Today`, `Later`.
- At least six tasks exist with correct dates.
- One task has a note and three subtasks.
- Two tasks are starred; `Today` shows the two moved tasks.
- `Completed` contains the ticked task (until cleared).

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 3: "Which task has no date, and where should it go?" â†' `Book photographer`; into `Later`.
- After step 6: "If I only star three things a day, is it okay that two are starred?" â†' Yes, three or fewer is the rule.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Tasks "missing" â†' check the learner is in the right list (the selected list name is shown at the top).
- Cannot find the date button â†' click the task to open the details panel; the date button is inside it.
- Subtasks not saving â†' click **Add subtasks**, type, then press **Enter**; click outside the panel to close.
- Different Google account â†' sign out and back in with the correct Gmail.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- [ ] Four lists created (`Shop` , `School` , `Today` , `Later`)
- [ ] At least six tasks created
- [ ] At least four tasks have due dates
- [ ] One task has a written note (details)
- [ ] One task has at least three subtasks
- [ ] Two tasks starred
- [ ] `Today` list holds the two daily MITs
- [ ] One task marked complete and `Completed` cleared

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: On your own, turn a messy week of personal commitments into a clean Google Tasks system. Do **not** copy the instructor's scenario.

Scenario: You are a **NYSC member in Port Harcourt** with a side business selling phone accessories. Next week you must: attend CDS on Wednesday, submit your monthly clearance letter to your PPA on Friday, restock chargers and screen guards, collect â‚¦8,500 a customer owes you, renew your data plan, attend a friend's wedding on Saturday, and start learning to design flyers. You also keep forgetting small things like buying toothpaste.

Requirements:

1. Create lists: `NYSC` , `Business` , `Personal` , `Today` , `Later` .
2. Capture the tasks above into the correct lists, using the **verb + object + date** rule. Add a due date where one makes sense.
3. Any item with no real deadline goes in `Later` .
4. Break the biggest task into at least three subtasks.
5. Star your three MITs for a typical day and move them into `Today` .
6. Add one new task of your own that you captured during the lesson.
7. Perform one full daily review and write, on paper, your three MITs for tomorrow.

Constraints:

- Every task title must contain a verb.
- No task in `NYSC` , `Business` or `Personal` may be longer than one line.
- At least one task must have a note.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Instructor answer key / model (do not show learners before they try):

Lists and tasks:

- `NYSC`
  - `Attend CDS meeting` â€" Wednesday
  - `Submit monthly clearance letter to PPA` â€" Friday (note: `Get PPA supervisor's signature first`)
  - `Renew data plan for clearance upload` â€" Thursday
- `Business`
  - `Restock chargers and screen guards` â€" Monday (subtasks: `Count current stock` , `Withdraw â‚¦30,000` , `Go to market` , `Update stock sheet`)
  - `Collect â‚¦8,500 from customer` â€" Tuesday
  - `Learn to design flyers` â€" no date â† `Later` (subtasks: `Watch one tutorial` , `Draft a practice flyer` , `Get feedback`)
- `Personal`
  - `Buy toothpaste` â€" Saturday
  - `Attend friend's wedding` â€" Saturday
- `Today`

    - `Attend CDS meeting`, `Collect â‚¦8,500 from customer`, `Restock chargers and screen guards` (three MITs, starred)
- `Later`
    - `Learn to design flyers` (parked until time allows)

Marking guidance (out of 15, this exercise is practice only):

- Four to five correct lists (3)
- All eight given items captured (3)
- Dates applied sensibly (3)
- One task with three-plus subtasks (2)
- Three MITs starred and moved to `Today` (2)
- Verby, one-line titles (2)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY â€” "The Salon That Forgot Appointments"

Situation. *Blessing* runs a small hair salon near Rumuokoro, Port Harcourt. She takes appointments on WhatsApp and "remembers" them. Last month she double-booked two bridal parties on the same Saturday, and forgot a regular customer who then went to another salon. She is losing both money and trust. She is not lazy â€” she is busy, and she keeps everything in her head.

Relevant facts.

- Blessing handles 15â€“20 appointments a week, plus stock, rent and staff pay.
- She has a smartphone with internet.
- She does not use any task or calendar app.
- Her busiest and most profitable jobs (bridal) need the most lead time and are the easiest to forget.

Decision point. How can a simple, free task system prevent double-booking and forgotten customers without slowing her down when a customer is standing in front of her?

Possible approaches.

1. Keep remembering, but write appointments in a paper diary.
2. Use Google Tasks with a `Today` list, a `Bridal` list and a nightly review.
3. Pay for a full salon booking software.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. When a customer books, Blessing captures the task in seconds on her phone: `Bridal - Chisom - Sat 10am (deposit paid)`. Her nightly five-minute review catches conflicts, and the next morning's `Today` list tells her exactly who is coming. She can also use Google Calendar for fixed appointment times.

Example capture lines:

- `Bridal - Chisom - Sat 10am - deposit â‚¦5,000 paid`
- `Wash and set - Ada - Wed 2pm`
- `Order relaxer stock - Friday`

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 is free but relies on her carrying the diary and remembering to read it; it failed once already.
- Approach 2 takes about ten minutes to set up and five minutes a night, removes double-booking, and costs nothing.
- Approach 3 is overkill and expensive for a one-person salon; it may be worth it only if she hires staff and opens a second branch.

Professional connection. Receptionists, administrators and project assistants are paid precisely because they keep systems that stop a business forgetting things. The skill taught today is the same skill that earns a salary in an office â€” written tasks, dates and a review routine.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

Use this table as the live troubleshooting guide. When a learner hits an issue, do not give the answer immediately â€" ask them to check the relevant row.

K.1 "My tasks have disappeared!"

Symptoms: The learner opens Google Tasks and sees an empty list, or a different set of tasks. **Likely causes:** (a) They are signed into the wrong Google account. (b) They are looking at a different list that is genuinely empty. **How to investigate:** Click the account circle (top-right) and confirm the email address. Look at the left column to see which list is selected. **Safe corrective steps:** Switch to the correct account, or click the correct list. **How to confirm resolved:** The expected tasks reappear. **Prevention:** Always sign into the same account on every device.

K.2 "Everything is marked urgent, I still don't know what to do."

Symptoms: Ten starred tasks; the learner feels paralysed. **Likely cause:** Over-starring. Star lost its meaning. **Corrective steps:** Un-star all but the three MITs for today. **Prevention:** Rule of three â€" maximum three stars per day.

K.3 "The task never gets done because it's too big."

Symptoms: A task has been moved forward for two weeks unchanged. **Likely cause:** It is really a project, not a task. **How to investigate:** Ask "Can I finish this in one action?" If not, it is a project. **Corrective steps:** Make it a **list**, then add the first small task. **Prevention:** Apply the verb + object test when creating every task.

K.4 "The task has no date and keeps sinking."

Symptoms: A task is old but still not done, with no due date. **Likely cause:** No date, so it never rises to the top. **Corrective steps:** Give it a real date, or move it to `Later` if it is truly not urgent. **Prevention:** Every active task gets a date; undated ideas live in `Later`.

K.5 "I captured the idea but never did anything with it."

Symptoms: The `Later` list fills up with items that never progress. **Likely cause:** No weekly review. **Corrective steps:** Do a weekly review and either date each item or delete it. **Prevention:** Protect the weekly review as a fixed appointment in your calendar.

K.6 "Tasks on my phone are different from my computer."

Symptoms: Two different lists on two devices. **Likely cause:** Different Google accounts on each device, or the device is offline. **Corrective steps:** Sign into the same account everywhere; connect to the internet and wait for sync. **Prevention:** Use one Google account for all work.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: In every case, the *likely* cause becomes a *confirmed* cause only after you check it (look at the account email, look at the list name). Teach learners to confirm before fixing.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Task Management System"

Purpose: To build a real, personal Google Tasks system that the learner will keep using after the course, demonstrating lists, dates, priorities, subtasks and a daily review.

Realistic scenario: You are starting a busy week managing a small enterprise (your own, or Adaeze Fashion Design). You must not forget a single commitment. Build the system that guarantees it.

Detailed instructions:

1. Open Google Tasks and create **at least three lists** that represent real projects or areas of your life (for example `Business`, `School`, `Personal`). Add a `Today` list and a `Later` list.
2. Capture **at least fifteen tasks** across your lists. Every title must pass the verb + object test.
3. Give **at least eight** of these tasks a real due date. Put genuinely undated ideas in `Later`.
4. Star **three** tasks as today's MITs and move them into `Today`.
5. Choose the biggest task and give it **at least four subtasks**.

6. Add a **written note (details)** to at least two tasks.
7. Perform **one daily review** and write a short paragraph describing what you moved and why.
8. (Extension) Also perform one **weekly review** and list one task you deleted and one you rescheduled.

Required deliverables:

- A Google Tasks system with the lists and tasks above.
- A short written note (in your workbook or a Google Doc) describing: your lists, your three MITs, and what you did in your daily review.
- The shareable view: since Google Tasks has no public share link, instead take a photograph of your Tasks screen (or draw the structure on paper) to hand in. *Note: Google Tasks does not offer a link-share the way Drive does; the deliverable is a photo/printout of your system plus your written notes.*

Submission format: Photo/printout of your Google Tasks lists plus your written notes handed to the instructor.

Deadline: Before Session 5.

Marking rubric (25 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
Lists created	4	Three or more meaningful lists plus `Today` and `Later`
Task quantity and titles	5	Fifteen or more tasks; every title has a verb and object
Dates and priorities	5	Eight or more dated; exactly three MITs starred and in `Today`
Subtasks and notes	4	One task with four-plus subtasks; two tasks with details
Daily review write-up	4	Clear, honest explanation of what was moved and why
Organisation and consistency	3	System is tidy, realistic and easy to read

Common mistakes to avoid: vague titles; no dates; starring everything; treating a project as one task; never doing the review.

Instructor reference solution (excerpt):

```
Business list:
  Restock phone accessories ......... Mon (starred, Today)
  Collect â‚¦8,500 from customer ...... Tue (starred, Today)
  Email October invoices ............ Wed
  Pay staff salary .................. 28th

School list:
  Submit Eco 101 assignment ......... Thu

Personal list:
  Renew data plan ................... Thu
  Attend church committee ........... Sat

Today list (three MITs):
  Restock phone accessories
  Collect â‚¦8,500 from customer
  Submit Eco 101 assignment

Big task with subtasks:
  Restock phone accessories
    - Count current stock
    - Withdraw â‚¦30,000
    - Go to Mile 1 market
    - Update the stock sheet
```

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below the questions.)

Q1. Short answer. In one sentence, give the difference between a *task* and a *project*.

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is the best task title? a) `shop` b) `Buy 10 Ankara bundles from Mile 1 market - Friday 4pm` c) `October collection` d) `Things to do`

Q3. True or false. Google Tasks has a built-in "high / medium / low" priority dropdown.

- True / False

Q4. Short answer. Name the two tools you use to prioritise in Google Tasks, and explain the "rule of three".

Q5. Explain in your own words. Why does the course recommend Google Tasks for *actions* and Google Keep for *notes*?

Q6. Fill in the blanks. A good task title is made of a _____, an _____, a due _____ and (optionally) a _____.

Q7. Scenario. A learner's tasks "vanished" when they opened Google Tasks on a new laptop. What is the **first** thing to check, and why?

Q8. Practical description. List the six steps of the daily review.

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. A task is a single action that can be finished in one sitting; a project is an outcome made up of several tasks. **A2.** (b) â€” it has a verb, an object, a quantity and a date. **A3.** False. Google Tasks has no numeric priority field; you use the star, the MIT method and lists/dates. **A4.** The **star** and the **MIT (Most Important Tasks) method**; also the **Eisenhower matrix** for deciding. The "rule of three" means choosing at most three MITs per day so you always know what matters most. **A5.** Tasks is built around actions with due dates and subtasks, so it drives "what do I do next" for deadlines. Keep is built for storing and reading information (ideas, lists, images), so it is the right home for notes that are not actions with dates. **A6.** Verb; object; date; context (where/how). **A7.** Check that the laptop is signed into the **same Google account** as before. Google Tasks lives in the cloud behind the account, so the wrong account shows an empty list. **A8.** (1) Check the calendar; (2) open Tasks and review lists; (3) choose and star three MITs; (4) move today's tasks into `Today`; (5) reschedule anything not doable today; (6) clear the `Completed` section.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that memory and notebooks lose commitments, and that a digital task list remembers, reminds and searches for you. You met Google Tasks, distinguished a task from a project, learned the "verb + object + date + context" rule, created subtasks, prioritised with the star, the MIT method and the Eisenhower matrix, organised work into lists, practised the "capture everything first" habit, and ran a daily review. You also learned the weekly review ritual and how tasks sync through your Google account.

Five important takeaways:

1. A task is one action; a project is many tasks â€” and a project becomes a **list**.
2. Use **Google Tasks for actions**, **Google Keep for notes**.
3. Good title = **verb + object + due date + context**.
4. **Capture everything first, organise later.**
5. The **daily review** (5 minutes) and the **weekly review** (~30 minutes) keep the system alive.

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I turn a big responsibility into a project list with a clear first task?
- Can I create a task with a note, a due date and subtasks without help?
- Can I explain why starring everything defeats the purpose?
- Can I list my three MITs for tomorrow right now?

Connection to the next session. Right now you have a list of tasks, but you still do each one manually â€” writing the same email, filing the same receipt, retyping the same invoice. Next session, **Workflow and Automation**, we turn repeated work into a documented routine and set up free tools to do some of it for you automatically.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner distinguishes a task from a project without prompting.
- Task titles contain a verb, an object and (usually) a date.
- The learner stars only a few tasks and can say why.
- The learner breaks one big job into logical subtasks.
- The learner runs a daily review and explains each move.
- The learner knows to check the signed-in account when tasks appear missing.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A list must hold everything, in order." â†' Lists are for specific projects or contexts; `Today` is for today.
- "Everything is urgent." â†' Enforce the rule of three.
- "Notes and tasks are the same." â†' Notes go in Keep; actions go in Tasks.
- "If I write it down once, I'm done." â†' Organising and reviewing are what make the list work.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Task triage drill:** give ten messy phrases and ask the learner to rewrite each as a proper task title.
2. **List-sorting drill:** hand out fifteen slips of tasks and ask the learner to place each into the right list.
3. **Review rehearsal:** have the learner perform three daily reviews on paper from a given list, explaining each decision.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a partially filled Google Tasks account with lists already created and three tasks filled in; the learner adds the rest.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the guided and independent exercises as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** design a recurring weekly review checklist as its own task list, and set a repeating calendar event for the weekly review.

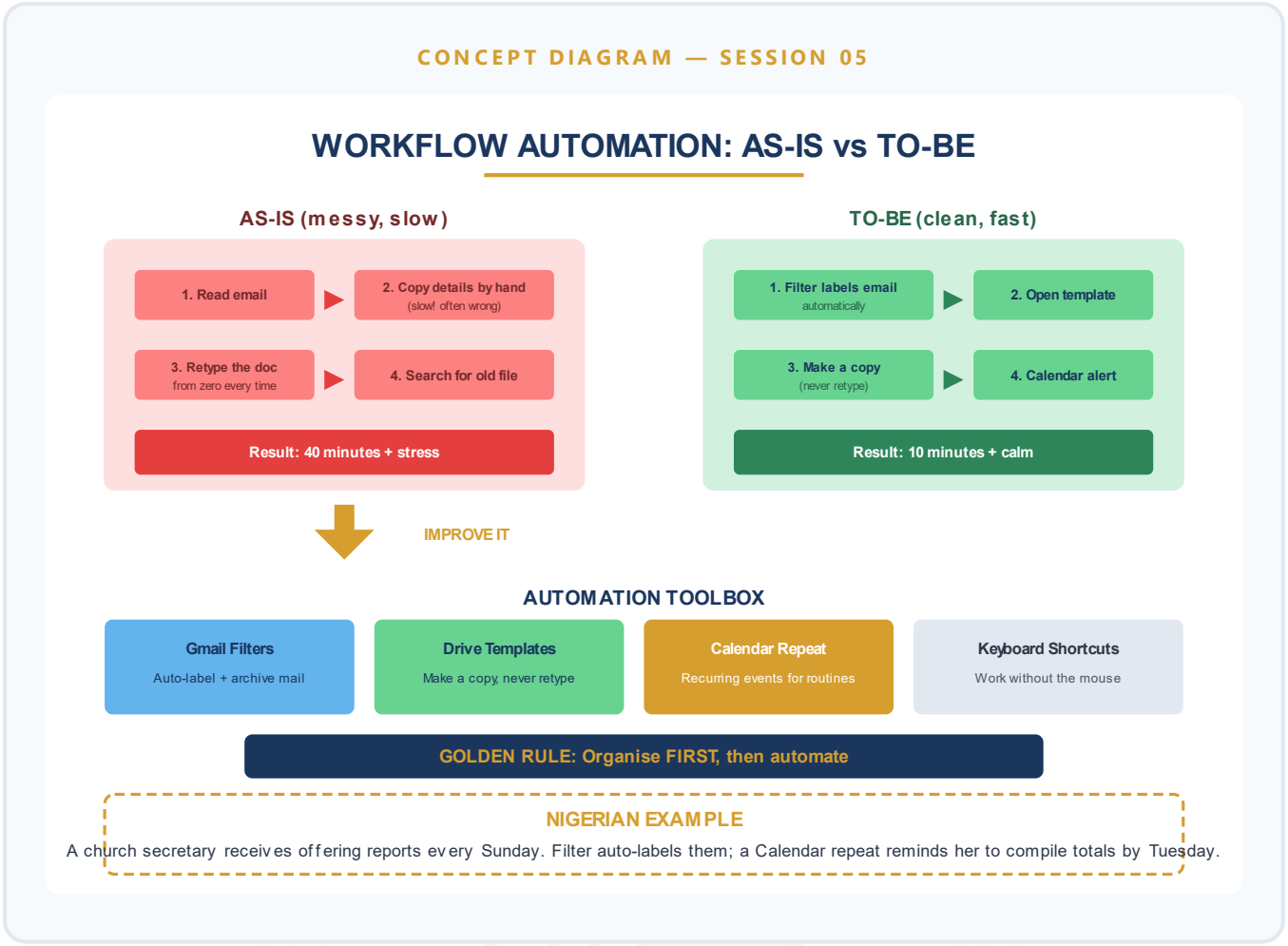
Timing guidance: Sections F.5â€"F.6 (lists and task creation) and Sections Gâ€"H (demonstration and guided practice) are the priority. If the room is slow, compress the case study (Section J) to a three-minute mention and protect the hands-on time â€" the practical is what the learner must leave with.

END OF SESSION 4

Next: Session 5 â€" Workflow and Automation.

SESSION 05 OF 6

Workflow Automation



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 5 â€" WORKFLOW AND AUTOMATION

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	5 of 6
Session title	Workflow and Automation
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Task Management and Workflow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"4. The learner should be able to organise Drive folders, use Gmail labels and filters, write in Docs, make a simple Sheet formula and keep a Google Tasks list. If a learner

Item	Detail
	cannot create a Gmail filter, the instructor reviews Section F.4 with them individually.
Connection to previous work	In Session 4 we learned to capture and organise tasks. But many tasks are done the same way every day and week â€" retyping the same email, filing the same receipt, writing the same invoice. This session looks at those *repeated* tasks, writes them down as a workflow, and makes free tools do part of the work automatically.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged into Gmail; a clean demo inbox with at least ten sample emails for filter practice; printed "As-Is / To-Be" workflow template; printed keyboard-shortcut cheat sheet; a demo Google Form linked to a Google Sheet; examples of a Docs invoice template and a recurring calendar event.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Define what a workflow is** and give three examples of recurring workflows from a Nigerian small-business, school or church setting.
2. **Document the current "as-is" workflow** of a real recurring task using numbered steps.
3. **Identify at least three repetitive, time-wasting activities** in that workflow.
4. **Design an improved "to-be" workflow** that removes or shortens the wasted steps.
5. **Create a Gmail filter** that automatically labels and archives incoming mail, and apply it to existing messages.
6. **Use a Google Drive template** ("Make a copy") so the same document is never retyped from zero.
7. **Set up a recurring Google Calendar event** for a repeated routine.
8. **Use a curated set of keyboard shortcuts** in Chrome, Gmail, Docs and Sheets to work without the mouse.
9. **Build and write a daily productivity routine** that ties Drive, Gmail, Docs/Sheets and Tasks together.
10. **Explain** why automation should come *after* organisation, and describe the limits of what free tools can automate.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops). Shared computers are acceptable; pair learners and swap halfway.
- Instructor computer connected to a projector or large screen.

Software

- Google Chrome (any recent version).
- Gmail, Google Drive, Google Docs, Google Sheets, Google Calendar, Google Forms â€" all free with a Gmail account.
- Google Tasks (from Session 4).

Accounts

- The learner's own Gmail account, already set up in earlier sessions.

Sample files

- A clean demo Gmail inbox with a variety of messages (newsletters, bills, client emails, order confirmations) for the filter demonstration.
- A demo Docs invoice template in a "Templates" folder.
- A demo Google Form ("Order Request Form") already linked to a Google Sheet.

Worksheets

- Worksheet 5.1 â€" "As-Is / To-Be Workflow Map" (printed template).
- Handout 5.2 â€" "Keyboard Shortcut Cheat Sheet" (printed, one per learner).
- Worksheet 5.3 â€" "My Daily Routine" (in the learner workbook, Part 3).

Tools

- Google Forms (`forms.google.com`) for demonstrating the Forms-to-Sheets pattern.

Internet

- Required. All automations described run in the cloud.

Alternative for learners who lack a facility

- Any device with Chrome and Gmail works. A phone-only learner can follow the Gmail filter and calendar steps in the Gmail and Calendar mobile apps, though the menu wording differs from the desktop â€" say so.

Honest note on the tools. This session teaches automation using only the tools already available free with a Google account. More advanced "no-code" automation services (such as Zapier, Make or IFTTT) and Google Apps Script can link many apps together automatically, but they are **optional, beyond this course, and not required**. We mention them only so learners know they exist.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes) â€" "The Two Hours That Disappear"

Instructor setup: Put a simple time budget on the projector:

```
Funmi's typical day (office admin, 8 hours):
- Searching for files ...... 40 min
- Retyping the same replies.. 40 min
- Deciding what to do next... 30 min
- Actually useful work....... the rest
```

What the instructor says:

> *"This is Funmi. She is not lazy â€" she works a full day. But look: forty minutes hunting for files that have no clear home. Forty minutes retyping the same 'thank you for your order' email she has written a hundred times. Thirty minutes staring at her screen deciding what to do first. That is nearly two hours a day doing work that a machine could do, or that she could avoid entirely.*
>
> *Two hours a day is ten hours a week. That is a whole extra working day, every week, thrown away. Today we do two things: we write down how we actually work, and we make free tools do the boring parts."*

The hook (do this live): In the demo Gmail, show an email from a supplier. Ask: *"How long would it take Funmi to label this and file it by hand?"* Then create a filter that labels and archives all such mail automatically. Say: *"That one filter will now do that job forever, for one minute of setup."*

Expected learner response: Some learners will say "I do this too", "I didn't know email could do that", or "I just use my memory". Accept all answers. Confirm that almost everyone wastes time on repetitive work, and that the fix is not to work harder but to remove the repetition.

Why this opener works: It puts a number (â‚¦ or hours) on the hidden cost of poor workflow, which makes the value obvious and urgent, then gives an instant win with the filter.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this as an oral round-robin with the questions on the projector.

Question 1: "What is a Gmail *filter*, in one sentence?"

- Expected answer: a rule that automatically acts on incoming mail â€" for example, applying a label or skipping the inbox â€" based on criteria you set.
- Common gap: learners confuse a label (a tag you apply) with a filter (an automatic rule). Re-state: a label is a box; a filter is a machine that fills the box for you.

Question 2: "From Session 4, what are your three MITs?"

- Expected answer: the three Most Important Tasks you chose to do today, starred and moved into the `Today` list.
- Common gap: learners forget that MITs are limited to three. Reinforce the "rule of three".

Question 3: "In Google Docs, if you want the same invoice again next month, would you type it from scratch?"

- Expected answer: no â€” you would make a **copy** of a template (`File > Make a copy`) and edit the copy.
- Common gap: learners still retype documents. This question sets up today's automation lesson.

Question 4: "In Google Sheets, what does the formula `=SUM(B2:B10)` do?"

- Expected answer: adds all the numbers from `B2` down to `B10` .
- Common gap: forgetting the `=` sign.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"Notice that everything we have learned so far makes storing and capturing easy. Today we make doing easy. A workflow is just the steps you follow to do a recurring job â€" and once you can see the steps, you can remove the wasted ones and let tools handle the rest."*

If more than a third of the class cannot explain a Gmail filter, spend 8 extra minutes re-demonstrating filter creation before continuing.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES

F.1 What a workflow actually is

Plain-English definition. A **workflow** is a repeatable sequence of steps you follow to complete a recurring task. "Recurring" is the key word â€" it is a job you do again and again, not a one-off.

Why it exists. When a job repeats, we stop noticing the steps. We do it on autopilot, including all its wasteful habits (hunting for a template, retyping, forgetting a step). Writing the workflow down turns a fog into a map â€" and a map can be improved.

What it does. A documented workflow lets you: see the whole job, find the slow parts, decide which parts a tool can do, and hand the routine to someone else (or to a new version of yourself) without explaining from the beginning each time.

Real-life comparison. A workflow is a **recipe**. A good cook does not invent jollof rice from nothing each time; she follows a sequence she has perfected. If the recipe has a wasteful step, she changes the recipe â€" not her energy.

Everyday workflow examples:

- **Order-to-delivery (tailor):** receive order on WhatsApp â†' take measurements â†' write details â†' collect deposit â†' sew â†' notify customer â†' deliver â†' collect balance â†' file the receipt.
- **Weekly school routine (student):** check lecturer's WhatsApp group â†' note assignments â†' add to Google Tasks â†' do research in Drive â†' submit on the portal â†' move file to an `Archive` folder.
- **Church announcements (admin):** collect notices â†' draft in Google Docs â†' get approval â†' send by email â†' post on WhatsApp â†' file the final copy in Drive.

Important distinction. A workflow is not the same as a task. A task is a single action; a workflow is the *sequence* of actions that repeats. "Send the invoice" is a task; "the way we prepare and send invoices every week" is a workflow.

F.2 Documenting your current workflow â€" the "as-is" map

The idea. Before you improve anything, you must see it as it really is. This is called the **as-is** workflow. Do not write the version you *wish* you followed â€" write the honest version.

How to map it (a simple method anyone can use):

1. Pick one recurring job (start with the most annoying one).
2. Write the steps in order as **numbered lines**, each starting with a verb.
3. Next to each step, write **who does it** and roughly **how long it takes**.
4. Mark the points where you **lose time**, **lose information** or **make mistakes** â€" put a star or a circle on them.

Worked example â€” Adaeze's "send weekly invoices" as-is map:

```
AS-IS: Send weekly invoices (Adaeze Fashion)
1. Remember which customers owe money ........ (5 min, memory â€” often forgotten) *
2. Look for last month's invoice to copy ..... (15 min, searching Drive) *
3. Retype the invoice into a new Doc ......... (20 min, retyping) *
4. Type each customer's name and amount ...... (10 min, error-prone) *
5. Email each invoice one by one .............. (10 min)
6. File nothing; emails stay in the inbox .... (0 min, messy later) *
Total: ~60 minutes, every Monday.
```

Say this to the class:

> *"Notice that only the last steps are real work. Half an hour is spent remembering, searching and retyping. That is the waste we are hunting."*

Common misconception. Learners are tempted to write an ideal workflow immediately. Stop them. You cannot improve a process you refuse to look at honestly.

F.3 Spotting repetitive, time-wasting activities

The idea. Once the as-is map exists, look for patterns. Most time-waste falls into five families:

Type of waste	What it looks like	Example
Retyping	Typing the same content again and again	Writing the same welcome email
Re-searching	Hunting for a file, template or old message	Finding last month's invoice
Re-entering data	Moving information from one place to another by hand	Copying names from WhatsApp into a sheet
Manual reminding	Remembering to do something on a set day	Weekly stock check
Re-deciding	Making the same decision from scratch	"Which customer gets a discount?"

The test to apply to every step. Ask: *"If I had to do this step a hundred times, would I want to do it by hand?"* If the answer is no, it is a candidate for automation.

Estimate the cost. Multiply the minutes wasted by how often it repeats. Adaeze wastes about 30 minutes per week on the invoice process = 26 hours a year. Put in naira terms: if her time is worth â‚¦1,500 an hour, that is almost â‚¦40,000 of her year spent retyping.

Say this to the class:

> *"You do not need to automate everything. Pick the steps that are frequent and boring. Automating a rare, complicated task is not worth it."*

F.4 Simple automation with free Google tools

Automation means letting a tool do a repeated step for you. You do not need to write code â€” the Google tools already include automation. Here are the four patterns we learn today.

Pattern 1 â€” Gmail filters for auto-labelling and archiving

A **filter** is a rule: *when a new email matches these conditions, do these actions automatically.*

Common conditions: From, To, Subject, Has the words, Doesn't have, Has attachment, Size, Date. **Common actions:** Apply a label, Skip the Inbox (Archive it), Mark as read, Star it, Apply a label, Forward, Delete, Never send to Spam.

How to create a filter (exact steps, wording may vary slightly by version):

1. In Gmail, click the **search bar** and fill in the criteria (for example, From: `orders@adanmafoods.com`). Alternatively click the **sliders icon** at the right of the search bar to open **search options**.

2. At the bottom of the search results, or in the drop-down, click **Create filter**.
3. Choose the actions you want, for example:
    - **Apply the label:** choose or create `Orders` (you can create a new label straight from this menu).
    - **Skip the Inbox (Archive it):** so the message is labelled but does not clutter the inbox.
    - **Also apply filter to matching conversations:** to tidy the messages already in your inbox.
4. Click **Create filter**.

Another route: Settings (gear) > See all settings > Filters and Blocked Addresses > Create a new filter.

Worked example â€" auto-file bills:

```
Condition:  Subject contains "your statement is ready"  (or From: your bank)
Action:     Apply label "Finance/Bills"  +  Skip the Inbox  +  Mark as read
Result:     Every bank statement files itself and never clutters your inbox.
```

Say this to the class: "A filter is a servant that never sleeps. You teach it once, it works forever."

Pattern 2 â€" Google Forms feeding Google Sheets

The idea. A **Google Form** is an online form you can share as a link. Every submission is automatically collected into a linked **Google Sheet** â€" you do not type anything.

Why it matters. This removes the "re-entering data" waste. Instead of a customer sending details by WhatsApp and Adaeze copying them into her book, the customer fills a form and the row appears in the sheet automatically.

How it works (exact steps, wording may vary):

1. Go to `forms.google.com` and click **Blank** (or start from a template).
2. Add questions: Customer name, Phone, Item ordered, Quantity, Delivery date.
3. Click the **Responses** tab, then click the green **Sheets** icon to "Create a new spreadsheet". All answers now flow into that Sheet.
4. Share the form link on WhatsApp status or a business page. Orders arrive in a tidy row-by-row list.

Worked example â€" a small shop order form: the shop posts a form link; every order becomes a row with a timestamp, so the shop has a permanent record and can total orders with `=SUM`.

Pattern 3 â€" Drive and Docs templates ("Make a copy")

The idea. Instead of retyping the same document, keep one perfect **template** and make a copy each time.

How it works:

1. Create the master document (for example `Invoice Template`) with your business name, a table for items, a total cell and your account details.
2. Keep it in a `Templates` folder in Drive.
3. For each new invoice: right-click the template in Drive and choose **Make a copy**, or open it and use **File > Make a copy**.
4. Rename the copy with the naming convention and fill in the details.

Worked example: Adaeze's `Invoice Template` already has the table, the logo and a `=SUM` total formula. Creating a new invoice becomes a one-minute job of changing three cells instead of a twenty-minute retype.

Tip: Keep the `Templates` folder read-only to yourself so you never accidentally overwrite the master.

Pattern 4 â€" Recurring Google Calendar events

The idea. Anything you must do on a fixed schedule â€" a weekly review, a monthly stock check, paying staff â€" becomes a **recurring event** with an automatic reminder.

How to set a recurring event (exact steps, wording may vary):

1. Open Google Calendar and click **Create** (or click the day to begin an event).
2. Add a title, for example `Weekly Review â€" Friday 4pm`.
3. Set the date and the time.
4. Click the drop-down that says **Does not repeat** and choose **Weekly** (or Daily / Monthly / Yearly / Custom).
5. Choose when the repetition should end (or "never").

6. Click **Save**.

Worked example: A church admin sets `Prepare Sunday bulletin` to repeat every Thursday. The reminder appears on the right day without anyone remembering it.

Honest limits of automation

- Google's built-in filters and forms are powerful but simple. They cannot, for example, "read" a WhatsApp message on their own.
- Advanced tools (Zapier, Make, IFTTT) and Google Apps Script *can* connect more apps, but they are **optional, beyond this course, and can cost money**. You do not need them to be highly productive.
- **Automate after you organise, never before.** Automating a messy process just makes the mess happen faster.

F.5 Keyboard shortcuts â€" Chrome

A shortcut is a key combination that does in one second what a mouse takes five seconds to do. It sounds small, but a worker who saves five seconds a hundred times a day wins back minutes â€" and stays in flow.

Chrome (Windows) â€" the core list:

Shortcut	What it does
`Ctrl + T`	New tab
`Ctrl + W`	Close current tab
`Ctrl + Shift + T`	Reopen the last closed tab
`Ctrl + L`	Jump to the address bar
`Ctrl + Tab`	Next tab
`Ctrl + Shift + Tab`	Previous tab
`Ctrl + R` (or `F5`)	Reload the page
`Ctrl + H`	Open History
`Ctrl + J`	Open Downloads
`Ctrl + D`	Bookmark this page
`Ctrl + Shift + B`	Show or hide the bookmarks bar
`Ctrl + Shift + N`	New incognito window
`Ctrl + +` / `Ctrl + -`	Zoom in / zoom out
`Ctrl + 0`	Reset zoom

F.6 Keyboard shortcuts â€" Gmail

Important first step: Gmail shortcuts are **off by default**. Turn them on: **Settings (gear) > See all settings > General > scroll to "Keyboard shortcuts" > select "Keyboard shortcuts on" > scroll to the bottom > Save Changes.**

Once enabled:

Shortcut	What it does
`?`	Show the full shortcut list
`c`	Compose a new email
`/`	Put the cursor in the search box

Shortcut	What it does
`e`	Archive the open conversation
`#`	Delete the open conversation
`r`	Reply
`a`	Reply all
`f`	Forward
`s`	Star / unstar
`!`	Report spam
`u`	Back to the conversation list
`x`	Select the conversation checkbox
`j` / `k`	Move to the next / previous conversation in the list
`o`	Open the selected conversation
`g` then `i`	Go to Inbox (press `g`, then `i`)

(Direction of `j` / `k` and some labels can vary slightly by version. `?` always shows the current list inside your account.)

F.7 Keyboard shortcuts â€" Google Docs

Shortcut	What it does
`Ctrl + B` / `Ctrl + I` / `Ctrl + U`	Bold / italic / underline
`Ctrl + K`	Insert or edit a link
`Ctrl + Shift + C`	Open word count
`Ctrl + Alt + M`	Insert a comment
`Ctrl + Shift + 7`	Numbered list
`Ctrl + Shift + 8`	Bulleted list
`Ctrl + Z` / `Ctrl + Y`	Undo / redo
`Ctrl + F`	Find in the document
`Ctrl + H`	Find and replace
`Ctrl + /`	Show the full shortcut list

F.8 Keyboard shortcuts â€" Google Sheets

Shortcut	What it does
`Alt + =`	Insert a SUM formula for the range above/left
`Ctrl + Shift + V`	Paste values only (no formatting)
`Ctrl + Arrow key`	Jump to the edge of the data
`Ctrl + Shift + Arrow key`	Select a whole block of data
`Ctrl + Space`	Select the whole column

Shortcut	What it does
`Shift + Space`	Select the whole row
`F2`	Edit the selected cell
`Ctrl + ;`	Insert today's date
`Ctrl + Shift + ;`	Insert the current time
`Ctrl + /`	Show the full shortcut list

Say this to the class: "In Docs and Sheets, if you ever forget a shortcut, press `Ctrl + /` and the whole list appears. In Gmail, press `?`. You never need to memorise them all â€" you need to know where the list lives."

F.9 Building your daily productivity routine

Automation handles repeated *steps*. A **daily routine** handles the repeated *habits* that tie your tools together. The routine below uses everything from the whole course.

Morning (about 15 minutes):

1. Open **Google Calendar** â€" see what is fixed today.
2. Open **Google Tasks** â€" run your daily review (check lists, choose three MITs, move them to `Today`).
3. Open **Gmail** â€" triage the inbox: delete spam, archive reference, reply to quick items, turn action emails into tasks.

Midday â€" the work block (roughly 90 minutes): 4. Pick one MIT and work on it with notifications off (close WhatsApp Web, silence your phone). 5. Use **Docs/Sheets** to do the actual work, working from your templates.

End of day â€" shutdown (about 10 minutes): 6. **File** finished documents into the right **Drive** folder with a proper name. 7. **Update** Google Tasks â€" tick off what is done, reschedule what is not. 8. **Plan tomorrow** â€" preview the calendar and pre-pick your three MITs.

Weekly (about 30 minutes, same day each week â€" put it in Calendar as recurring): 9. Run the weekly review of your task lists (Session 4). 10. Check your `Templates` folder and update anything out of date. 11. Check your Gmail filters still make sense. 12. Back up any important local files to Drive.

Say this to the class:

> *"A routine is not a prison â€" it is a railway track. It carries you through the day without you having to decide, again and again, what to do next. That repeated deciding is one of the biggest hidden time-wasters."*

F.10 Summary of the session

- A **workflow** is a repeatable sequence of steps for a recurring task.
- Document the **as-is** honestly, then design the **to-be**.
- Hunt five kinds of waste: retyping, re-searching, re-entering, manual reminding, re-deciding.
- Automate with **Gmail filters**, **Forms â†' Sheets**, **Drive/Docs templates** and **recurring Calendar events**.
- Learn **keyboard shortcuts** for Chrome, Gmail, Docs and Sheets; the full list lives at `?` and `Ctrl + /`.
- Tie it together with a **daily routine**: morning triage, a focused work block, and an end-of-day shutdown.
- **Automate after you organise, never before.**

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes)

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- Chrome signed into the demo Gmail account with a messy demo inbox (ten-plus messages).

- The Tasks side panel, a `Templates` folder in Drive with an `Invoice Template` Doc, and Google Calendar open.
- Gmail shortcuts already enabled (Settings > See all settings > General > Keyboard shortcuts on).
- The projector showing the screen.

G.2 Demonstration 1 â€" Map as-is, then build a Gmail filter (7 minutes)

Say: "First we look honestly at a workflow, then we automate its most boring step."

Exact steps:

1. On the projector, draw the as-is workflow on a whiteboard/document: `Receive supplier email â†' label it by hand â†' move it â†' remember to pay â†' file the receipt` (about 20 minutes a day).
2. In Gmail, click the **search bar**, click the **sliders icon (search options)**.
3. In **From**, type the demo supplier address `orders@adunmifoods.com`. Click **Search** to preview, then click **Create filter**.
4. On the action screen, tick:
   - **Apply the label:** `Orders/Suppliers` (click **New label** to create it inside the menu).
   - **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)**.
   - **Also apply filter to matching conversations**.
5. Click **Create filter**. Show that the matching messages now carry the label and left the inbox.

Expected result: all supplier mail is labelled `Orders/Suppliers` and no longer clutters the inbox; future supplier mail will file itself.

Reasoning to explain: "The filter replaced a manual step that repeated many times a week. One minute of setup, permanent saving."

Things to watch/mistakes: do not tick "Delete it" by accident; do not create a rule so broad that it catches everything (for example, only filter on "has the words: order" â€" too broad). Show the teacher to use a specific sender or subject.

Question to ask: "What is the difference between the label and the filter?" â†' The label is the box; the filter is the machine that fills it automatically.

G.3 Demonstration 2 â€" Template and recurring event (4 minutes)

Say: "Now we stop retyping and stop remembering."

Exact steps:

1. In Drive, open the `Templates` folder and right-click `Invoice Template` â†' **Make a copy**.
2. Rename the copy `2026-10-09 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-014`, open it and change three cells. Show that a 20-minute job became a 1-minute job.
3. Open Google Calendar â†' **Create** â†' title `Weekly Review` â†' set Friday 4pm â†' click **Does not repeat** â†' choose **Weekly** â†' **Save**.
4. Point out that the reminder will now appear every Friday automatically.

Expected result: a new invoice copy created in a minute; a recurring weekly review event on the calendar.

Reasoning: "A template removes retyping; a recurring event removes remembering."

G.4 Demonstration 3 â€" A shortcut-only minute (4 minutes)

Say: "Watch one full minute with no mouse."

Exact steps (narrate each key press):

1. In Chrome, press `Ctrl + T` for a new tab, `Ctrl + L`, type `mail.google.com`, press Enter.
2. In Gmail: press `c` to compose, type a few words, then `Esc`; press `/` to search; press `j` to move down the list; press `e` to archive one message; press `?` to reveal the shortcut list.
3. Open a Doc and press `Ctrl + Shift + C` to show word count, then `Ctrl + /` to reveal the shortcut list.

Expected result: the instructor navigates and acts without touching the mouse.

Question to ask: "Which single shortcut do you think would save you the most time this week?" (Common answers: `e` to archive, `c` to compose, `Ctrl + T` new tab.)

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes) â€" "My Workflow Map and One Automation"

Objective: With the instructor guiding, each learner documents one real recurring workflow (as-is and to-be), sets up one Gmail filter, and practises a short shortcut routine.

Starting materials: Each learner uses their own Gmail. The instructor displays the template. The demo inbox is available for filter practice, or learners filter their own real mail.

The scenario (read aloud):

> *Think of one job you repeat every week â€" for example, processing orders, preparing a report, or handling messages from a group. We will map it, improve it and automate one step.*

Procedure (instructor calls each numbered step; learners follow; instructor walks the room):

1. On Worksheet 5.1, write the title of your recurring job, for example `Process weekly customer orders`.
2. Under **AS-IS**, write 5â€"7 numbered steps in order. Next to each, note roughly how long it takes. Circle the steps where you lose time.
3. Under **TO-BE**, rewrite the steps with the waste removed. Mark which step you will automate.
4. Open Gmail. Turn on shortcuts if needed: **Settings > See all settings > General > Keyboard shortcuts on > Save Changes**.
5. **Pause and predict:** "If I create a filter for a sender, will it affect mail already in my inbox, or only future mail?" (Answer: by default only future mail â€" unless you tick *Also apply filter to matching conversations*.)
6. Create one filter using the exact steps from Section F.4 Pattern 1. Choose a real sender or subject that repeats (for example a school notice, a bank alert, or a newsletter). Actions: apply a label AND skip the inbox.
7. Tick **Also apply filter to matching conversations** so old mail is tidied too. Click **Create filter**.
8. Open the label on the left and confirm the messages moved.
9. Practise a shortcut routine in Gmail: press `/` to search, `Esc`, `j` twice, `e` to archive one message, then `?` to view the list.
10. Write your **to-be** routine in 3â€"5 lines with rough times, using the morning / work block / shutdown pattern.

Expected result:

- A completed As-Is / To-Be worksheet for one real workflow.
- One working Gmail filter that labels and archives matching mail.
- The matching label visible in the left column with the tidied messages inside.
- A short written to-be daily routine.

Points to pause on and predict:

- After step 5: "What happens if I forget to tick *Also apply filter to matching conversations*?" â†' Only future mail is affected; the old messages stay put.
- After step 8: "Why did the messages leave the inbox?" â†' Because we chose *Skip the Inbox (Archive it)*; they are still safe under the label.

Troubleshooting while walking the room:

- Filter does not seem to work â†' check the criteria; a small spelling error means no match.
- Messages disappeared entirely â†' they were archived, not deleted; find them under the label or in **All Mail**.
- Shortcuts do nothing â†' they were not enabled in Settings.
- Menu wording differs â†' reassure learners that exact wording varies by version; the path is Settings > Filters, or the search sliders icon.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ One recurring job written as 5â€"7 as-is steps
- ☐ At least three wasteful steps circled
- ☐ A to-be version written
- ☐ Gmail shortcuts enabled

- [ ] One filter created with a label and Skip the Inbox
- [ ] Old matching mail tidied
- [ ] Shortcut routine practised (`/` , `j` , `e` , `?`)
- [ ] A to-be daily routine written in 3â€“5 lines

I. INDEPENDENT CLASS EXERCISE (15 minutes)

Task: On your own, design a workflow and automate one step for a fictional business, then present your shortcut routine.

Scenario: *Emeka* runs *Emeka Phone Repairs* in Port Harcourt. Every day he gets repair requests, tracks jobs, and updates customers. His current routine is: customers message on WhatsApp â†’ he writes jobs on paper â†’ customers call to ask "is my phone ready?" â†’ he checks the paper â†’ he replies â†’ he forgets to record payments. He loses at least an hour a day.

Requirements:

1. Write the **as-is** workflow in 5â€“7 numbered steps, marking the wastes.
2. Write a **to-be** workflow that removes at least two wastes, using only free Google tools.
3. Choose **one** automation and set it up (a Gmail filter, or a Google Form linked to a Sheet, or a recurring calendar event). Describe it in one sentence.
4. List **five keyboard shortcuts** you would use most, and say what each does.
5. Write a **three-line daily routine** for Emeka (morning / work block / shutdown).

Constraints:

- The to-be workflow must not require any paid tool.
- The automation must be one a beginner can set up in under five minutes.
- At least one shortcut must be from Gmail.

Time allowance: 15 minutes.

Instructor answer key / model (do not show learners before they try):

```
AS-IS (Emeka Phone Repairs):
1. Read WhatsApp request ....... (5 min) *
2. Write job on paper .......... (5 min, paper can be lost) *
3. Wait for customer to call ... (many calls/day) *
4. Check paper for status ...... (10 min searching) *
5. Reply to customer ........... (10 min) *
6. Record payment (often forgotten) *

TO-BE:
1. Customer fills a Google Form ("Repair Request") -> row appears in a Sheet automatically.
2. Emeka adds a task in Google Tasks: "Repair - [customer] - due Wednesday".
3. When done, Emeka updates the Sheet status column to "Ready".
4. A Gmail filter labels all "ready for pickup" replies automatically.
5. Payment recorded in the Sheet "Paid" column.
Wastes removed: paper loss, searching, forgotten payments.

AUTOMATION CHOSEN:
Google Form "Repair Request" linked to a Sheet, so job details are captured
without typing.

FIVE SHORTCUTS:
Ctrl + T (new tab), c (compose), e (archive), Ctrl + / (shortcut list),
Alt + = (SUM in Sheets for daily totals).

DAILY ROUTINE:
Morning (10 min): check Sheet + Tasks, pick 3 MITs, triage Gmail.
Work block (90 min): repair phones; update Sheet status as each finishes.
Shutdown (10 min): file receipts, tick tasks, plan tomorrow.
```

Marking guidance (out of 15, practice only):

- Clear as-is map with wastes marked (3)
- Realistic to-be map with two-plus wastes removed (3)

- One sensible, free automation described/set up (3)
- Five correct shortcuts (3)
- Three-line routine that ties tools together (3)

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY â€” "The Salon That Freed Its Saturdays"

Situation. *Ngozi* runs a small salon and spends every Saturday retyping receipts and stock notes by hand, then searching for last week's totals. She also forgets to send monthly appointment reminders. Saturdays, which should be her busiest selling day, are half-lost to admin.

Relevant facts.

- Ngozi has Gmail, Drive and a smartphone, but no automation at all.
- Her monthly tasks always repeat: appointments, stock, receipts, reminders.
- She cannot afford paid software.

Decision point. How can free Google tools turn her repetitive Saturday admin into a few minutes of automated work?

Possible approaches.

1. Do nothing â€” keep retyping and remembering.
2. Use a Drive `Templates` folder for receipts, a Sheets total, a Gmail filter for supplier mail, and recurring Calendar reminders.
3. Buy a paid salon management app.

Recommended solution (for this stage). Approach 2. Ngozi makes a `Receipt Template`, reuses it (no retyping); totals her week with `=SUM` in a Sheet; creates a Gmail filter so supplier invoices file themselves; and sets a recurring Calendar reminder to send appointment messages on the 1st of each month. The whole setup takes under an hour and saves her every Saturday.

Example automations:

- Filter: `From: supplier@example.com â†’ label Suppliers, Skip Inbox`.
- Recurring event: `Send monthly appointment reminders â€” 1st of each month, repeats monthly`.
- Template: `Receipt Template` â†’ Make a copy per sale.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 costs nothing but keeps wasting her best selling day.
- Approach 2 is free and quick, but she must spend an hour setting it up and remember to keep templates updated.
- Approach 3 is convenient but costs money she does not need to spend at this size.

Professional connection. In offices, this work is called **process improvement**: observing how a job is done, removing waste, and automating the boring steps. Employers pay for people who can look at a messy routine and make it run smoothly â€” exactly the skill practised today.

K. COMMON MISTAKES AND TROUBLESHOOTING

K.1 The filter catches too much (or nothing)

Symptoms: After creating a filter, unrelated mail is labelled, or nothing matches. **Likely causes:** The criteria are too broad (for example "has the words: order") or too narrow (a spelling mistake, or the wrong sender). **How to investigate:** Go to **Settings > Filters and Blocked Addresses** and read the criteria; test with search first. **Corrective steps:** Edit the filter (click **Edit**), narrow or correct the criteria, and save. **How to confirm resolved:** Only the intended mail is affected. **Prevention:** Use a specific sender or an exact subject phrase; test with search before creating the filter.

K.2 "My emails disappeared!"

Symptoms: A learner thinks archived mail is deleted. **Likely cause:** Choosing **Skip the Inbox (Archive it)** moved mail out of the inbox. **Corrective steps:** Find the mail under the new label, or open **All Mail**. **Prevention:** Explain early that archive protects mail; only "Delete" removes it (and even then it goes to Trash).

K.3 Shortcuts do nothing

Symptoms: Pressing `c`, `e` or `j` has no effect in Gmail. **Likely cause:** Gmail keyboard shortcuts were never enabled. **Corrective steps: Settings > See all settings > General > Keyboard shortcuts on > Save Changes**. **Prevention:** Enable them once at the start.

K.4 Automating a messy process

Symptoms: A filter or form is set up, but the underlying process is still chaotic. **Likely cause:** Automation was applied before organisation. **Corrective steps:** Go back to the as-is map, fix the structure first, then re-automate. **Prevention:** Remember the rule â€" organise first, automate second.

K.5 Recurring event repeats at the wrong time or day

Symptoms: The weekly reminder shows on the wrong day. **Likely cause:** The wrong repeat option (Daily instead of Weekly) or the wrong start date. **Corrective steps:** Open the event, click **Edit**, fix the repeat drop-down and start date, and **Save**. **Prevention:** Check the start day before choosing the repeat option.

K.6 The template keeps getting overwritten

Symptoms: The `Invoice Template` now contains a specific customer's data. **Likely cause:** The learner edited the master instead of a copy. **Corrective steps:** Rebuild the clean master; move it to a `Templates` folder. **Prevention:** Always **Make a copy** and edit the copy; keep the master read-only.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: Always confirm the cause (read the filter criteria, check the repeat setting) before changing anything.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT

Assignment title: "My Documented Workflow and Automation"

Purpose: To practise observing a real workflow, removing waste and automating at least one repeated step with free tools â€" the skills behind process improvement.

Realistic scenario: You manage the digital admin of a small business, school office or church office. Choose one recurring job (weekly or daily) that wastes your time. Document it, improve it, and automate one step.

Detailed instructions:

1. Choose **one recurring workflow** (for example, processing orders, sending weekly reports, or handling a WhatsApp group).
2. Write the **as-is** workflow in 5â€"8 numbered steps with rough timings and mark the wastes.
3. Write the **to-be** workflow with at least two wastes removed.
4. Set up **at least two automations** from these options: a Gmail filter, a Google Form linked to a Sheet, a Drive/Docs template, or a recurring Calendar event.
5. List **eight keyboard shortcuts** across Chrome, Gmail, Docs and Sheets, one line each explaining what it does.
6. Write your **daily routine** (morning / work block / shutdown) in a Google Doc.
7. Put all of this into **one Google Doc** and share it with the instructor as **Viewer**.

Required deliverables:

- One Google Doc containing the as-is map, the to-be map, descriptions of two automations, the eight shortcuts and the daily routine.
- The document itself demonstrates Drive, Docs and sharing (from earlier sessions).
- The automations must actually exist in the learner's own account.

Submission format: Share the Doc link with the instructor (Viewer). Bring a photo of any automation setup (for example the filter screen) if the instructor asks to see it.

Deadline: Before Session 6.

Marking rubric (25 marks):

Criterion	Marks	Description of a strong answer
As-is workflow	4	Clear, honest 5â€"8 steps with wastes marked
To-be workflow	5	At least two wastes realistically removed
Automations	6	Two working automations, appropriate and described clearly
Shortcut list	4	Eight correct shortcuts with clear explanations
Daily routine	3	Morning/work/shutdown linked to real tools
Presentation & sharing	3	Tidy Doc, shared correctly as Viewer

Common mistakes to avoid: automating before organising; a filter that catches everything; editing the template master instead of a copy; a routine so long it will never be followed.

Instructor reference solution (excerpt, as a Doc):

```
MY DOCUMENTED WORKFLOW â€" Adaeze Fashion

AS-IS: Send weekly invoices (60 min)
1. Try to remember who owes ..... 5 min  (*)
2. Search Drive for last invoice ..... 15 min (*)
3. Retype the invoice ..... 20 min (*)
4. Type names and amounts ..... 10 min (*)
5. Email each customer ..... 10 min

TO-BE: Send weekly invoices (10 min)
1. Open Invoice Template -> Make a copy ... 1 min
2. Change 3 cells (name, items, total) .... 4 min
3. Save to /Adaeze Fashion/Invoices ..... 1 min
4. Send from a saved Gmail template ..... 4 min

AUTOMATION 1: Gmail filter â€" From: orders@adunmifoods.com ->
              label Orders/Suppliers + Skip Inbox.
AUTOMATION 2: Recurring Calendar event â€" "Weekly Review",
              every Friday 4pm.

EIGHT SHORTCUTS:
Ctrl+T new tab | Ctrl+L address bar | c compose | e archive |
/ search | j next conversation | Ctrl+Shift+C word count |
Alt+= sum in Sheets.

DAILY ROUTINE:
Morning (15 min): Calendar -> Tasks review -> Gmail triage.
Work block (90 min): one MIT, notifications off, use templates.
Shutdown (10 min): file in Drive, update Tasks, plan tomorrow.
```

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK

(Learner version â€" answers only in the Instructor Key below the questions.)

Q1. Short answer. In one sentence, what is a workflow?

Q2. Multiple choice. Which of these is NOT one of the five common types of workflow waste we studied? a) Retyping b) Re-searching c) Doing paid work d) Manual reminding

Q3. True or false. You should automate a process before you organise it.

- True / False

Q4. Short answer. Name two actions a Gmail filter can perform automatically.

Q5. Explain in your own words. What does the Forms â† Sheets pattern save you from doing by hand?

Q6. Fill in the blanks. To reuse a document without retyping, you keep a _____ and use **Make a** _____.

Q7. Short answer. Which key do you press in Gmail to see the full list of shortcuts? In Docs and Sheets?

Q8. Scenario. A learner's filter archived important client emails by mistake. What are the two things to check and how would you fix it?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€“Q8)

A1. A workflow is a repeatable sequence of steps you follow to complete a recurring task. **A2.** (c) â€” doing paid work is the point of work, not a waste. The five wastes are retyping, re-searching, re-entering data, manual reminding and re-deciding. **A3.** False. Automate **after** organising; automating a mess makes the mess faster. **A4.** Any two of: apply a label, skip the inbox (archive), mark as read, star, forward, delete, never send to spam. **A5.** It saves re-entering data by hand: the customer fills an online form and the answers appear automatically as rows in a Google Sheet. **A6.** template; copy. **A7.** Gmail: `?`. Docs and Sheets: `Ctrl + /`. **A8.** Check (1) the **criteria** â€” they are probably too broad â€” and (2) the **actions** â€” likely *Skip the Inbox* was intended but a *Delete* or wrong label was chosen. Fix by editing the filter (Settings > Filters and Blocked Addresses > Edit), narrowing the criteria, and, if mail was deleted, checking Trash.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

Plain-English summary. Today you learned that a workflow is a repeatable sequence of steps for a recurring job. You mapped the honest "as-is", hunted five kinds of waste, and designed a faster "to-be". You set up real automations using only free Google tools â€” a Gmail filter that labels and archives by itself, a Forms-to-Sheets pattern that removes typing, a Drive/Docs template that removes retyping, and recurring Calendar events that remove remembering. You also collected a curated set of keyboard shortcuts for Chrome, Gmail, Docs and Sheets, and built a daily routine that ties all your tools together.

Five important takeaways:

1. A workflow is a **recipe** for a recurring job â€” write it down before you improve it.
2. Hunt the five wastes: **retyping, re-searching, re-entering, manual reminding, re-deciding**.
3. Automate with **filters, Forms â†’ Sheets, templates and recurring events**.
4. Learn shortcuts â€” and know that the full list lives at `?` (Gmail) and `Ctrl + /` (Docs/Sheets).
5. **Organise first, automate second.**

Questions to help you recognise what you can now do:

- Can I take a weekly job I dislike and write its as-is steps honestly?
- Can I create a Gmail filter that files mail without me touching it?
- Can I name three shortcuts that save me time every day?
- Can I describe my morning triage in thirty seconds?

Connection to the next session. You now have every building block: an organised Drive, a managed Gmail, working Docs and Sheets, a task system, and a documented workflow. Next session, the **Capstone**, you assemble them all into one complete productivity system, present it to the class, and answer questions about it â€” and, if you meet the standard, receive your certificate.

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner maps a workflow honestly rather than idealising it.
- The learner correctly identifies at least three wasteful steps.
- The learner's Gmail filter works and is sensibly narrow.
- The learner explains the difference between a label and a filter.
- The learner uses a few shortcuts fluently and knows where the full list lives.
- The learner's routine is short enough to actually follow (five to eight steps, not twenty).

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "Automation is complicated / needs coding." â†’ The four patterns are point-and-click.

- "Archive means delete." â†’ Archive protects mail; explain.
- "More automation is always better." â†’ Only automate frequent, boring steps.
- "The routine must be detailed to be good." â†’ A five-step routine someone follows beats a twenty-step routine nobody follows.

Suggested remedial exercises for learners who struggle:

1. **Waste-spotting relay:** give a workflow and have learners shout out the wasteful steps.
2. **Filter drill:** hand a learner three emails and ask them to write the exact filter criteria for each.
3. **Shortcut race:** time a simple task done with the mouse versus with shortcuts.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** provide a pre-filled as-is workflow and a partially completed filter; the learner completes the rest.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the guided and independent exercises as written.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** build a Google Form linked to a Sheet with a `=SUM` total, and design a monthly recurring review with its own calendar event.

Timing guidance: Sections F.4 (the four automation patterns) and Gâ€"H (demonstration and guided practice) are the priority. If the room is slow, trim the case study (Section J) to a three-minute mention and make sure every learner leaves with at least one working filter and one written routine.

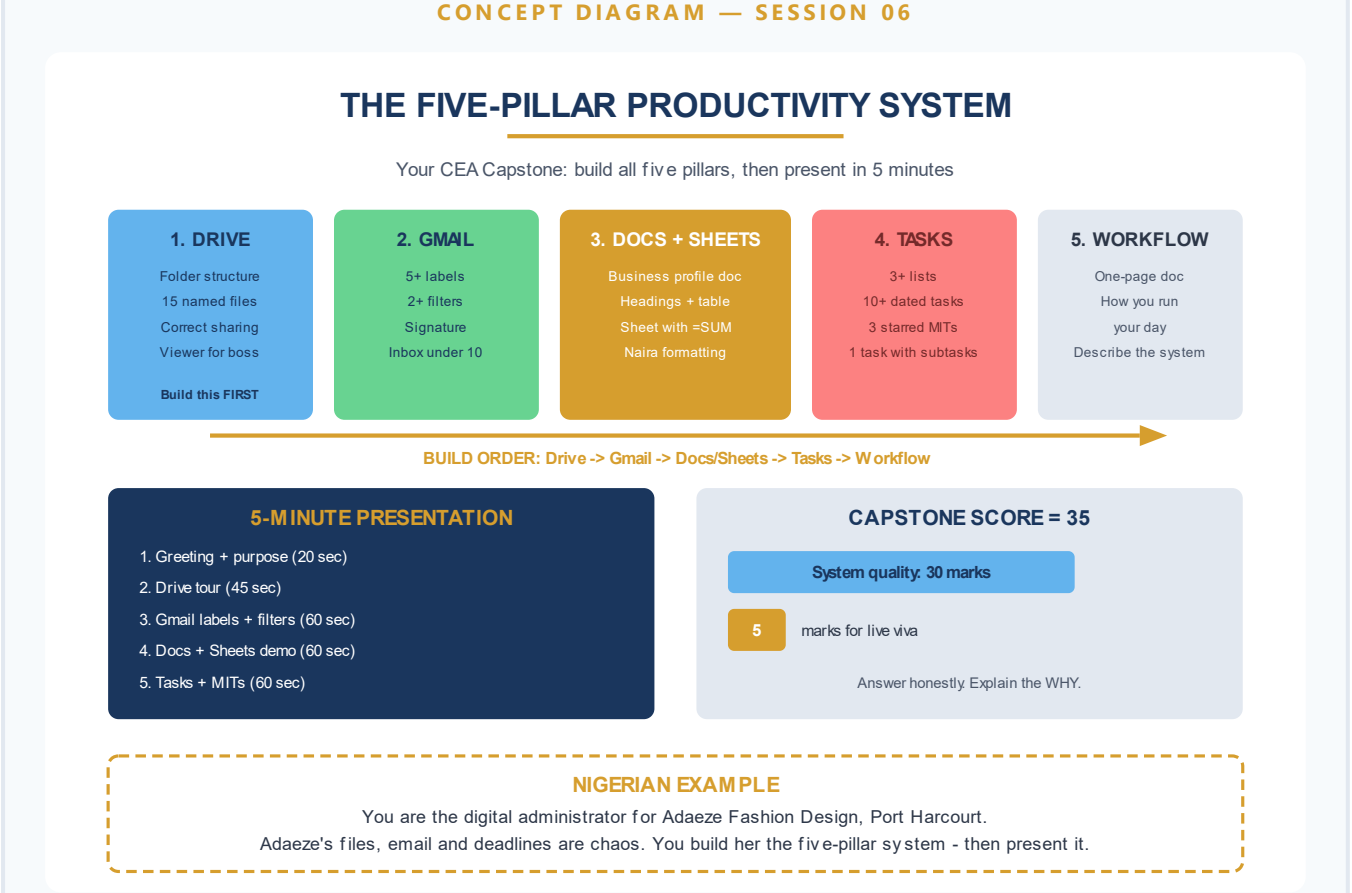
END OF SESSION 5

Next: Session 6 â€" Final Project: My Productivity System (Capstone).

SESSION 06 OF 6

Capstone Productivity System

CONCEPT DIAGRAM — SESSION 06



CYBER ELIAS ACADEMY â€" DIGITAL PRODUCTIVITY

SESSION 6 â€" FINAL PROJECT: MY PRODUCTIVITY SYSTEM (CAPSTONE)

A. SESSION IDENTIFICATION

Item	Detail
Session number	6 of 6 (final session)
Session title	Final Project â€" My Productivity System (Capstone)
Week / Module	Week 2 â€" Module 3: Task Management and Workflow
Recommended duration	105 minutes
Difficulty level	Beginner â€" but this session tests every skill from Sessions 1â€"5
Prerequisite knowledge	Sessions 1â€"5 completed. The learner should already have an organised Drive, a managed Gmail, working Docs and Sheets, a Google Tasks system and a draft workflow document. This

Item	Detail
	session is build, polish, present and viva.
Connection to previous work	Session 1 gave you organised storage; Session 2 gave you a managed inbox; Session 3 gave you documents and spreadsheets; Session 4 gave you a task system; Session 5 gave you a documented workflow. Today those five pieces become one complete, demonstrable productivity system â€" the certificate requirement.
Preparation before class	Academy PCs on and logged into Gmail; projector for learner demonstrations; printed capstone briefs (one per learner); printed rubric sheets for the instructor; printed viva question bank (instructor copy); printed certificate sign-off sheets; a completed model system on the instructor's demo account to show the standard.

B. LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of this session, the learner will be able to:

1. **Assemble a complete productivity system** in one Google account, integrating Drive, Gmail, Docs, Sheets and Tasks.
2. **Demonstrate an organised Google Drive** with a logical folder structure, at least fifteen correctly named files, and at least one folder shared with the correct permission.
3. **Demonstrate a managed Gmail** with at least five labels, at least two filters, a professional signature, at least one saved email template, and an inbox below ten conversations.
4. **Demonstrate Docs and Sheets competence** â€" a formatted one-page business profile document and a spreadsheet with working formulas and naira formatting.
5. **Demonstrate a task management system** with three or more lists, at least ten dated tasks, three starred MITs and at least one task with subtasks.
6. **Present a five-minute walkthrough** of the complete system that clearly explains the decisions made.
7. **Answer viva questions** about the system accurately and honestly.
8. **Self-assess** against the capstone rubric and reflect on growth since Session 1.
9. **Explain honestly** what the CEA Certificate of Digital Productivity means â€" and what it does **not** mean.

C. REQUIRED MATERIALS

Hardware

- One computer per learner (academy desktops).
- Instructor computer connected to a projector for learner presentations.

Software

- Google Chrome; Gmail; Google Drive; Google Docs; Google Sheets; Google Tasks; Google Calendar; Google Forms (optional).

Accounts

- The learner's own Gmail account, containing all work built in Sessions 1â€"5.

Printed materials

- Capstone brief (one per learner).
- Capstone rubric (instructor copy; learner copy optional).
- Viva question bank (instructor copy).
- Certificate sign-off sheet (one per learner).
- Learner reflection worksheet (Worksheet 6.1).

Internet

- Required throughout.

Instructor's model system

- A complete, exemplary system on the instructor's demo account, to show the class the standard at the start of the session. This is the single most useful preparation.

D. OPENING ACTIVITY (6 minutes) â€" "The Interview"

Instructor setup: On the projector, display a simple job advertisement:

> *WANTED: Office Assistant, Port Harcourt. Must be organised, reliable with files, email and deadlines. Send CV to HR.*

What the instructor says:

> *"Imagine two people apply. The first says, in the interview, 'I am organised.' The second opens a laptop and shows a tidy Drive, a Gmail inbox at zero with labels and filters, a task list showing exactly what she is working on this week, and a one-page document explaining how she runs her day. If you were the employer, who would you believe?*
>
> *Today you become the second person â€" not by talking about being organised, but by showing a real system. This is your final project. In the next hour you will complete, polish and present the whole thing, and then you will receive your certificate if you meet the standard."*

The hook: Open the instructor's model system and take the class on a 60-second tour â€" Drive first, then Gmail, then Tasks, then the workflow doc. Say: "*This is the finish line. By the end of today, this is you.*"

Expected learner response: Learners may feel nervous ("I have not finished everything"). Reassure them: today is exactly the time to finish, and the instructor will move around the room helping. Emphasise that presentation quality is not about fancy words â€" it is about honest, clear explanation.

Why this opener works: It frames the capstone as a real-world outcome (employability and trust) rather than a school exercise, and it lowers anxiety by showing a concrete, achievable destination.

E. PREREQUISITE REVIEW (7 minutes)

Run this fast as a whole-class review with the questions on the projector. This doubles as a warm-up before the build.

Question 1: "What are the three sharing permissions in Google Drive, and which one should you use when a person only needs to read?"

- Expected answer: Viewer, Commenter, Editor. Use **Viewer** for reading only. (Least privilege.)

Question 2: "Give one example of a Gmail filter you built, and say what it does."

- Expected answer: any valid filter, for example `From: bank â†' label Finance/Bills â†' Skip the Inbox`.

Question 3: "What is your task-title rule, and what is a MIT?"

- Expected answer: verb + object + due date + context. A MIT is one of your three Most Important Tasks for the day.

Question 4: "What is the capital of Nigeria? " *(no â€" wrong course!)*

- Expected answer: learners should laugh. The instructor says: *"Just checking you are awake. Notice how easy it is to give a confident answer to the wrong question â€" in your viva, answer the question that is asked, and if you do not know, say so honestly."* This is a deliberate teaching moment about viva conduct.

Question 5: "In one line, what is your daily workflow?"

- Expected answer: any sensible morning / work block / shutdown routine using the course tools.

Bridge to today (say this):

> *"You have already learned every skill. Today is not new learning â€" it is assembly, polish and proof. If something is missing, now is the moment to fix it. Then you present, you answer questions, and you finish."*

If a majority of learners cannot answer Questions 1â€"5, spend 10 extra minutes reviewing the key concepts before the build begins.

F. FULL LECTURE NOTES AND CAPSTONE BRIEF

F.1 The capstone brief (restated)

Scenario. You are the digital administrator for **Adaeze Fashion Design**, a small Port Harcourt tailoring and fashion business. The owner, Adaeze, is overwhelmed: files are everywhere, email is chaotic, deadlines are missed, and nobody has written down how the work is done. She has hired you to set up her complete digital productivity system. At the end of the project, you will present the system and answer her questions.

Your deliverables (the five pillars):

1. **An organised Google Drive**
   - A main folder named `CEA-Capstone-YourName`.
   - At least four subfolders with a logical structure (for example `01-Admin`, `02-Designs`, `03-Customers`, `04-Marketing`).
   - At least fifteen files, each correctly named with the convention `YYYY-MM-DD - Topic - Name` (or another consistent convention), and each in the correct folder.
   - At least one folder shared with the instructor as **Viewer**.
2. **A managed Gmail**
   - At least five labels, sensibly named and (where useful) nested.
   - At least two filters that automatically label, archive or star incoming mail.
   - A professional signature with your name, role and a contact line.
   - At least one saved email template (for example "Client Follow-up" or "Order Confirmed").
   - An inbox below ten conversations (ideally at or near zero).
3. **Docs and Sheets competence**
   - A one-page business profile in Google Docs using heading styles, at least one table and one image.
   - A Google Sheet with at least ten rows of sales or stock data, using `=SUM`, `=AVERAGE` and `=COUNT`, formatted with the naira sign (â‚¦), and with a filter applied.
4. **A task management system**
   - At least three lists (for example `Shop`, `School`, `Personal`) plus `Today`.
   - At least ten tasks with dates; three starred MITs; at least one task with subtasks.
5. **A documented daily workflow**
   - A one-page Google Doc describing your morning / work block / shutdown routine, and at least two automations.

Presentation and viva. Each learner gives a **five-minute walkthrough** of their system to the class and answers questions from the instructor (the viva).

Timing within the session. In practice, the build/polish block runs about 45â€"60 minutes, presentations and vivas about 5 minutes per learner, with the wrap-up at the end. If the class is large, split presentation time across the final two hours or a follow-up session, and inform learners in advance.

F.2 Milestone checkpoints â€" what should already be done before Session 6

Use this checklist at the very start of the session. Everything here should have been completed across Sessions 1â€"5. Anything unticked becomes part of today's build time.

Pillar	Checkpoint	Should be ready before S6?
Drive	`CEA-Capstone-YourName` folder + 4 subfolders	Yes
Drive	15 files named and placed correctly	Yes
Drive	One folder shared Viewer with the instructor	Yes
Gmail	5+ labels created	Yes
Gmail	2+ working filters	Yes
Gmail	Signature set up	Yes
Gmail	1+ saved template	Yes
Gmail	Inbox below 10	Yes
Docs	One-page business profile (headings, table, image)	Yes
Sheets	10+ rows with SUM / AVERAGE / COUNT, â‚¦ format	Yes
Tasks	3+ lists + `Today`	Yes
Tasks	10+ dated tasks, 3 MITs, 1 with subtasks	Yes
Workflow	1-page workflow doc draft	Yes (final polish in S6)
Reflection	Draft reflection notes	Draft only

Say this to the class: "Tick what is done. Whatever you cannot tick is what you build in the first part of today's session. No learner is left behind â€” the instructor will move around to help."

F.3 The recommended build order

When time is short, build in this order (the same order the certificate looks for):

1. **Drive first** â€” everything else is stored there.
2. **Gmail second** â€” filters and signature matter most for daily work.
3. **Docs and Sheets third** â€” the actual work products.
4. **Tasks fourth** â€” the plan for using it all.
5. **Workflow document last** â€” it describes the system you just built.

Why this order? Each pillar depends on the one before it. A workflow doc makes no sense until the system it documents exists.

F.4 How to present your system (the five-minute structure)

A confident presentation is simply a clear story in a fixed order. Use this script:

1. **Greeting and purpose (20 seconds):** "Good morning. I am [name], and this is the productivity system I built for Adaeze Fashion Design."
2. **Drive (45 seconds):** open the folder, name your structure, explain *why* you chose it, show one file name, and show the shared folder.
3. **Gmail (60 seconds):** show labels, open a filter and explain what it does, show the signature and one template, and point at the inbox count.
4. **Docs and Sheets (60 seconds):** show the business profile, scroll to the table; open the sheet and click one formula cell to show `=SUM`.
5. **Tasks (60 seconds):** show your lists, three MITs, one subtask, and explain your daily review.
6. **Workflow (45 seconds):** open the workflow doc and summarise your routine and one automation.
7. **Close (20 seconds):** "That is my system. What I am most proud of is [one thing]."

Presentation tips: speak slowly; point at the screen; do not read word-for-word; if something breaks, stay calm and move on; it is fine to say "I would improve this next time."

F.5 How to answer viva questions

The viva is a short conversation, not an exam trap. Three rules:

1. **Answer the question you are asked.** Do not wander.
2. **If you do not know, say so honestly** and add what you *do* know. Honesty scores better than a confident wrong answer.
3. **Use the course vocabulary** â€" labels, filters, least privilege, MIT, as-is/to-be, template. It shows you understand.

The full viva bank with model answers is in Section M.

F.6 The capstone rubric explained

Your capstone is marked out of **35** in total:

- **30 marks** for the quality of the system itself, across eight criteria (Drive, Gmail, templates, Docs/Sheets, Tasks, workflow, consistency, presentation delivery).
- **5 marks** for the **viva / live demonstration**, where the instructor asks you to show and explain parts of your system live.

The full rubric table with performance descriptions is in **Section L**. Read it before you present so you know exactly what "excellent" looks like.

F.7 An honest word about what this certificate means

This course makes you a **competent digital-productivity beginner**. That is a real achievement â€" most office workers never receive this training. But be honest with yourself and with employers:

- You can **set up and run** a productivity system with Google's free tools.
- You **cannot yet** call yourself a productivity consultant or coach.
- You have **not** covered advanced automation, programming or enterprise tools.
- A certificate does not guarantee a job â€" it proves a skill you must now keep using.

Say this to the class: "A certificate is a key, not a house. It opens a door. What you build behind that door â€" by practising every week â€" is up to you."

G. INSTRUCTOR DEMONSTRATION (15 minutes) â€" "The Model System"

G.1 What the instructor prepares

- A complete model system on the demo account, matching the brief exactly.
- The rubric printed, so the instructor can point to criteria while showing the model.

G.2 Demonstration â€" a guided tour of the model (12 minutes)

Say: "Before you present, watch what 'excellent' looks like. Notice that nothing here is complicated â€" it is just complete and consistent."

Walk through, on the projector, in the build order:

1. **Drive (3 min):** open `CEA-Capstone-Demo`, show the four subfolders, open one file and read its name aloud, then open the **Share** box and point at **Viewer** for the instructor's email. Explain least privilege.
2. **Gmail (3 min):** show the label list; open **Settings > Filters and Blocked Addresses** and read one filter's criteria and actions aloud; open a saved template; show the signature; point at the inbox count (under ten).
3. **Docs and Sheets (3 min):** open the business profile, point at Heading 1 and the table; open the sheet, click a `=SUM` cell so the formula bar shows the formula, and point at the â,¦ number format.
4. **Tasks (2 min):** show the lists, the three starred MITs in `Today`, and one task's subtasks.
5. **Workflow doc (1 min):** read the morning line and the two automations.

Expected result: learners can see exactly what is expected, remove guessing, and copy the standard.

Mistakes/things to watch: do not rush the tour; pause at each pillar so learners can note what they are missing. Emphasise that the model is *complete and consistent*, not *busy or complicated*.

Questions to ask during the tour:

- "Why is this folder shared as Viewer and not Editor?" â†' least privilege; the instructor only needs to read.
- "What proves this sheet is really working, not just numbers typed in?" â†' clicking the cell shows the formula `=SUM(...)` in the formula bar.

G.3 Demonstration â€" how a viva sounds (3 minutes)

Say: "Now watch me answer a viva question the right way."

Model exchange (instructor plays both roles):

- **Question:** "Walk me through your Drive structure and why you chose it."
- **Model answer:** "I used four folders â€" Admin, Designs, Customers and Marketing â€" because Adaeze's work falls into those four areas. Admin holds invoices and receipts, Designs holds photos and logos, Customers holds measurements and orders, and Marketing holds flyers and posts. Numbering the folders '01, 02…' keeps them in a fixed order. I named files with the date first so they sort by time."

Point out: the answer was short, used course vocabulary, explained *why*, and did not ramble.

H. GUIDED PRACTICAL EXERCISE (18 minutes) â€" "Checkpoint Sprint"

Objective: Each learner rapidly ticks the pre-S6 checkpoints from Section F.2 and fixes the gaps, with the instructor guiding and moving around the room.

Starting materials: The learner's own account; the milestone checklist (Section F.2).

Procedure (instructor calls the checkpoint; learners verify and fix):

1. **Drive checkpoint.** Open your `CEA-Capstone-YourName` folder. Confirm four subfolders exist. Count your files â€" are there fifteen, all named correctly and in the right folders? Fix any gaps now. Confirm one folder is shared with the instructor as **Viewer**.
2. **Gmail checkpoint.** Confirm five labels, two filters, a signature and one template. If your inbox is above ten, spend three minutes archiving, deleting, labelling and snoozing until it is below ten.
3. **Docs/Sheets checkpoint.** Open your business profile â€" does it have a heading style, a table and an image? Open your sheet â€" do you have ten rows and the three formulas, formatted in â‚¦?
4. **Tasks checkpoint.** Confirm three lists plus `Today`, ten dated tasks, three starred MITs and one task with subtasks.
5. **Pause and predict:** "Which pillar do you think the rubric rewards most, and why?" (Answer: Drive and Gmail each carry 5 marks â€" they are the backbone â€" but every pillar matters.)
6. **Workflow checkpoint.** Open your workflow doc. Make sure it names your morning, work block and shutdown, plus two automations.
7. Write three lines of reflection notes you can use in the closing discussion.

Expected result: every checkpoint from Section F.2 is ticked; the system matches the brief.

Points to pause on and predict: after each checkpoint, ask a learner to state, in one sentence, why that pillar matters to a real business.

Troubleshooting while walking the room: see Section K for the common failure points and fixes.

Completion checklist (learner ticks each):

- ☐ Drive: folder, 4 subfolders, 15 files, 1 shared Viewer
- ☐ Gmail: 5 labels, 2 filters, signature, 1 template, inbox <10
- ☐ Docs: one-page profile with headings, table, image
- ☐ Sheets: 10 rows with SUM/AVERAGE/COUNT, â‚¦ format
- ☐ Tasks: 3+ lists, 10 dated tasks, 3 MITs, 1 with subtasks
- ☐ Workflow doc complete
- ☐ Reflection notes drafted

I. INDEPENDENT CAPSTONE BUILD AND PRESENTATION (15+ minutes, extended as needed)

Task: In the time remaining (and using the full build block), **finish, polish and present** your complete productivity system. This is the assessment.

Requirements: meet every item in the brief (Section F.1) and the rubric (Section L). Then deliver the five-minute walkthrough (Section F.4) and answer viva questions (Section M).

Presentation order: the instructor draws names; each learner presents in turn while the class watches respectfully.

Instructor conduct during the build:

- Observe and record against the rubric; give at most **two hints per learner**, and only in question form (for example, "Where should that file live?"), never by doing the work for them.
- Note concrete evidence for each rubric criterion.
- Keep learners on the clock; announce time at 30, 15 and 5 minutes remaining.

Instructor reference: what a strong completion looks like

```
DRIVE:    CEA-Capstone-Blessing/
           01-Admin/      2026-10-01 - AdaezeFashion - Invoice-001.pdf
                          2026-10-05 - AdaezeFashion - Receipt-014.pdf
           02-Designs/    ... (photos, logos)
           03-Customers/  ... (measurements, orders)
           04-Marketing/  ... (flyers, posts)   [shared Viewer with instructor]
           (15 files total, all named YYYY-MM-DD - Topic - Name)

GMAIL:    Labels: Clients/Orders, Finance/Bills, School, Reference, Auto/Notifications
          Filter 1: From bank -> Finance/Bills + Skip Inbox
          Filter 2: Subject "invoice" -> star + Clients/Orders
          Signature: "Blessing Okoro | Adaeze Fashion | 0803 xxx xxxx"
          Template: "Order Confirmed" | Inbox count: 3

DOCS:     Business profile, Heading 1 title, 2 paragraphs, 1 table, 1 image
SHEETS:   12 sales rows, =SUM(D2:D13), =AVERAGE, =COUNT, â,¦ format, filter on

TASKS:    Lists: Shop, School, Personal, Today
          11 tasks, 9 dated, MITs: Pay rent / Deliver Ngozi dress / Submit Eco 101
          1 task with 4 subtasks

WORKFLOW: Morning triage 15 min -> work block 90 min -> shutdown 10 min;
          2 automations (bank filter, weekly review event)
```

J. REAL-WORLD CASE STUDY â€" "Emmanuel's First Office Job"

Situation. *Emmanuel* and *Uche* both finished a short computer course and got hired at the same Port Harcourt company on the same day. On their first morning, Uche asks a colleague where the client contracts are kept; nobody is sure, and it takes an hour to find the latest version. Emmanuel opens his laptop, goes to an organised shared folder, and finds the right contract in thirty seconds. He also has a labelled inbox, a task list of what HR asked for, and a short note describing how he will run his week.

Relevant facts.

- Both men have similar qualifications and intelligence.
- Only one of them was trained in digital productivity.
- Files and email chaos cost the company money and trust every day.

Decision point. Within the first week, which new employee will the manager trust with important client work?

Possible approaches.

1. Wait to be told how the office works and hope for the best.

2. Take five minutes to ask where things live, then build a personal system (folders, labels, tasks) aligned to the company's setup.
3. Ignore organisation and rely on memory like everyone else.

Recommended solution. Approach 2. Emmanuel builds a small system around the company's tools. It costs him a few minutes a day and quickly makes him the person who "never loses anything" â€" which is exactly who gets promoted.

Trade-offs.

- Approach 1 and 3 are effortless now but create repeated failure later.
- Approach 2 takes a small, consistent effort and pays compounding returns in trust and opportunity.

Professional connection. This is the true value of the CEA Digital Productivity certificate: not the paper, but the habit of building systems that make you reliable. Reliability, more than talent, is what earns responsibility at work.

K. COMMON FAILURE POINTS AND REMEDIATION

These are the failures observed most often at capstone time. For each: the likely cause, the fix, and how to prevent it next time.

K.1 The shared folder is not actually shared

Symptom: The instructor cannot open the Drive folder. **Likely cause:** The learner forgot to share, shared the wrong folder, or shared as a link that is restricted. **Fix:** Right-click the folder â†' **Share** â†' add the instructor's email â†' set **Viewer** â†' **Send**. **Prevent:** Tick "share Viewer with the instructor" as a numbered step in the checklist.

K.2 Formulas are not real formulas

Symptom: The totals look right but there is no formula in the cell. **Likely cause:** The learner typed the answer instead of using `=SUM`, or typed numbers as text. **Fix:** Select the cell, click it and check the **formula bar**; retype using `=SUM(D2:D13)`; if numbers are text, use **Format > Number**. **Prevent:** Always verify by clicking the cell and reading the formula bar.

K.3 The inbox is still over ten

Symptom: Inbox count is high; labels exist but the inbox is cluttered. **Likely cause:** Filters created but never applied to existing mail, or no triage habit. **Fix:** Archive/label/delete/snooze until below ten; tick **Also apply filter to matching conversations** on the filters. **Prevent:** Run the morning triage daily.

K.4 Tasks exist but have no dates or MITs

Symptom: A long undated task list. **Likely cause:** Tasks captured but never organised (the "capture" half without the "organise" half). **Fix:** Add dates; star exactly three MITs; move them into `Today`. **Prevent:** Apply the verb + object + date rule and the rule of three.

K.5 Files are in the wrong folder or badly named

Symptom: Files scattered, names like `Document1` or `final-final`. **Likely cause:** Naming convention not followed. **Fix:** Rename with `YYYY-MM-DD - Topic - Name` and move to the correct subfolder. **Prevent:** Name files the moment they are created.

K.6 The learner cannot explain their own system

Symptom: During the viva, the learner goes silent or contradicts the screen. **Likely cause:** The system was copied without understanding; no presentation practice. **Fix:** Rehearse the five-minute structure (Section F.4) once before presenting; answer honestly where unsure. **Prevent:** Practise the walkthrough with a partner.

K.7 Panic and running out of time

Symptom: The learner freezes with 20 minutes left. **Likely cause:** Trying to build everything at once. **Fix:** Breathe. Follow the build order: Drive â†' Gmail â†' Docs/Sheets â†' Tasks â†' Workflow. **Prevent:** Use the milestone checkpoints from Section F.2 before S6.

Distinguish likely vs confirmed: always confirm (click the Share button, read the formula bar) before fixing.

L. SESSION ASSIGNMENT â€" THE CAPSTONE

Assignment title: My Productivity System (Capstone)

Purpose: To prove, in one integrated project, that the learner can set up and explain a complete digital productivity system using free Google tools â€" the CEA certificate requirement.

Scenario: As in Section F.1 â€" you are the digital administrator for Adaeze Fashion Design, and you must build and present her complete system.

Instructions: Complete all five pillars from Section F.1, then deliver the five-minute walkthrough and answer viva questions.

Deliverables checklist:

- ☐ `CEA-Capstone-YourName` folder + 4 subfolders + 15 named files + 1 folder shared Viewer
- ☐ Gmail: 5+ labels, 2+ filters, signature, 1+ template, inbox <10
- ☐ Docs: one-page business profile (headings, table, image)
- ☐ Sheets: 10+ rows, SUM/AVERAGE/COUNT, â‚¦ format, filter
- ☐ Tasks: 3+ lists, 10+ dated tasks, 3 MITs, 1 with subtasks
- ☐ Workflow: one-page doc with routine + 2 automations
- ☐ Five-minute presentation delivered
- ☐ Viva completed
- ☐ Reflection submitted

Submission format: Live demonstration plus the shared Drive folder and shared workflow Doc link given to the instructor.

Deadline: End of Session 6 (system + presentation). Reflection briefs submitted the same day.

â€" CAPSTONE RUBRIC (35 marks total) â€"

Part 1: The System â€" 30 marks across eight criteria. Shown as three performance bands.

#	Criterion	Marks	Excellent (full marks)	Competent (~half)	Not yet (low / 0)
1	**Drive organisation**	5	4+ logical subfolders; 15+ files all named with a consistent convention and correctly placed; folder shared Viewer	Folder and most files present; naming or placement partly inconsistent	Few or no folders; files scattered or badly named; no sharing
2	**Gmail organisation**	5	5+ sensible labels (some nested); 2+ working filters; inbox below 10; spam handled	Some labels and one filter; inbox still high	Few labels, no filters, cluttered inbox
3	**Email templates**	4	2+ reusable templates that are professional and clear; correct signature	One template and a signature; usable but rough	No template or signature
4	**Docs / Sheets competence**	4	Profile uses heading styles, table, image; sheet uses SUM/AVERAGE/COUNT, â‚¦ format and a filter, all correct	One deliverable strong, the other basic; minor formula or formatting issues	Neither deliverable formatted or formulas missing/incorrect
5	**Task management system**	4	3+ lists plus `Today` ; 10+ dated tasks; exactly 3 starred MITs; 1+ task with subtasks	Lists and tasks exist but missing dates, MITs or subtasks	Few tasks, no dates or organisation
6	**Workflow documentation**	3	Clear one-page routine (morning/work/shutdown) with 2 documented automations	Routine present but vague; one automation	No workflow document
7	**Consistency of the system**	2	Naming, labels and structure are coherent across all tools; the system "hangs together"	Mostly consistent with a few mismatches	Inconsistent, looks unplanned
8	**Presentation delivery**	3	Clear, confident five-minute walkthrough in the correct order;	Understandable but rushed or incomplete	Unable to present or reads without

#	Criterion	Marks	Excellent (full marks)	Competent (~half)	Not yet (low / 0)
			explains the *why*		explaining
	System subtotal	**30**			

Part 2: The Viva / Live Demonstration â€" 5 marks.

Criterion	Marks	Excellent (5)	Competent (~3)	Not yet (0â€"1)
Viva / live demonstration	5	Answers viva questions accurately using course vocabulary; can open and demonstrate any part of the system live; honest about limitations	Answers most questions; can demonstrate with prompting	Cannot locate or explain parts of the system; guesses

Total capstone mark: 30 (system) + 5 (viva) = 35.

Passing standard for the capstone: the learner must demonstrate a complete, functional system and present it. A system the learner cannot explain does not pass, regardless of how it looks.

Common mistakes to avoid: forgetting to share the folder; typing formula results instead of formulas; leaving the inbox cluttered; undated tasks; an incomplete workflow doc; going blank in the viva.

Instructor reference solution: the model system described in Section I.

M. KNOWLEDGE CHECK AND VIVA BANK

M.1 Written knowledge check (final, 10 questions)

(Learner version â€" answers in the key below.)

Q1. What are the three sharing permissions, and which gives read-only access? **Q2.** What is the difference between a Gmail label and a filter? **Q3.** Give the task-title formula taught in this course. **Q4.** What is a MIT? **Q5.** Write the Sheets formula that totals `C2` to `C20`. **Q6.** In one sentence, what is a workflow? **Q7.** Where do you press to see the shortcut list in Gmail? In Docs? **Q8.** What do the As-Is and To-Be maps represent? **Q9.** True or false: automatically archiving a rough, disorganised process is the correct first step. **Q10.** In one sentence, what does the CEA Digital Productivity certificate prove?

INSTRUCTOR ANSWER KEY (Q1â€"Q10)

A1. Viewer, Commenter, Editor. **Viewer** is read-only. **A2.** A label is a tag you apply to messages; a filter is an automatic rule that applies labels (and other actions) to incoming mail. **A3.** Verb + object + due date + context. **A4.** A Most Important Task â€" one of the (maximum) three priority tasks chosen for the day. **A5.** `=SUM(C2:C20)`. **A6.** A repeatable sequence of steps for completing a recurring task. **A7.** Gmail: `?`. Docs: `Ctrl + /`. **A8.** The As-Is map shows how a workflow currently works (with its waste); the To-Be map shows the improved version. **A9.** False. Organise first, automate second. **A10.** It proves the holder can set up and maintain a complete digital productivity system using free cloud tools â€" a competent beginner, not an expert or consultant.

M.2 Viva question bank (instructor copy)

The viva is a short live conversation. Ask 3â€"5 questions per learner, adapting to what they show. Model answers are provided so marking is consistent.

V1. Walk me through your Drive structure and why you chose it. *Model:* names the folders, explains that they match the business's main areas, and notes the numbering keeps order and the date-first naming sorts by time.

V2. Show me one filter and explain what it does. *Model:* opens Settings > Filters (or the filter list), reads the criteria (for example From bank), and states the actions (label Finance/Bills + Skip Inbox), and why.

V3. What is the difference between a task and a project in your system? *Model:* a task is one action; a project is many tasks and appears as its own list; e.g., "Buy fabric" is a task, "October Collection" is a project.

V4. How do you decide what to work on first each day? *Model:* morning review, check calendar, choose three MITs, star them, move to `Today`, work with notifications off.

V5. Show me a formula in your sheet and explain it. *Model:* clicks a cell, reads the formula bar (`=SUM(D2:D13)`), and explains it adds the numbers in that range.

V6. Why did you share that folder as Viewer and not Editor? *Model:* least privilege â€" the instructor only needs to read; Editor would let someone change or delete files.

V7. Walk me through your daily workflow. *Model:* morning triage (calendar, tasks, inbox), a focused work block on one MIT, and a shutdown that files documents and updates tasks.

V8. What was the hardest part of building this system, and how did you solve it? *Model:* an honest answer naming a real difficulty and the steps taken; shows problem-solving, not perfection.

V9. If a new customer order arrives tomorrow, what happens in your system? *Model:* order captured (form or task), a task with a date created, customer labelled/labelled mail, invoice made from a template, receipt filed in Drive.

V10. If your laptop were stolen tonight, what survives and why? *Model:* everything in Google Drive, Gmail, Docs, Sheets and Tasks survives because it lives in the cloud under the account; only local files are lost.

V11. What would you improve if you had another week? *Model:* a specific, realistic improvement (for example "connect a Form to my order sheet", or "add more filters"), showing self-awareness.

V12. What does this certificate mean â€" and not mean â€" for you? *Model:* it means I can set up and run a productivity system with free tools; it does not make me a consultant or expert, and I must keep practising.

Marking the viva (5 marks): award full marks for accurate, vocabulary-rich answers and fluent live demonstration; about three for mostly correct answers with prompting; zero to one for inability to locate or explain the system.

N. REFLECTION AND RECAP

N.1 Course summary

Over six sessions you built a complete digital productivity system. In Week 1 you organised your **Drive**, tamed your **Gmail**, and learned **Docs and Sheets**. In Week 2 you set up **task management**, documented and automated a **workflow**, and today you assembled and presented the whole system. You did not just learn tools â€" you built one integrated system and proved you can explain it.

N.2 Five course takeaways

1. **Organise before you automate** â€" structure first, then filters and templates.
2. **One system beats many apps** â€" Drive, Gmail, Docs/Sheets and Tasks working together.
3. **Capture everything, review daily, review weekly** â€" the habit that keeps the system alive.
4. **Good names and clear dates prevent most problems.**
5. **Reliability is the real skill** â€" a system you actually use is worth more than a perfect one you abandon.

N.3 Reflection questions (Worksheet 6.1)

1. Which pillar of your system are you most proud of, and why?
2. Which pillar was hardest, and what did you do to complete it?
3. How does your system today compare with how you worked in Session 1?
4. Name one habit from this course you will keep using next month.
5. What is one improvement you will make to your system within the next two weeks?
6. Who else at work, school, church or your business could benefit from this system, and how would you explain it to them?

N.4 Certificate and next steps (course wrap-up, read aloud)

> *"Congratulations â€" you have completed the Digital Productivity course. Be clear about what you have earned: you are now a **competent digital-productivity beginner**. You can set up, run and explain a complete productivity system using free Google tools, and that is a skill most people in the workplace do not have. You are **not** yet a productivity consultant or expert, and this course did not cover advanced automation, programming or enterprise systems. That honesty matters â€" it is the difference between a real skill and a false claim.*

Keep using your system. A productivity system is like a farm: it only produces if you tend it. Do your daily review, keep your files named, and clear your inbox.

Where to go next: *you may continue with related CEA courses â€" Microsoft Office for deep document skills, Data Entry for spreadsheet and data management, Business & Freelancing for professional workflows, or Graphic Design for marketing your work. Whatever you choose, the habit you built here â€" capturing, organising and reviewing â€" will serve you for the rest of your career.*

Your certificate includes a verification code that employers can check at ***cea.ng/certificates/verify****. Carry it with pride, and keep practising."*

N.5 Certificate sign-off (instructor completes)

- ☐ Attended at least 5 of 6 sessions
- ☐ All assignments submitted to a satisfactory standard
- ☐ Capstone system completed and presented
- ☐ Overall score at least 50%
- ☐ Capstone score recorded (out of 35): _____
- ☐ Verification code issued: _____

O. INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

Observable signs of genuine competence:

- The learner navigates their own system quickly and confidently during the viva.
- The learner explains the *why* behind choices (least privilege, date-first naming, rule of three).
- The learner's system is complete and internally consistent, not just present.
- The learner answers honestly when unsure instead of bluffing.
- The learner demonstrates at least one automation actually working.

Common misconceptions to watch for and correct:

- "A certificate makes me an expert." â†' It makes you a competent beginner; state this plainly and kindly.
- "If the numbers look right, the formula is fine." â†' Always check the formula bar.
- "Sharing as Editor is more helpful." â†' Least privilege; use Viewer unless editing is needed.
- "I can explain it next time." â†' If you cannot explain your own system, it needs practice now.

Remediation for learners who do not meet the standard:

1. Identify which of the five pillars is weakest and rebuild just that pillar with the learner.
2. Allow a short, supervised re-demonstration after a brief practice session, if policy permits a resit.
3. Pair the learner with a stronger classmate for a practice viva before re-assessment.
4. Record the gap clearly on the sign-off sheet so the learner knows exactly what to fix.

Differentiation:

- **Level 1 (supported):** allow the build to run longer, provide a partially completed system, and accept a shorter two-minute presentation.
- **Level 2 (standard):** the capstone as written, five-minute presentation, full viva.
- **Level 3 (challenge):** add a Google Form linked to the order sheet, a third filter, a nested label structure, and a one-month automation plan.

Timing guidance: Protect the final 10 minutes for the wrap-up and sign-off â€" finishing the course on a clear, honest, positive note matters. If the class is large, run presentations in two waves across the session and keep the build time tight so every learner presents.

END OF SESSION 6

COURSE COMPLETION NOTE

This is the final session of the CEA Digital Productivity course. A learner who has completed all six sessions, submitted all assignments and passed the capstone has demonstrated the ability to organise and manage their digital work life using free cloud tools, and is awarded the **CEA Certificate of Digital Productivity**. This certificate marks the learner as a **competent beginner ready for the next level** â€" it does not certify them as a productivity consultant, guarantee employment, or cover advanced automation or programming. Certificates can be verified at cea.ng/certificates/verify.

From Zero to Expert, Together.